THURSDAY
October 8, 2026

CHENNAI
CITY EDITION
26 Pages ₹ 5.00

THE HINDU

www.thehindu.com

INDIA'S NATIONAL NEWSPAPER SINCE 1878

Vol. 149 • No. 239
Regd. TN/ARD/110/2024-2026
RNI No. 1001/1957

To subscribe,
give a missed call at
9828331787
or scan QR code

Printed at » Chennai » Coimbatore » Bengaluru » Hyderabad » Madurai » Noida » Visakhapatnam » Thiruvananthapuram » Kochi » Vijayawada » Mangaluru » Tiruchirapalli » Kolkata » Hubballi » Mohali » Malappuram » Mumbai » Lucknow » Cuttack » Patna

amazon.in
Great Indian Festival
Live Now
Powered by SAMSUNG Galaxy | Co-Powered by intel CORE ULTRA
NO COST EMI
BANK DISCOUNT
EXCHANGE OFFERS

Amazon Great Indian Festival is here!

1 Open Amazon shopping app and tap Amazon Lens icon in the search bar
2 Scan any product using Amazon Lens
3 Find matching or similar products on Amazon and discover eligible offers
4 Click on Rufus icon at the bottom of the app to ask shopping questions

Scan any product and find matching or similar products on Amazon
Use Rufus for all your shopping questions

10% INSTANT DISCOUNT# SBI Debit Card | SBI card
Min. Trxn.: ₹2,490. Also valid on EMI Trxn. with SBI Credit Card.
Check offer T&C for further details. Validity: 08 Oct – 20 Oct 2026. T&C Apply.

Extra ₹250 Cashback only for Prime*
amazon prime

UPI and Pay Later Offers*
amazon pay

35% Off* on first order up to ₹150

Above visuals is generated or modified using AI . Any resemblance to actual persons, places, or events is purely coincidental. *For more details on the T&Cs for the Amazon Great Indian Festival, respective offers & exchange offers, please visit www.amazon.in/offertnc. The above mentioned information, deals and offers have been provided by participating sellers and/or brands and/or banks and/or payment processing partners and is displayed as is. Amazon does not endorse these claims and makes no representations as to the accuracy, credibility or validity of such information and does not provide any guarantees or warranties of any kind, express or implied, whatsoever in relation to the same. Offers are valid till stocks last.

Great Deals Delivered Now

Electronics & Accessories — Up to 70% Off*



Home & Kitchen Appliances — Up to 50% Off*



Personal Care & Beauty — Up to 40% Off*



fast now. fayda now. | amazon now | Zero Convenience Fees* Assured Cashback*

Mega Festive Deals



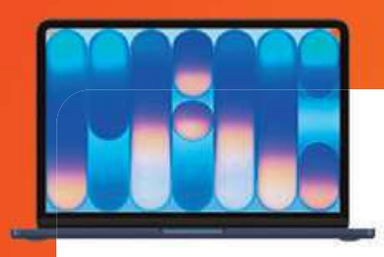
iPhone 16
48MP Fusion Camera
2x Optical Zoom
~~₹89,900~~
From **₹74,999***
Including ₹2,000 Off via Eligible Bank Discount and other Offers*



Samsung Galaxy S25 Ultra
200MP Camera with
AI ProVisual Engine
Starting
₹84,999*
Including ₹5,000 Off via Coupon and other Offers*
Up to 9 Months No Cost EMI*



OnePlus Nord CE6
8000mAh Battery with
up to 2.5+ Day Power
~~₹40,999~~
From **₹32,999***
Including ₹2,000 Off via Eligibile Bank Discount and other Offers*
Up to 6 Months No Cost EMI*



Apple 2026 MacBook Neo 13
A18 Chip, Apple Intelligence
~~₹79,990~~
From **₹64,990***
Including ₹4,000 Off via Eligible Bank Discount and other Offers*



Apple Watch Series 11
Aluminium Body, GPS
~~₹49,900~~
From **₹33,999***
Including ₹2,000 Off via Eligible Bank Discount and other Offers*



Samsung 653L Smart Refrigerator
Convertible 5-in-1 Digital Inverter
~~₹1,13,900~~
From **₹64,990***
Including ₹12,000 Off via Eligible Bank Discount and other Offers*
Up to 12 Months No Cost EMI*



ECOVACS T30e Omni Vacuum Cleaner
Full Station Robotic Vacuum Cleaner
~~₹89,999~~
From **₹39,999***
Including ₹5,000 Off via Eligible Bank Discount and other Offers*
Up to 9 Months No Cost EMI*



Lifelong Walking Pad
4HP
~~₹12,499~~
From **₹8,819***
Including ₹1,680 Off via Eligible Bank Discount and other Offers*



Lifelong 2 Burner Glass Gas Stove
Manual Ignition
~~₹4,350~~
From **₹899***
Including ₹100 Off via Coupon Discount and other Offers*



TCL 139cm (55) SmartChoice 4K QD-Mini LED Google TV
512+ Dimming, Native 144Hz
~~₹1,07,990~~
From **₹43,990***
Including ₹9,750 Off via Eligible Bank Discount and other Offers*
Up to 6 Months No Cost EMI*



MuscleBlaze Whey Protein Powder 1Kg
50% Higher Protein Absorption
~~₹3,978~~
At **₹3,799***
Buy 2, Get Extra 5% Off*
Up to 3 Months No Cost EMI*



Amazon Fire TV Stick HD
Streaming Stick with Alexa+
Smart Voice Search
~~₹5,499~~
At **₹2,999***
Extra 10% Off via Eligible Bank Discount and other Offers*
Buy & Unlock Alexa+ Early Access



American Tourister 3Pc Set
Hard PP Suitcase for Travel
~~₹25,700~~
At **₹6,499***
Additional 5% Off via Coupon Discount and other Offers*



WROGN Men's Jeans
Stretch Cotton, Slim Fit
~~₹1,999~~
At **₹699***
Additional 10% Off via Coupon Discount and other Offers*



Cetaphil Face Wash
Gentle Skin Cleanser
~~₹1,459~~
At **₹337***
Buy 3, Get Extra 7% Off*
Additional 5% Off via Coupon Discount for Prime Members

Buy More Save More % | Exchange Mela | 8pm Deals | Blockbuster Deals! | Freebie Central

Ogilvy 3680

Above visuals is generated or modified using AI . Any resemblance to actual persons, places, or events is purely coincidental. *For more details on the T&Cs for the Amazon Great Indian Festival, respective offers & exchange offers, please visit www.amazon.in/offertnc. The above mentioned information, deals and offers have been provided by participating sellers and/or brands and/or banks and/or payment processing partners and is displayed as is. Amazon does not endorse these claims and makes no representations as to the accuracy, credibility or validity of such information and does not provide any guarantees or warranties of any kind, express or implied, whatsoever in relation to the same. Offers are valid till stocks last.

amazon.in
Great Indian Festival
Live Now

Powered by SAMSUNG Galaxy | Co-Powered by intel CORE ULTRA

Great Deals on Smartphones



Samsung Galaxy Z Fold7 5G
Ultra Sleek Foldable with Galaxy AI
Starting
₹10,833/month*
Up to 12 Months No Cost EMI*



OnePlus Nord 6
9000mAh Battery
Snapdragon® 8 Series
~~₹52,999~~
From **₹42,999***
Including ₹2,000 Off via Eligible Bank Discount and other Offers*
Up to 6 Months No Cost EMI*



iQOO 15R
Elite Performance with Snapdragon® 8 Gen 5 Processor
~~₹69,999~~
From **₹46,499***
Including ₹7,500 Off via Coupon Discount and other Offers*
Up to 3 Months No Cost EMI*



XIAOMI 17
Leica Triple Camera
Stunning Detail in Every Shot
~~₹1,19,999~~
From **₹59,999***
Including ₹3,000 Off via Eligible Bank Discount and other Offers*
Up to 6 Months No Cost EMI*



Samsung Galaxy A56 5G
Ultra-efficient 4nm Processor
Starting
₹31,999*
Including ₹1,000 Off via Coupon Discount and other Offers*
Up to 6 Months No Cost EMI*



OnePlus Nord CE6 Lite 8+128 GB
MediaTek Dimensity 7400 Apex 5G
~~₹33,999~~
From **₹26,999***
Including ₹1,500 Off via Eligible Bank Discount and other Offers*
Up to 6 Months No Cost EMI*



iQOO Z11xa 5G
7200mAh Battery with Dimensity 7400-Turbo Processor
~~₹40,999~~
From **₹24,999***
Including ₹1,000 Off via Eligible Bank Discount & ₹3,000 off via Coupon Discount and other Offers*



Samsung Galaxy M47 5G
Monster Performance with Snapdragon + LPDDR5X RAM
Starting
₹25,999*
Including ₹2,000 Off via Eligible Bank Discount and other Offers*
Up to 6 Months No Cost EMI*

Great Upgrades on Electronics



ASUS Vivobook 15
Intel Core 3, Free 1 Year M365
~~₹86,990~~
From **₹48,990***
Including ₹4,000 Off via Eligible Bank Discount and other Offers*
Up to 6 Months No Cost EMI*



Samsung Galaxy Tab S10 Lite with Pen
Enabled with Samsung Galaxy AI
~~₹57,999~~
From **₹25,999***
Including ₹3,000 Off via Eligible Bank Discount and other Offers*



DJI Osmo Action 4
Waterproof, Outdoor Digital Camera for Travel, Biking
~~₹44,990~~
From **₹20,490***
Including ₹1,500 Off via Eligible Bank Discount and other Offers*
Up to 3 Months No Cost EMI*



Haier 598L Side by Side Refrigerator
3-Door, Smart Sense AI enabled
~~₹1,42,890~~
From **₹71,990***
Including ₹5,000 Off via Eligible Bank Discount and other Offers*



Bosch 12kg Washing Machine
Fully Automatic, Front Load
~~₹85,990~~
From **₹41,990***
Including ₹5,000 Off via Eligible Bank Discount and other Offers*
Up to 12 months No Cost EMI*



Hitachi 1.5 Ton 3 Star Inverter Split AC
4 Way Swing
~~₹63,990~~
From **₹33,990***
Including ₹2,000 Off via Eligible Bank Discount and other Offers*
Up to 6 Months No Cost EMI*



Samsung 138cm (55) Mini LED 4K Vision AI TV
30W Speakers, 4K Upscaling
~~₹59,990~~
From **₹37,740***
Including ₹5,750 Off via Eligible Bank Discount and other Offers*
Up to 12 Months No Cost EMI*



XIAOMI 108cm (43) 4K Fire QLED Fire TV
30W Dolby Audio, 32GB Memory
~~₹44,999~~
From **₹22,949***
Including ₹3,750 Off via Eligible Bank Discount and other Offers*
Up to 6 months No Cost EMI*

Great Offers on Fashion and Beauty

Clothing
Min 60% Off*
Levi's | RARE RABBIT | GAP | MYX | TOMMY HILFIGER

Beauty & Personal Care
Up to 70% Off*
GUESS | LAKMÉ | PHILIPS | Chopard | MAYBELLINE NEW YORK

Fashion Accessories
50-80% Off*
Nike | Mia by Tanishq | crocs | AMERICAN TOURISTER | uppercase

Extra up to 15% Off on 50 Lakh+ Styles via Coupon Discount*

Great Offers for Festive Joys



Hero Xtreme 125R
125cc Bike
~~₹95,700~~
From **₹84,700***
Including ₹11,000 Off via Eligible Bank Discount and other Offers*
OEM Warranty up to 5 Years*

Festive Gifting
Up to 70% Off*



Buy 3, Get Extra 5% Off*

Everyday Needs
Up to 70% Off*



Buy 3, Get Extra 5% Off*

Books & Toys
Up to 80% Off*



Extra up to 5% Off via Coupon Discount*



Echo Dot (5th Gen)
Smart speaker with Alexa+
~~₹5,499~~
At **₹4,499***
Additional 10% Off via Eligible Bank Discount and other Offers*
Buy & unlock Alexa+ Early Access

Health & Wellness
Up to 70% Off*



Buy 3, Get Extra 5% Off*

Daily Essentials
Under ₹99



Buy 3, Get Extra 5% Off*

Flight Booking
Flat 23% Off*



IndiGo | AIR INDIA express | AIR INDIA & more
On First Flight Booking*

Above visuals is generated or modified using AI . Any resemblance to actual persons, places, or events is purely coincidental. *For more details on the T&Cs for the Amazon Great Indian Festival, respective offers & exchange offers, please visit www.amazon.in/offertnc. The above mentioned information, deals and offers have been provided by participating sellers and/or brands and/or banks and/or payment processing partners and is displayed as is. Amazon does not endorse these claims and makes no representations as to the accuracy, credibility or validity of such information and does not provide any guarantees or warranties of any kind, express or implied, whatsoever in relation to the same. Offers are valid till stocks last.

amazon.in
Great Indian Festival
Live Now

Powered by SAMSUNG Galaxy | Co-Powered by intel CORE ULTRA

10% INSTANT DISCOUNT# SBI Debit Card | SBI card

Min. Trxn.: ₹2,490. Also valid on EMI Trxn. with SBI Credit Card.
Check offer T&C for further details. Validity: 08 Oct – 20 Oct 2026. T&C Apply.

Extra ₹250 Cashback only for Prime* — amazon prime

UPI and Pay Later Offers* — amazon pay

35% Off* on first order up to ₹150

Great Deals on Home and Kitchen



Aquaguard Aquasaver 2X RO+UV+UF+MC
Stainless Steel Tank, 2 Year Filter Life
~~₹25,000~~
From **₹9,999***
Including ₹2,000 Off via Eligible Bank Discount and other Offers*
Exchange Offer up to ₹1,000*



Prestige Iris Mixer Grinder
4 Jars 750W, 2 Year Warranty
~~₹6,295~~
At **₹2,699***
Additional ₹270 Off via Eligible Bank Discount and other Offers*
Exchange Offer up to ₹250*



Wakefit ShapeSense Orthopedic Mattress
Memory Foam, King Size
~~₹24,998~~
From **₹13,130***
Including ₹1,200 Off via Eligible Bank Discount and other Offers*



Native Lock Ultra by Urban Company
Facial Recognition Digital Door Lock
~~₹39,999~~
From **₹20,999***
Including ₹2,500 Off via Eligible Bank Discount and other Offers*
Up to 6 Months No Cost EMI*

Pressure Cooker, Triply Cookware and more
Min 40% Off*



Exchange Offer up to ₹500*
Flat ₹60 Cashback for Prime Members*

Blender, Induction Cooktops & more
Up to 35% Off*



No Cost EMI Starting ₹39/Day*
Exchange Offer up to ₹1,699*



Monte Carlo Symphony AC Comforter
Lightweight All Season Quilt
~~₹1,489~~
At **₹499***



Kidsmate Cruiser Kick Scooter
Ages 2-12 Years, Adjustable Height
~~₹4,999~~
At **₹699***
Up to 3% Coupon Discount for Prime Members*

Great Deals on Festive Style

Great Festive Looks
Min 50% Off*



BIBA KISAH soch Libas VASTRAMAY CARLTON LONDON MOCHI SHOES & ACCESSORIES

Great Festive Glow-up
Up to 70% Off*



SKINN by TITAN L'ORÉAL PARIS MARS SWISS BEAUTY WishCare Minimalist Neutrogena

Great Festive Accessories
50-80% Off*



PALMONAS FOSSIL CLARA Lavie Signature HIDESIGN TITAN SHAYA by CARATLANE

Extra Up to 15% Off on 50 Lakh+ Styles via Coupon Discount*

Great Deals on Smartphones and Accessories



OnePlus N6x
Military-Grade Durability Ready for Real Life
~~₹26,999~~
From **₹17,499***
Including ₹1,500 Off via Eligible Bank Discount and other Offers*
Up to 3 Months No Cost EMI*



REDMI 15C 5G Prime
50MP AI Dual Camera with 33W Fast Charging
~~₹29,999~~
At **₹15,999***



Lava Bold N2
Expansive 6.75 HD+ Display at 90Hz
~~₹12,999~~
From **₹8,729***
Including ₹970 Off via Eligible Bank Discount and other Offers*



Sony WH-1000XM6
Best Wireless Noise Canceling Headphones
~~₹49,990~~
From **₹35,990***
Extra ₹3,000 Off via Eligible Bank Discount and other Offers*
Up to 18 Months No Cost EMI*



OnePlus Nord Buds 4 Pro
55dB Active Noise Cancellation
~~₹4,999~~
From **₹3,799***
Including ₹200 Off via Eligible Bank Discount and other Offers*



JBL Vibe Beam 2
Active Noise Cancelling Earbuds
~~₹7,499~~
From **₹2,519***
Including ₹280 Off via Eligible Bank Discount and other Offers*



Whoop 5.0 Health and Fitness Wearable
24/7 Activity, Sleep Tracker
~~₹28,990~~
From **₹21,490***
Including ₹2,500 Off via Eligible Bank Discount and other Offers*
Up to 6 Months No cost EMI*



ZEBRONICS Blanc Slim
Sleek and Slim Design
~~₹799~~
At **₹329***

Crazy Deals Under ₹299*



Men's Casual Check Shirt
Cotton Blend
~~₹999~~
From **₹199***



Women's Short Kurti
Rayon Cotton Blend
~~₹499~~
From **₹99***



CELLO Aurum Designer Casserole 1.2L
Inner Steel Insulated
~~₹700~~
From **₹299***



Jaipuri Single Bed Cotton Bedsheet with Pillow Cover
Soft Plush Cotton Fabric
~~₹1,499~~
From **₹199***

35% Off up to ₹150 on First order* | UPI and Pay Later Offer from Amazon Pay*

Great Deals Delivered Now

fast now. fayda now. | amazon now | Zero Convenience Fees* Assured Cashback*

Above visuals is generated or modified using AI . Any resemblance to actual persons, places, or events is purely coincidental. *For more details on the T&Cs for the Amazon Great Indian Festival, respective offers & exchange offers, please visit www.amazon.in/offertnc. The above mentioned information, deals and offers have been provided by participating sellers and/or brands and/or banks and/or payment processing partners and is displayed as is. Amazon does not endorse these claims and makes no representations as to the accuracy, credibility or validity of such information and does not provide any guarantees or warranties of any kind, express or implied, whatsoever in relation to the same. Offers are valid till stocks last.

THURSDAY
October 8, 2026

CHENNAI
CITY EDITION
26 Pages ₹ 5.00

THE HINDU

www.thehindu.com

INDIA'S NATIONAL NEWSPAPER SINCE 1878

Vol. 149 • No. 239
Regd. TN/ARD/110/2024-2026
RNI No. 1001/1957

To subscribe, give a missed call at 9828331787 or scan QR code

Printed at » Chennai » Coimbatore » Bengaluru » Hyderabad » Madurai » Noida » Visakhapatnam » Thiruvananthapuram » Kochi » Vijayawada » Mangaluru » Tiruchirapalli » Kolkata » Hubballi » Mohali » Malappuram » Mumbai » Lucknow » Cuttack » Patna



INDUS PACT CITED

Revisit Cauvery water allocation: Karnataka

SOUTH » PAGE 7



MINOR INJURED

France pauses use of stun grenades at protests

WORLD » PAGE 14



25 YEARS IN OFFICE

Modi calls for 'can-do attitude' to reach goals

NEWS » PAGE 10

ENCOURAGING CONDITION

From the brink to a comeback

Sustained conservation, local action essential for safety of India's wildlife

EDITORIAL » PAGE 8



THE LAST TANGO

Emotional Messi gets a perfect farewell

SPORT » PAGE 15

Protests will go on until CEC resigns, says Rahul

Several Opposition leaders detained for second day in a row while moving towards Jantar Mantar; they stage impromptu dharna near the designated protest site; SP leaders absent from protests

Sandeep Phukan
NEW DELHI

The protests against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar will not stop until he resigns over alleged vote *chori* (theft), Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi said on Wednesday, after the Delhi Police detained him and other Opposition leaders for the second day in a row while they were on their way to Jantar Mantar for a dharna.

Mr. Gandhi, who has stressed a "politics of resistance", his sister Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, and other Opposition leaders staged an impromptu dharna at a roundabout barely a couple of hundred metres from Jantar Mantar, a designated protest site in central Delhi. "We are not going to stop protesting till [CEC] Gyanesh Kumar resigns. This is a fight to protect the most sacred thing in this country. There is nothing that [Prime Minister] Narendra Modi and [Union Home Minister} Amit Shah can do that will stop us," Mr. Gandhi said.



Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi during the INDIA bloc's protest against CEC in New Delhi on Wednesday. ANI

Samajwadi Party (SP) members, however, were conspicuous by their absence. The Congress played it down, saying the invitation had been sent at short notice and some parties could not respond.

Several other Opposition MPs, including CPI (M)'s John Brittas, CPI's P. Sandosh Kumar, Rashtriya Janata Dal's Manoj Jha, and Trinamool Congress's Derek O'Brien and Mahua Moitra, were part of the protests.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 10

YOUTH GROUPS' JOINT CALL
» PAGE 11

SC to examine plea on CEC appointment law

NEW DELHI
The Supreme Court on Wednesday agreed to examine and take a call on hearing an application seeking to recall a split verdict pronounced on September 23 in a case challenging the Election Commissioners' appointments law. » PAGE 11

RBI raises repo rate to 5.5% amid 'calibrated tightening'

Lalatendu Mishra
MUMBAI

The Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) on Wednesday raised the policy repo rate under the liquidity adjustment facility (LAF) by 25 basis points to 5.5% and shifted its stance from neutral to calibrated tightening, signalling that rate cuts are off the table in the near term.

Consequently, the standing deposit facility (SDF) rate stands adjusted to 5.25%, and the marginal standing facility (MSF) rate and the bank rate to 5.75%.

The policy repo rate, which was cut to 5.25% in December 2025, had been kept on hold at the next four MPC meetings. In the easing cycle, the MPC had cut the rate by 125 basis points in phases, from 6.5% to 5.25%, before increasing it on Wednesday.

The sudden re-escalation of the West Asia conflict in September and the consequent hardening and volatility in global crude prices soured global economic sentiment and unsettled financial markets, RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra said in the Governor's statement.

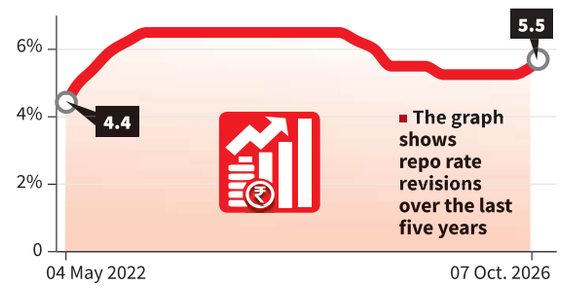
"It [the shifted policy stance] underscored that given the current conditions, rate cuts are off the table in the near term and policy action ahead can only be a rate hike or a pause, depending on the evolving conditions and the outlook," the Governor stated.

Further tightening of global financial conditions, uncertainty about fair valuation of AI stocks, and an elusive resolution of the West Asia conflict pose significant downside risks to the global economic outlook, Mr. Malhotra highlighted in his statement.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 10

Tighter grip

The shift in policy stance amid a sour global economic sentiment indicates that rate cuts are off the table in the near term, and policy action ahead can only be a rate hike or a pause



NEARBY



Vijay inaugurates Aavin's annexure laboratory

CHENNAI
Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Wednesday inaugurated the new annexure laboratory of Aavin's State Central Laboratory at the Central Dairy of the Tamil Nadu Cooperative Milk Producers' Federation in Chennai. » PAGE 6

Paperless registration for some deeds

CHENNAI
The government has accorded sanction for mandating paperless registration of certain documents pertaining to family arrangements from November 2. » PAGE 6

METROPLUS » 6 PAGES

Three killed in attacks on airports, says Saudi Arabia

Associated Press
CAIRO

Three people were killed in attacks on two airports in Saudi Arabia, the kingdom's General Authority for Civil Aviation said on Wednesday.

The Saudi Arabian authorities did not blame any party for the attacks at Abha and Riyadh's King Khalid international airports, but Houthi rebels in Yemen claimed earlier in the day that they carried out attacks against the two airports. The militia also said it targeted military facilities in the kingdom.

FULL REPORT ON
» PAGE 14

Crumble zone



Fragile structure: People gather in the New Seemapuri area of Delhi where a four-storey building collapsed on Wednesday. Two children and a pregnant woman were killed and eight injured in the incident. PTI (REPORT: PAGE 10)

Ex-IAF officer killed as boulder crashes on car in Coimbatore

The Hindu Bureau
COIMBATORE

A retired officer of the Indian Air Force died after a boulder slid from the slope and fell on a moving car in the ghat section of the Mettupalayam-Udhagamandalam Road in Coimbatore district on Wednesday.

The police said B. Krishnamoorthi, 64, the retired IAF officer and resident of Jagathala near Udhagamandalam in the Nilgiris district, died in the accident.

Son at the wheel

The accident took place around 9.20 a.m. when he was travelling from Udhagamandalam to Coimbatore in a sedan, with his son Karthi at the wheel.



The accident occurred near Burliar in Coimbatore district on Wednesday morning. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

His wife and two female relatives were also in the car.

As the vehicle proceeded about 500 metres downhill from the Burliar checkpoint in Coimbatore district, the boulder rolled down the slope and fell on the car.

Krishnamoorthi sustained serious injuries and was rushed to the Government Hospital at Mettupalayam.

The duty doctor examined him and declared him dead on arrival, the police said.

Wife, relative injured

A police officer said the wife of the deceased suffered a fracture in one of her arms. One of the female relatives suffered a head injury. They were admitted to a private hospital in Coimbatore for treatment.

The Mettupalayam police are conducting further investigation.

Chemistry Nobel for French-Japanese duo who expanded 'mirrored' molecules study

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

French chemist Henri Kagan and Japanese chemist Kenso Soai were on Monday named the winners of the chemistry Nobel Prize for 2026 for their work showing how chemical reactions can amplify small asymmetries in molecules.

Their work centred on chiral molecules, which are molecules that can exist in two mirror-image forms, like a left and a right hand. Professor Kagan's work paved the way for scientists to tune chemical reactions to produce the desirable forms of drugs, agrochemicals, and fragrances. In 1986, Professor Kagan and his team made a landmark discovery involving catalysts – substances that influence reactions. They showed that a small imbalance in the 'handedness' of a catalyst could disproportionately bias the reaction's end products. This finding was used to optimise chemical reactions.

Almost a decade on, Professor Soai and his colleagues showed that a chiral molecule could speed up the formation of other molecules with its own handedness. His work expanded the understanding of why many molecules essential for life prefer just one of the two possible forms. The proteins in our bodies are made mostly of amino acids that have one of the two mirror-image arrangements.

The enzymes that catalyse chemical reactions in cells and the receptors that respond to chemical trigger signals are also chiral. As a result, the differently handed forms of a chiral drug can interact with these molecules to elicit varied responses, only one of which might be desirable. This was a challenge for chemists who had to manufacture the desirably handed form of a drug.

Symmetric study

The duo's work is centred on molecules that can exist in two mirror-image forms, a property called chirality



Henri B. Kagan
Professor emeritus at the former Universite Paris-Sud, France



Kenso Soai
Professor emeritus at the Tokyo University of Science, Japan

Their study of chiral molecules expanded the understanding of why many molecules essential for life prefer just one of the two possible forms. The findings have been used to optimise chemical reactions as well

Former First Lady of Sri Lanka, Shiranthi Rajapaksa, arrested over graft allegations

Meera Srinivasan
COLOMBO

Sri Lanka's anti-corruption body on Wednesday arrested former First Lady Shiranthi Rajapaksa, wife of former President Mahinda Rajapaksa, over alleged financial irregularities. She has been remanded until October 13.

The Commission to Investigate Allegations of Bribery or Corruption (CIABOC) said it was arresting Ms. Rajapaksa in connection with an investigation into the alleged misuse of funds at her charity Siriliya Saviya Foundation.

Ms. Rajapaksa, who travelled to Singapore on September 16 for medical treatment, was served with a summons at Colombo airport to provide a statement to police in connection with allegations of financial irregularities at her charity.



Shiranthi Rajapaksa, wife of Sri Lanka's former President Mahinda Rajapaksa, being taken to prison in Colombo on Wednesday. AFP

Ms. Rajapaksa flew back on Monday after filing a court petition seeking to prevent her arrest, but the hearing for anticipatory bail was fixed for October 12, news agency *AFP* reported.

Ms. Rajapaksa's eldest son and Opposition lawmaker, Namal Rajapaksa, is also in remand custody after being arrested by the CIABOC last month over corruption allegations. The Rajapaksa family has denied any wrongdoing and accused the government of pursuing a political witch-hunt.

The arrests come as part of the ruling National People's Power government's ongoing anti-corruption drive, in which many politicians, bureaucrats, and businessmen are being investigated over graft charges. Authorities appear to be expediting long-dragging investigations.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 10

INBRIEF



M. SRINATH

City hospital launches centre for obesity, metabolic health

Kauvery Hospital, Radial Road, Chennai, has launched SAMATVA, a centre for obesity, metabolic health, and lifestyle management. Tamilisai Soundararajan, former Governor of Telangana, inaugurated the centre on Tuesday. The centre will provide comprehensive care for people with obesity and related health problems through a multidisciplinary team of physicians, endocrinologists, gastroenterologists, hepatologists, nutrition specialists and other health professionals. The assessment will look at medical and metabolic health, nutrition, physical activity and lifestyle, and factors that may make it difficult for a person to lose weight or maintain a healthy weight. Piyush Bawane, clinical lead, Medical Gastroenterology, and Rameez Raja B., consultant, Endocrinology, spoke.

Department of Posts to hold Dak Adalat on October 12

The Department of Posts will conduct a Dak Adalat at the office of Senior Superintendent of Post Offices, Chennai city central division, to address customers' grievances at 11 a.m. on October 12. A press release said the chairperson of the divisional level dak adalat will hear the grievances related to the postal department's products and services. Customers may send their complaints pertaining to the division to senior superintendent of post offices, Chennai city central division, Chennai-17 through ordinary or registered post on or before October 9.

Text & Context and Science

Weekday features on *The Hindu* epaper (epaper.thehindu.com) carry explainers, special articles and quizzes. In the latest issue (October 8, Thursday), the following articles are available:

- India's trade caught in the middle **newsth.live/indiatradeissues**
- India's formidable cement footprint stands in its way to net-zero **newsth.live/cementscience**

You can use your smartphone's inbuilt features to access these articles. If it's an Android phone, use Google Lens to read and tap the url to access an article. If it's an iPhone, use Live Text on camera to do the same.

Second round of hydrological study to be done for elevated corridor in Chennai airport

Anna University will undertake the study to ensure the Adyar river's flow remains unaffected by pillar construction. AAI will also need another approval from the Water Resources Department

PORT CALL

Sunitha Sekar
CHENNAI

A second round of hydrological study will be prepared in order to check the feasibility to build an elevated corridor and T5 Terminal for Chennai airport.

The move to build a T5 Terminal and a connecting elevated corridor for passenger access was mooted by the Tamil Nadu government a few months ago in order to enhance the capacity of the airport.

T5 Terminal

With the proposed T5 Terminal located near the remote bays, an elevator corridor for vehicular movement has to be constructed for air passengers to enter and exit this building.



Moving ahead: The next round of discussions between AAI and the State government will be held in a few days to hire a consultant for planning the project. B. VELANKANNI RAJ

Officials of Airports Authority of India (AAI) and the Tamil Nadu government, along with a few other stakeholders, recently held a meeting in which discussions were held on the alignment of the elevated corridor.

While AAI had a tentative alignment planned, the State Highways Department communicated the exact alignment linking the T5 Terminal with the NH32 (near Madha Engineering College).

"When we initially planned the T5 Terminal, a hydrological study was done. It had to be done to know whether the flow of water in the Adyar River will be affected if pillars are built near the bund. At that time, the study indicated that there will not be any impact on the water flow. Now, since the alignment has been finalised, Anna University will begin another detailed hydrological study," an official said.

Based on the report, AAI will also need another approval from the Water Resources Department.

The next round of discussions between AAI and the State government will be held within a few days to decide and hire a consultant for planning the terminal and the elevated corridor. The firm will require a minimum of 6-8 months to submit the detailed project report regarding this project.



Water hyacinth was removed from Jalladianpet Lake near Veerathamman Koil Street on Wednesday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

150 high-capacity pumps installed in flood-prone areas

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC) has kept 150 high-capacity 100 HP motor pumps, and 500 tractor-operated motor pumps, ready as part of its Northeast monsoon preparedness measures. The 100 HP pumps have been installed at 45 flood-prone locations across city.

The GCC had allocated ₹100 crore for various monsoon preparedness works, including desilting canals, removing water hyacinth from waterbodies, road maintenance, and keeping motor pumps ready, GCC Commissioner G.S. Sameeran said in a press release. The GCC has conducted two rounds of trial runs in all 15 zones to check the functioning of machinery, vehicles, and equipment to be deployed during the monsoon.

Besides this, 670 electric and diesel motor pumps of various capacities are also available.

Mr. Sameeran said the preparedness measures would include ensuring the availability and functioning of equipment required for floodwater removal across the city.

Service postgraduates get temporary postings without counselling

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Nearly 800-odd service postgraduates (PG), who completed MD/MS, have been given temporary postings in Tamil Nadu without counselling or following seniority.

Government doctors said this was a departure from the practice followed in the past few years, when vacancy lists were notified and counselling was held for posting service PGs. However, health officials said the temporary postings were made only for salary purposes. On October 5, the Directorate of Medical Education (DME) and Research issued orders temporarily assigning service PGs to posts in government medical college hospitals/affiliated institutions under the DME, and to institutions under the Directorates of Medical and Rural Health Services (DMS) and Public Health (DPH) and Preventive Medicine.

However, the posts and institutions were not specified for those assigned to DMS and DPH institutions.

The communication said transfer counselling for service PGs would be scheduled later and prior information would be given. The move has, however, caused concern among a section of doctors.

"Usually, vacancies in DME and DMS institutions are notified in advance when service PGs near course completion. Transparent counselling is held and postings are based on Civil Medical List (CML) seniority. This year, all of a sudden, the DME issued temporary postings without notifying vacancies or counselling. CML seniority has also not been followed, with juniors posted in DME institutions while seniors have been posted in DMS institutions," a doctor said.

Doctors said the temporary postings and delay in transfer counselling could affect salary disbursement as it usually takes four to five months for doctors to receive their first month salary at the initial place of posting.

Some doctors recalled a similar situation in 2019, when temporary postings were issued for service PGs without a regular counselling process. They said it took nearly three years to obtain posts on the basis of CML seniority.

The Service Doctors and Post Graduates Association (SDPGA) has objected to the move.

Its president, P. Saminathan, said even temporary postings should be made through counselling while maintaining CML seniority.

"This is not about 10 or 15 doctors but a massive number of 800-odd service PGs. CML seniority has not been maintained", he said.

Junior doctors have been posted to DME institutions, while doctors who are senior as per CML have been posted to DMS and DPH institutions. This will lead to complications in promotion counselling for associate professors in the future," he said.

A senior health official, however, said that the temporary postings were issued only for salary purposes. DME officials said the arrangement was temporary, for a month or two, until regular counselling is conducted after transfer counselling of assistant professors.



Working Women's Forum (India) President Nandini Azad at the launch of 'ArTribute 2026' theme 'Shades of Her – Tribute to Women' held at IIT-Madras.

'Poor women workers in informal sector make significant contributions to country's economy'

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

More than 90 per cent of poor women workers are deployed in the informal sector and make significant contributions to the country's economy, Nandini Azad, President, Working Women's Forum (India) (WWF) and Indian Cooperative Network for Women (ICNW) said.

While speaking recently at the launch of 'ArTribute 2026' theme 'Shades of Her - Tribute to Women' held at the IIT-Madras, she said, these women are powerless, invisible, low paid, unregulated and lack bargaining power. They have less to no investment capacities, and no trade unions to support them, she said.

"These women survive amidst starvation, social oppression, and the three-fold inequalities of caste, class, and gender. Yet they demonstrate extraordinary socialised resilience, operating through indigenous methods and ingenious mechanisms despite severe drudgery and discriminatory conditions," she added.

WWF and ICNW started working with poor women in the informal sector more than four decades ago, according to a press release. Through the 'gender and equity' model, Ms. Azad said, they have disbursed nearly ₹500 crore as small loans, with a high repayment rate.

"Our members are not just surviving, but thriving, and are leading the charge for gender equity and social justice. The Gender and Equity model of the WWF-ICNW cooperative helps women in the informal sector access finance, capacity building, and institutional support to transform their lives as leaders," she said.

Through the gender awareness and leadership training provided on social, economic and legal rights, ICNW has empowered women to turn into local community leaders, she added.

IT Minister reviews monsoon preparedness in Adyar Zone

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Minister for Information Technology and Digital Services R. Kumar visited areas in Wards 179 and 180 in Adyar Zone including Besant Nagar, Thideer Nagar and parts of Thiruvanmiyur, on Wednesday as part of review of monsoon preparedness.

He met residents and traders to hear their grievances and asked the officials concerned to take action on the issues raised. He also inspected ongoing storm-water drain works on Radhakrishnan Salai, Kalakshetra Road and Malaviya Avenue, and asked officials to complete the works before monsoon. At the pumping station on Thiruvalluvar Salai, he asked officials to undertake the necessary precautionary measures. He also visited an Amma Unavagam in Cholapuram and a fair-price shop in Marudheeswarar Nagar.



IT Minister R. Kumar inspecting Ward 179 of the Adyar Zone on Wednesday.

Later, the Minister met residents of Marudheeswarar Nagar, Lakshmipuram and Bharathidasan Street over sewage-related issues and patta-related requests and asked the officials concerned to take immediate action.

Chennai Weather	max	min
Tiruvallur	35	22
Chennai Airport	35	25
Chennai City	35	26

Chennai Airport Today
36°C The weather will be mostly dry. Day will be very warm and uneasy. Night also will be uneasy.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow
37°C The weather will be dry. Day will be very warm and uneasy. Night will be comfortable.

© Copyright Skymet Weather 2026
All rights reserved.

CINEMA ❖ ARTS ❖ EVENTS

MUSIC DANCE DRAMA

Arulmigu Sri Kapaleeswarar Temple, Mylapore, Chennai. Today (08.10.2026) Thursday 6.45 PM onwards Pradosham Special 'NAMASANKEERTHANAM' Vocal By Govindarajapuram Shri Aravind Choodamani, Vocal support by Shri. Seshadri Ananthanarayanan & Shri. Sriram, Violin by Shri. G.Kailasapathy, Harmonium by Shri.Gopalakrishnan, Mridangam by Shri B Ganapathiraman, Dolki by Shri. Arun Sudharsan. All are welcome

Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan,
East Mada Street, Mylapore, Chennai-600 004
SOOPER PRESENT
"Multi-Lingual Theatre Festival" from October 5 to 10, 2026 daily at 6.30 P.M. Today: 8th Oct: Kannada "Ushaharana" by Mysore Natana. Tomorrow: 9th Oct: Telugu "New Bombay Tailors" by B Studio. High Tea at 6.00 pm
All are Welcome.
Powered by : Nalli

Rukmini Trust, 24992672
Flute Concert by J B Sruthi Sagar & Party. Today 6.15pm at Ragasudha Hall.

To advertise visit
www.thehinduads.com
☎ 044-28576300
☎ Toll Free: 1800 102 4161

CLASSIFIEDS MART
TO ADVERTISE VISIT
www.thehinduads.com
CALL: 044-28576300 ▪ TOLL FREE: 1800 102 4161
or Contact your nearest Authorised space sellers

PERSONAL

CHANGE OF NAME

I, P.C.ELANGO S/o Chellaiah, Army No.14260600M Ex Hav, My wife S.Krisnaveni residing at No,11/133A, E–Block, Thanikachalam Nagar, Ponniammanmedu, Chennai–600110 henceforth be known as E.Krishnaveni

HEALTH

HAPPY FOOT Reflexology. @ Shenoy Ngr. 60min– 999/– 9042 18 28 28

BODY MASSAGES Avl at Alwarpet @ PIVOT SPA. Ct: 97909 67299

PEST CONTROL

NETLON SAINTGOBAIN SS Doortype SV Trading Authorised Dealer:9940386715

KENNEL PETS

MISSING
Please Help Us Find Azhagi
Finders will be suitably rewarded
Fully Vaccinated & Safe
Missing Since 06/10/2026
(Around 7.00 pm)
Last seen near
Manogar Nagar, Pallikaranai
If you find Azhagi or have any information, please contact
91768 67479
63809 83694
Please help us bring Azhagi home safely

CLASSIFIEDS SPECIAL

பூம்புகார் Poompuhar
Hand in hand with our artisans...
தமிழ்நாடு கைத்திறத் தொழில்கள் வளர்ச்சிக் கழகம்
(தமிழ்நாடு அரசு நிறுவனம்)
நடத்தும்
நவராத்திரி முன்னிட்டு
கொலு பொம்மைகள் கண்காட்சி மற்றும் விற்பனை
பலவகை வண்ண வடிவங்களில் பல்வேறு புது வரவுகளுடன்
கூடிய கொலு பொம்மைகள் இக்கண்காட்சியில் இடம் பெறுகிறது
நாள் : 23.09.2026 முதல் 31.10.2026 வரை (ஞாயிறு உட்பட)
நேரம் : காலை 10 மணி முதல் இரவு 8 மணி வரை
பூம்புகார் விற்பனை நிலையங்கள்
சென்னை : 044-28522222
சேலம் : 0427-2414994
மதுரை : 0452-2340517
சுவாமிமலை : 0435-2454442
கோவை : 0422-2391055
தஞ்சாவூர் : 04362-230060
திருச்சி : 0431-2704895
கடலூர் : 0414-2223099
ஈரோடு : 0424-2254885
டெக்ஸ்-வேலி : 88833 65899
கன்னியாகுமரி : 04652-246040
திருநெல்வேலி : 0462-2904040
சிறப்பு கண்காட்சி மற்றும் விற்பனை
ஸ்ரீ சங்கரா ஹால், (Mini AC Hall)
எண்: 281, டி.டி.கிருஷ்ணமாசாரி சாலை, ஆழ்வார்பேட்டை, சென்னை-600 018. 91761 38431
10% சிறப்பு தள்ளுபடி
Shop online @ www.poompuhar.com

INBRIEF



Hospital holds campaign to mark World Sight Day

Dr. Agarwals Eye Hospital and Dr. Agarwals Institute of Optometry (DAIO) held an innovative and interactive eye health awareness campaign 'See What They See' on Wednesday, a day ahead of World Sight Day. As part of the initiative, undergraduate students pursuing optometry at the institute designed specially curated simulation glasses mimicking the visual impact of different conditions including cataract, glaucoma, age-related macular degeneration, diabetic retinopathy, and refractive errors at four locations. A release said more than 1,400 individuals wore these glasses and experienced how everyday vision can be affected by these conditions. Karpagam, Dean, DAIO, said, raising awareness about silent eye diseases is crucial to motivate people to get annual examinations. Early detection is the first defence in controlling preventable and avoidable blindness, she said.

Piped water supply to be hit in three zones for 24 hours

Residents of Sholinganallur, Perungudi, and Adyar Zones will not receive piped water supply from 9 a.m. on October 10 to 9 a.m. on October 11, as Chennai Metrowater plans to carry out maintenance works at Nemmeli desalination plant. A release said areas, including Indira Nagar, Kottivakkam, Neelankarai, Sholinganallur, and Kottur Garden will not receive piped water supply. Metrowater has requested residents to book water tankers online for emergency needs.

'Ask COMK' weather chatbot seeks to make daily decisions easier for residents in city

The chatbot by Chennai Rains, a city-based weather platform, has been designed to answer simple daily questions by residents on elevated temperatures, rains and weather systems near the coast

K. Lakshmi
CHENNAI

The Northeast monsoon may bring larger concerns - floods, reservoirs' storage and crop prospects, but for people, it also prompts simpler questions – will it rain today?

It is everyday questions such as these that 'Ask COMK', a chatbot created by *Chennaiyil Oru Mazhaikalam* (Chennai Rains), a city-based weather platform, seeks to answer by bringing weather information closer to the decisions that people make in their daily lives.



Quick response: COMK bloggers noticed that most of the questions they received revolved around the specifics of the rain forecast, particularly during the monsoon. V. UMESH KUMAR

Specific questions

The seed for the concept was sown when COMK weather bloggers noticed that most of the questions they received revolved around the specifics of the rain forecast, particularly during the monsoon- Will it rain in my area? Should I carry an umbrella?

'Ask COMK' has been designed to answer simple daily questions on elevated temperatures, rains and weather systems near the coast. Users have to feed their area pincode and choose between rainfall and temperature forecasts to get answers. They can also use prompt questions provided on the weblink for convenience.

K. Srikanth, who blogs with COMK and created 'Ask COMK', said the simple-to-use weblink, https://plots.chennairains.com/ask.html, provides a probability and context for the prediction, leaving it to users to make their own judgement based on the output. The chatbot uses inputs from eight weather models and IMD radar information, particularly for forecasts for the next few hours. 'Ask COMK' provides answers on weather forecasts for up to one week.

"I have mapped nearly 6,500 pin codes across South India for the weather information. But it may not have answers for more complex questions like when will the monsoon set in," he said.

Next on the list is another most relatable question- can I dry clothes, which would be available online in a few days. Quirky answers are being prepared for questions like 'Will there be sunshine today?'

"Ask COMK has received about 6,000 questions in the past four days since it was made available," Mr. Srikanth said.



Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay at the passing out parade at the Tamil Nadu Police Academy on Wednesday. V. UMESH KUMAR

Vijay reviews passing out parade of 14th batch of DSP trainees

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Wednesday reviewed the passing out parade of the 14th batch of directly recruited Deputy Superintendent of Police (DSP) trainees at the Tamil Nadu Police Academy at Oonamancherry in Chengalpattu district.

Mr. Vijay also distributed medals and trophies under various categories to the DSP trainees. The Chief Minister presented the Sword of Honour for the best all-round trainee officer to Aaneesh Pradeep, who was also the Parade Commander.

A total of 25 directly recruited DSP trainees including 11 women and 14 men, passed out. They included 16 engineering graduates, four graduates and five postgraduates. They underwent rigorous training for 52 weeks in criminal law, special laws, investigation, internal security, emerging policing challenges, handling modern security equipment, special field exercises, jungle warfare, marine rescue and scuba diving, said Director General of Police/Head of Police Force (DGP/HoPF) Mahesh Kumar Aggarwal.

Rajeev Kumar, Director General of Police (Training)/Director (in-charge), Tamil Nadu Police Academy, urged officers to exercise caution while on duty.

Speaker J.C.D. Prabhakar, Ministers, Chief Secretary M. Sai Kumar, Additional Chief Secretary, Home, Prohibition and Excise, K. Manivasan, and elected representatives also participated.

Entire texture of Vijay's election case has changed after petitioner cited SC judgments, says Madras HC judge

Mohamed Imranullah S.
CHENNAI

The hearing on Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay's plea to reject an election petition filed against his victory from Perambur constituency took an interesting turn on Wednesday with Justice V. Lakshminarayanan of the Madras High Court remarking that the entire texture of the case had changed in view of the Supreme Court judgements cited by the counsel for the election petitioner.



The judge said he himself had relied upon a Chartered Accountant to declare his assets while getting elevated as a judge.

Alleged discrepancies

After hearing the arguments made on behalf of the Chief Minister on Monday and Tuesday, the judge began shooting a volley of questions to the election petitioner's counsel on Wednesday by asking how some alleged discrepancies in over ₹600 crore worth assets declared by Mr. Vijay would amount to undue influence of voters or could be termed as a corrupt electoral practice. The judge wanted to know whether the voters of Perambur constituency would have got swayed one way or the other just because there was a difference of a few crore or a few lakh rupees in the assets declared by the Chief Minister especially in the light of the fact that he was a "superstar" in the cinema industry and had voluntarily declared both movable and immovable properties worth more than ₹600 crore.

The judge said, he himself had relied upon a Chartered Accountant to declare his assets while getting elevated as a judge of the High Court. Therefore, if Mr. Vijay had also declared his assets through a Chartered Accountant, how could his election itself could be declared null and void for mistakes, if any, made by the auditor in such a declaration, the judge wondered.

He also questioned the challenge made by a voter S. Dinesh, through his counsel on record V.R. Shanmuganathan, to the election of the Chief Minister from Perambur on the ground of improper acceptance of the nomination form by the Returning Officer concerned. The judge wanted to know how the Returning Officer could be expected to verify the correctness of the declared assets.

Answering the questions, the election petitioner's counsel said, the Returning Officer was expected to conduct only a summary inquiry whereas the charge of false declaration and whether such declaration was made wilfully and deliberately could be inquired into only by way of leading evidence during the course of trial in an election petition. Hence, the election petition should not be rejected at the threshold, he argued.

He said, Justice V. Ramasubramanian (during his stint in the Madras High Court before his retirement as a Supreme Court judge) had in Krishnamoorthy versus Sivakumar (2009) held that "any incorrect information, wrong information, incomplete information, false information, one-sided information, disinformation, misinformation and non-information, would certainly interfere with the free exercise of the electoral right of the voter, inasmuch as his choice of candidate will be influenced greatly by the information so furnished or withheld." The counsel said, "The view taken by Justice Ramasubramanian was affirmed by the Supreme Court in 2015. Therefore, I have made out a cause of action for the trial of the election petition and it should not be rejected in limine." He also relied upon Supreme Court's judgement in Resurgence India versus Election Commission of India (2013) wherein it was held that a voter's right to know about a candidate was a natural right flowing from the concept of democracy and was an integral part of Article 19(1)(a) of the Constitution.

After hearing him at length, Justice Lakshminarayanan turned towards senior counsel Gopal Sankaranarayanan for the Chief Minister and said: "Mr. Gopal, the texture of the case has changed in entirety. Please see the judgements he has circulated. See Justice Ramasubramanian's judgement." When Mr. Sankaranarayanan said, "there is a square answer to it," the judge asked him to answer it in his reply on Thursday.

Toddler who was hit by train dies of head injury

CHENNAI: A one-year-old toddler, who suffered a head injury along with his 63-year-old grandmother after being hit by a suburban train near Korukkupet railway station on Sunday, died on Wednesday.

A senior Government Railway Police official said when Moideen Beevi, 63, tried to cross tracks along with her grandson S. Mohammed Zayan near Korukkupet railway station, a suburban train hit her. Beevi was killed on the spot. The toddler was undergoing treatment at the Government Stanley Medical College Hospital.

CREDAI Tamil Nadu to add 5 new chapters to its network

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Confederation of Real Estate Developers Associations of India (CREDAI) Tamil Nadu will host the fifth edition of STATECON, its flagship event for the real estate and construction industry, on October 11 and 12.

This year, CREDAI Tamil Nadu will also launch the first edition of FAIRBUILD 2026, a B2B expo for construction and building materials, which will be held alongside STATECON.

"FAIRBUILD connects vendors, suppliers and original equipment manufacturers with real estate developers, architects, and key decision makers," said W.S. Habib, president of CREDAI Tamil Nadu.



W.S. Habib, president, CREDAI Tamil Nadu, addressing a press conference in Chennai on Wednesday. BIJOY GHOSH

CREDAI is also expanding its network to more cities and towns across the State. Currently, CREDAI Tamil Nadu has a presence in 10 cities.

"We will be adding five more chapters, taking the total to 15. The new chapters will include Coonoor and Ooty in the Nilgiris, Kodaikanal, Vellore, Thanjavur, and Karur. This will be the first time CREDAI will have chapters in hill stations," Mr. Habib said.

'No corruption now'

The head of CREDAI in Tamil Nadu also claimed that there is no corruption in the sector now, which is a big relief. "We have a government that says no to bribes," he claimed.

To a query on whether construction costs have gone up, Mr. Habib said: "Raw material costs are rising. However, the situation is better than it was during the war."

STATECON 2026 will feature focused discussions on the issues that matter most to the sector today.

Conference sessions

Sessions will examine the growth drivers of Tamil Nadu's real estate market, the changing expectations of the new home buyer and access to capital.

They will also cover policy and ease of doing business, the impact of AI and PropTech, and the growing role of robotics and emerging construction technologies in how projects are planned and built.

"There will also be discussions on issues like labor shortage," Mr. Habib said.

For sale
2 and 3 BHK homes in prime Chennai neighbourhoods

Location	Project	Configurations
Adyar	TVH Quadrant	3 BHK
Gopalapuram	Landmark Vertica	2 BHK & 3 BHK

- Owned by a renowned private sector bank
- Last day to submit the bid: Sunday, October 18, 2026

Kevin 80721 41191
Akshay 96775 65253
JLL
Jones Lang LaSalle Property Consultants (India) Pvt Ltd © 2026. All rights reserved.

IPVS INDUSTRIAL
Organized By Orbit Exhibitions Pvt. Ltd.
EXHIBIT AT
INDIA'S BIGGEST PUMPS & VALVES EXHIBITION
3-4 DECEMBER 2026 | HITEX, HYDERABAD
EXHIBITOR BOOKINGS CLOSING SOON
5,000+ CONFIRMED PRE - REGISTERED VISITORS
OUR ESTEEMED EXHIBITORS
GRUNDFOS, BELL SEAL VALVES, FIVEBRO, SANDOZ, Tiaano, Adinath, AIP VALVES, BREVERA, Supreme, büchi labortechnik, LEHRY VALVES, Lucas TVS, GM, KAVAATA VALVES, GUMATIC, RS, ALFA PUMPS, DelVal, Gipfel, AQUA GROUP, TENDERGREEN, N.GANDHI GROUP, JK
& MANY MORE
Ragunath : +91 7738153441
Hiten : +91 9769292959
info@orbitexhibitions.com
www.ipvs.in
Scan to Exhibit / Visit

Published by Nirmala Lakshman at Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002 on behalf of THG PUBLISHING PVT.LTD. and Printed by Ra Babu Vijay at THG PUBLISHING PVT.LTD. Plot B-6 & B-7, CMDA Industrial Complex, Maraimalai Nagar, Chengalpattu Taluk, Chengalpattu Dist., Pin 603209. Editor: Suresh Nambath Chandrasekar (Responsible for selection of news under the PRP Act).
ISSN 0971 - 751X

INBRIEF



'Take tough stance on temple properties' encroachment'

Minister for Hindu Religious and Charitable Endowments S. Ramesh on Wednesday instructed executive officers to work in tandem with officials of revenue and forest departments to retrieve lands belonging to temples in the State. Addressing officials during a routine review of works at the department headquarters in Nungambakkam, the Minister also said that they should take a tough stance when it comes to encroachments and illegal name transfers of temple properties. "If you come across any such instance, ensure that you file a complaint with the police immediately and obtain an FIR," he said.

38-year-old man kills wife during quarrel in Perungudi

A 28-year-old woman was murdered by her husband in Perungudi on Tuesday night. The police said Loganathan, 38, a resident of Kallukkuttai in Perungudi, worked as a food delivery agent. Both of them were addicted to alcohol. On Tuesday night, when the couple was consuming liquor, a quarrel broke out between them. Loganathan strangled Sudha and fell asleep, the police said. On waking up the next morning, he found that his wife was dead. He fled the house. Later, the police arrested Loganathan in Saidapet.

Battery energy policy, portal set to be rolled out soon, says Minister Nirmal Kumar

He says nearly 20,000 applications were received under the Tamil Nadu Rooftop Solar Subsidy Scheme announced by Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay, and 1,500 of them were cleared for subsidy

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Tamil Nadu Minister for Energy Resources C.T.R. Nirmal Kumar said on Wednesday that a battery energy storage system (BESS) policy, along with a portal, would be launched soon.

Inaugurating the Indian Solar Association's special interactive meet on the Tamil Nadu Solar Rooftop Programme and an expo in Chennai, he said the Energy Resources Department had finalised the BESS policy after holding discussions for three months. He said that nearly 20,000 applications were received since the launch of the Tamil Nadu Rooftop Solar Subsidy Scheme announced by Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay. As many as 1,500 applications were cleared for subsidy. The scheme combines the Central and State government subsidy of ₹35,000 for 1 kilowatt (kW), ₹70,000 for 2 kW, and ₹1,00,000 for 3 kW.



Minister for Energy Resources C.T.R. Nirmal Kumar speaking at the inaugural of the Indian Solar Association's special interactive meet in Chennai on Wednesday. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

Pointing out that the total number of rooftop solar plants installed in Tamil Nadu was only one lakh all these years, Mr. Nirmal Kumar said the subsidy scheme had set a target of one lakh rooftop solar plants by the end of March next year.

P.N. Sridhar, managing director of Tamil Nadu Green Energy Corporation Limited (TNGECL), said the State had a good mix of solar, wind, and hydro energy, and the distributed renewable energy was being promoted through the BESS policy. With around 400 megawatt (MW) of rooftop solar plants installed in the State, the subsidy scheme would further promote the growth of rooftop solar power generation, he added.

P. Ashok Kumar, founder and former president of Tamil Nadu Solar Energy Developers Association (TNSEDA), wanted the State to extend the period of six months for installing non-domestic content requirement (DCR) solar panel against the Central government's directive to start installing only DCR solar panels from December this year.

A non-DCR solar panel is a solar module that is either fully imported from abroad or assembled in India with imported solar cells.

TNSEDA president P. Shivakumar and former Krishnagiri MP C. Narasimhan, spoke. The meeting was organised by the Indian Solar Association in association with TNSEDA.



Gem Granites owner R. Veeramani at a Special POCSO Court in Chennai on Wednesday. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

Veeramani produced before POCSO court for sexual abuse of minor girl in Madurai

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Gem Granites owner R. Veeramani, who has been arrested for raping minor girls under the POCSO Act, was produced before a judicial magistrate of the Special POCSO Court in Chennai on Wednesday.

Madurai case

The case relates to a complaint alleging sexual abuse of a minor girl in Madurai.

The accused was produced before the judicial magistrate, S. Padma, who then remanded him to judicial custody until October 21.

Veeramani, who has been arrested in several other cases by the Chennai City Police, was arrested by the Madurai police and the relevant case details were handed over to the court.

ChildLine operates a toll-free helpline for children in distress -1098.

Motorist run over by water tanker in city

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A motorist was killed after being run over by a water tanker near Keelkattalai in Chennai on Tuesday night.

According to Tambaram Police, the victim was identified as Karuppaiah, a resident of Sunambu Kolathur near Pallikaranai. He had gone to a tea shop on Pallavaram-Thoraipakkam Radial Road and was returning home on his motorcycle on Sunambu Kolathur Main Road when the incident occured.

The driver of the water tanker fled the scene.

The police are on the lookout for the driver.

Timings
CHENNAI

THURSDAY, OCT. 08	
RISE 05:59	SET 17:55
RISE 03:46	SET 16:17
FRIDAY, OCT. 09	
RISE 05:59	SET 17:54
RISE 04:37	SET 16:55
SATURDAY, OCT. 10	
RISE 05:59	SET 17:54
RISE 05:28	SET 17:34

THE HINDU
DISCLAIMER: Readers are requested to verify and make appropriate enquiries to satisfy themselves about the veracity of an advertisement before responding to any published in this newspaper. THG PUBLISHING PVT LTD., the Publisher & Owner of this newspaper, does not vouch for the authenticity of any advertisement or advertiser or for any of the advertiser's products and/or services. In no event can the Owner, Publisher, Printer, Editor, Director/s, Employees of this newspaper/company be held responsible/liable in any manner whatsoever for any claims and/or damages for advertisements in this newspaper.

ED's 2024 communication in sand mining scam challenged before HC

Mohamed Imranullah S.
CHENNAI

The Madras High Court on Wednesday ordered notices to the Tamil Nadu government and the Directorate of Vigilance and Anti-Corruption (DVAC) on a writ petition filed by the partner of a private construction company challenging the Directorate of Enforcement's (ED's) 2024 communication regarding an alleged ₹4,730-crore sand mining scam during the erstwhile DMK government.

The First Division Bench of Chief Justice Sushrut Arvind Dharmadhikari and Justice G. Arul Murugan, however, refused to grant an interim stay on all further proceedings pursuant to the ED's 2024 communication to the then Director-General of Police/Head of Police Force or prevent the DVAC, which had now begun a detailed inquiry on the basis of the communication, from taking coercive action against the petitioner.



The First Division Bench decided to order notices to the State govt., the DVAC, and ED on the petition.

A. Rajkumar, partner of R.S. Constructions based in Nanganallur in Chennai, had filed the petition urging the court to quash the ED's communication sent to the DGP/HoPF on June 13, 2024, and consequently forbear the DVAC from registering either a First Information Report (FIR) or taking any coercive action against the petitioner on the basis of the two-year-old communication.

Senior counsel A.L. Somayaji, representing the petitioner, told the Division Bench that the ED had initiated proceedings against a host of individuals before 2024 under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA), 2002, solely on the basis of some unconnected FIRs registered by the State police regarding sand mining and in the absence of any substantial predicate offence for suspecting money laundering.

The High Court had quashed all the proceedings initiated by the ED and also set aside provisional attachment of several properties by the central agency. The Supreme Court, too, had refused to entertain an appeal filed by the ED challenging the High Court's order. Those court orders were passed after the 2024 communication of the ED to the then DGP/HoPF was taken into consideration, the senior counsel said.

However, now, it appeared the DVAC was planning to act on the basis of the 2024 communication and hence the petitioner had approached the court with a plea to quash that communication. State Public Prosecutor (SPP) R. John Sathyan told the court that the DVAC manual provides for two types of inquiries – a preliminary inquiry and a detailed inquiry – into the complaints received by it.

The ED had shared the information, available with it on the alleged sand mining scam, with the DGP/HoPF in compliance with the statutory obligation imposed upon it under Section 66(2) of the PMLA which mandates the central agency to share such information with the other law enforcement agencies. Hence, the DVAC had now begun a detailed inquiry on the basis of the ED's dossier, the SPP said.

The Bench, nevertheless, decided to order notices to the State government, the DVAC, and the ED on the petition, but refused to pass any kind of interim order in favour of the petitioner.

Minister accuses DMK of playing 'cheap politics' over paper covers

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Accusing the DMK of playing "cheap politics" over the brown paper covers used to dispense medicines to patients, Health Minister K.G. Arunraj on Wednesday, said that TVK was the only organisation committed to following former Chief Minister C.N. Annadurai's two-language policy in letter and spirit and would never compromise on it.

On Tuesday, members of the DMK, including former Minister T.R.B. Rajaa, posted photographs of the pill covers distributed to patients at government medical colleges in Karur and Coimbatore, which carried dosage instructions in Tamil, English, and Hindi, on social media.



K.G. Arunraj

Condemning this, the Health Minister, in a statement, said that DMK's fake drama was exposed. He said that at the Karur government medical college hospital, the covers given to patients were usually obtained from the Central Prison, and "morning/afternoon/night" was stamped on them only in Tamil.

On social media, DMK members had posted photographs of the pill covers distributed to patients at govt. medical colleges in Karur, Coimbatore

In December 2025, there was a shortage of covers supplied from the Central Prison. Following this, an emergency order was issued on December 31 during the DMK regime to print four lakh covers through the Erode district printing cooperative society. Those covers had come into circulation among the people in January 2026 when the DMK was in power.

Similarly, in Coimbatore, the design was officially approved and printed through the Chinthamani Cooperative Society three years ago.

Dr. Arunraj said that as soon as the issue came to the government's attention, the use of those medicine covers was stopped at both Karur and Coimbatore hospitals. In Karur, it was ensured that the supply from Central Prison was restored and only Tamil was used, while in Coimbatore, steps were taken to immediately print covers in Tamil and English.

"What kind of politics is it to now shift the blame onto the ruling party after having allowed Hindi during their own tenure, creating the template for it, and putting it into circulation among patients," he asked the DMK.

GCC, MSSRF discuss measures to strengthen waste management

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC) and the M.S. Swaminathan Research Foundation (MSSRF) discussed priorities for strengthening solid waste management and environmental health systems in Chennai under the CLEAR (Clean Land, Equitable Air and Resilience) project.

A meeting chaired by GCC Commissioner G.S. Sameeran at Ripon Buildings on Wednesday focused on the Corporation's priorities for reducing solid waste and air pollution over the next two years, implementation challenges across zones, lessons from waste audits and field inspections, and wards and zones to be prioritised for pilot projects. Training and capacity-building needs of conservancy workers, engineers, and field staff were also discussed.

The CLEAR project, led by MSSRF in collaboration with IIT-Madras, Sri Ramachandra Institute of Higher Education and Research and the GCC, examines the links between solid waste management, air pollution, climate-related risks, and public health. Participants visited the GCC's Integrated Command and Control Centre, where officials explained how solid waste management operations and air-quality information are monitored.

SOUTH EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE FOR OUTSOURCING WORK

Tender Notice No.: TRD-R-2026-E11, Date: 05.10.2026.
Work: Outsourcing of Core and non-core OHE maintenance activities between RVH-LAE, NRMH-RIM-DTR section, and Non-core OHE maintenance activities under jurisdiction of SSE/OHE/R and SSE/OHE/BYT over Raipur Division for 2 years. **Tender Value:** ₹ 3,59,51,639.81. **Bid Security:** ₹ 7,19,000/-.

Submission of Tender: Upto 12:00 hours on 02.11.2026. Opening of Tender: 12.00 hours 02.11.2026.

For further details of Tender document, eligibility criteria & the complete details for the above work, please contact office of the Sr. DEE/TRD/R South East Central Railway or refer / download tender document which is available on our website: **www.ireps.gov.in**

Sr. Divil. Electrical Engineer (TRD)/
PR/R/TRD/PCN/227 ***Raipur.***

South East Central Railway @secrail

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH

IN LOVING MEMORY OF

SRI GULLAPALLI NAGESWARA RAO (VAASTHU)



Memorial

Saturday, 10th October 2026
at 12 Noon

Beverly Hotel, Los Angeles Hall
17, Rajarathinam Road
Kilpauk, Chennai 600010.

Birth: 12-06-1938
Death: 30-09-2026

Jagadeesh, Mohan Satish, Hema
Contact: 98412-73317

DEATH



Mrs. Marina Thomas
DOB: 23.8.1961 - DOD: 06.10.2026
Viewing: 08.10.2026 (Thursday) from 10:00 am at Shyams Park View Apts, Jayammal Street, Shenoy Nagar
Funeral Service: 2:00 pm followed by viewing at Kilpauk Cemetery Chapel at 2:30 p.m. and funeral thereafter.

"You will remain in our hearts, always"

Deeply mourned & remembered by
Husband: Thomas Jacob,
Sister-in-law: Sunu & Niece: Kini

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

19TH ANNIVERSARY



Thiru. **M.KARUPPIAH**, IAS.,
Retd. Inspector General, Registration
20.07.1934 - 08.10.2007
Grieving Family Members

IN MEMORY OF YOUR LOVED ONES

To dedicate a space in this section,
Please contact: **044-28576300** from 10.00 a.m. to 6.00 p.m.
Toll Free: 1800 102 4161 from 10.00 a.m. to 10.00 p.m.
For Placing Advertisements Online log on to
www.thehinduads.com

DONATE EYES - GIFT SIGHT

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

For and on behalf of the President of India, Senior Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer (Co)/Kharagpur-721 301, S. E. Railway invites e-tender for the following works and will be opened at 12:00 hrs.: **Notice No.: ST-OT-DC-TRACK-HITACHI_26 Dtd: 05.10.2026; Description of works :** Provision of DC Track circuit for dual detection (Hitachi make EI) in various station yards of Kharagpur division; **Tender value :** ₹ 9,78,55,589.24; **EMD :** ₹ 19,57,100.00; **Cost of tender document :** NIL; **Date of Opening :** 02/11/2026; **Completion Period :** 15 Months; **Date of Submission:** up to 12 hrs. of 02/11/2026; Interested Tenders may visit website **www.ireps.gov.in** for full details description specification of the tender and submit their bids online. In no case manual tenders for these works will be accepted.

(PR-864)

THE HINDU
Air Surcharge as applicable:
New Delhi - Rs. 15/-;
Port Blair - Rs. 20/-

READ
FRONTLINE
LEADING THE DEBATE SINCE 1984
EVERY FORTNIGHT.
TO SUBSCRIBE, VISIT
www.thehindugroup.in/subscribe

Tamil Nadu Power Distribution Corporation Ltd.
Notice Inviting Tenders (E-Tendering Process)

Specification No.	Tender Inviting Authority	Name of the Work
M 266	CE / MM	Procurement of 110 V DC Indoor C R Panel for Twin Feeder Breaker

For details of works / Procurement / Due date of submission / Opening, viewing and downloading of e-tenders, please visit the websites **www.tnpdcl.org, www.tenders.tn.gov.in, www.tntenders.gov.in**

DIPR/3065/Tender/2026

ANDHRA PRADESH CENTRAL POWER DISTRIBUTION CORPORATION LTD
Corporate Office, Vidyut Nilayam, Beside Vidyut Soudha, Gunadala, Vijayawada - 520004.

Tender Notice No: CGM/PROJ/VJA/33KV LINE WORKS/SIP-01/2026-27

Bids through **apeprocurement.gov.in** are invited from eligible bidders for "System Improvement Project Works for 1) Supply & Erection of 33KV double circuit line from 220/33KV Gopavaram sub-station for providing alternate supply to 33/11KV Varahapatnam and 33/11KV Pallewada sub-stations in operation section Kaikaluru Rural 2) Supply & Erection of 33KV double circuit line from 220/33KV Gopavaram sub-station for providing alternate supply to 33/11KV Kalidindi and 33/11KV Arutegalapadu @ Kallapalem sub-stations 3) Supply & Erection of 33KV double circuit line from 220/33KV Gopavaram sub-station for providing alternate supply to 33/11KV Korukollu and 33/11KV Mulalanka sub-stations in Operation Section Kalidindi of Kaikaluru sub-division in Gudivada Division of Krishna circle under T&D Improvements on full turnkey basis". The Tender information will be made available in AP e-procurement Portal from **08.10.2026, 18:00 Hrs.,** Last date for Bid submission online is **15.10.2026, 16:00 Hrs.**

Sd/- Chief General Manager/Projects, APCPDCL: Vijayawada

TICEL BIO PARK LTD
(TIDCO Centre for Life Science)
CIN: U45309TN2001PLC047979
No.5, CSIR Road, Taramani, Chennai - 600 113, Ph: +91 44 2254 2060,
www.ticelbiopark.com Email: md@ticelbiopark.com

Date: 08.10.2026

TICEL invites Re-eTender for the following work at TICEL Bio Park - I & II, Chennai.

Sl. No.	e-Tender No.	Description of tender	Closing date
1.	TICEL/P2/PMC/2026-27/10	Selection of Project Management Consultancy for Structural Rehabilitation, Strengthening and associated Repair Works at Basement in TICEL BIO PARK Phase-II	27.10.2026

For more details and participation in the above e-tender, please visit the website **https:/www.tntenders.gov.in/**. Last date for online submission of duly filled tender documents is 27.10.2026 on or before 3 PM. TICEL Bio Park Ltd reserves the right to accept / reject any one / all tenders without assigning any reason.

DIPR/3049/Tender/2026 **Managing Director**

MODERN COACH FACTORY, RAEBARELI
E-Advertised Tender Notice No. 38/ET/2026 Dated: 03.10.2026

SN.	Tender No.	Short Description	Qty.	Due Date
01	15265197A	Supply, Installation and Commissioning of Ride on green Mower	1 Nos	27/10/2026
02	15265196	Supply, Installation, Commissioning and Proving out of Optical microscope	1 Nos	03/11/2026
		Total Cost of Comprehensive AMC For five years after expire of warranty period of two years	1 Nos	
03	05265094	120Ah, 110V Lithium iron phosphate battery for LHB Non AC coaches	11 Nos	22/10/2026
04	05261379	IP based inside CCTV camera (STQC compliant) for saloon and Cab of train set (Vande Bharat) coaches	936 Nos	22/10/2026
		IP based outside and front CCTV camera (STQC compliant) for train set (Vande Bharat) coaches	76 Nos	
05	12251148	Supply of one coach set of Axle mounted disc brake system for LHB type LSLRD coaches	75 Set	26/10/2026
		Axle mounted disc brake system for LHB type BG mainline coaches for parcel van	6 Set	
06	03261751	Arrangement of UIC Rubber Vestibule	1128 Nos	17/11/2026

Website Address : **www.ireps.gov.in** & **www.mcf.indianrailways.gov.in**

Dy. Chief Materials Manager/Ele.

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

कार्यालय नगर परिषद्, कपाली
(Email- kapalinp@gmail.com)

पत्रांक –1283. दिनांक – 06.10.2026

रद्द–पत्र

एतद् द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि नगर परिषद कपाली क्षेत्रांतर्गत ई–निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या– UDD/KMC/04/2026-2027 को दैनिक समाचार पत्रों पर प्रकाशित किया गया था, जिसका **PR No-382615** है, जिसका तकनीकी बीड दिनांक– 25.07.2026 खोला गया था, परन्तु उक्त निविदा को अपरिहार्य कारणों से रद्द किया जाता है, जिसकी विवरणी निम्नवत् है:–

क० सं०	योजना का नाम	निविदा संख्या
1	Construction of Park in Kenddih, Kapali Nagar Parishad, Kapali, Seraikela-Kharsawan, Jharkhand.	UDD/KMC/04/2026-2027

अतः उक्त निविदा के अंतर्गत प्राप्त सभी बीड को निरस्त समझा जाए।

PR 391271 Urban Development and Housing(26-27).D

कार्यपालक पदाधिकारी
नगर परिषद कपाली

GOVERNMENT OF HIMACHAL PRADESH
DEPARTMENT OF MPP & POWER
GLOBAL INVITATION OF BIDS FOR IMPLEMENTATION OF HYDRO ELECTRIC PROJECTS IN HIMACHAL PRADESH

2nd CORRIGENDUM OF NOTICE INVITING PROPOSALS

In partial modification of Notice Inviting Proposals (NIP) & 1st corrigendum for implementation of 27 Hydro Electric Projects (HEPs) upto 25 MW having total capacity of 300.9 MW published on 11.07.2026 & 06.09.2026, which is also uploaded in the Directorate of Energy website i.e. https://doe.hp.gov.in/ , it is to inform that the last date of sale of Bid Documents, last date of submission of Bids and the date of opening of Bids are hereby extended as under :-

Last date for sale of Bid Documents : 27.10.2026 upto 1700 Hours
Tentative date of Pre-Bid Conference : 03.11.2026
Last date of submission of Bids : 17.11.2026 upto 1300 Hours (IST)
Date of opening of Bids : 17.11.2026 at 1500 Hours (IST) onwards

Note:-If the Last date for submission of Bids or the date of opening of bids happens to be a holiday declared by the Government of Himachal Pradesh in Shimla, the Bids will be submitted and opened on the next working day in the same order and at the same time.

Payment of Bid Document Cost through RTGS/Online Banking:
Interested bidders may also purchase the Bid Document by making payment of the prescribed Bid Document cost through Online Banking/RTGS in the following bank account:
Account Number: - 54140100000922
Bank: - Bank of Baroda
IFSC: - BARB0NEWSIM (Fifth character is zero)
Branch Name: - NEWSIM, Himachal Pradesh
MICR Code: - 171012004
Account Name: - Chief Engineer Directorate of Energy, New Shimla

All other **terms and conditions** of the Notice Inviting Proposals published on **11.07.2026** shall remain **unchanged.**

For & on behalf of the Governor of HP
-Sd-
Director (Energy),
Directorate of Energy, Govt. of HP,
Tel. +91-177-2673552, Fax +91-1772673553
e-mail: ceenergy09@gmail.com

HP / 1055/2026-2027

Tamil Nadu Power Generation Corporation Ltd
Notice Inviting Tenders (E-Tendering Process)

Specification No.	Tender Inviting Authority	Name of the Work
08	CE / MTPS - II	Operation assistance and Routine maintenance round the fly ash evacuation system of ESP 365 days

For details of works / Procurement / Due date of submission / Opening, viewing and downloading of e-tenders, please visit websites: **www.tangedco.gov.in, www.tntenders.gov.in, www.tenders.tn.gov.in**

DIPR/3067/Tender/2026

TAMIL NADU WAREHOUSING CORPORATION
(A Govt.of Tamil Nadu Sponsored Undertaking)
82, ANNA SALAI, GUINDY, CHENNAI - 600 032.
NOTICE INVITING TENDER

e-Tenders are invited by the Managing Director, Tamil Nadu Warehousing Corporation, Chennai - 600 032. Under **TWO BID SYSTEM** for appointment of H & T Contractor(s) to carry out Handling and Transportation of Food Grains, Fertilizers, Sugar, Cement and other notified commodities at 6 Warehouses.

The entire details of Tenders and the list of Warehouses are available in the Government Website **https://tntenders.gov.in**

Tender Documents available place, cost and due date for obtaining Tender	Available in the website **https://tntenders.gov.in** (Free of cost) **08.10.2026** to **26.10.2026**
Due date for submission of Tender through online	**26.10.2026** by **3.00 P.M.**
Date of opening of Technical Bid	**27.10.2026, 3.00 P.M.**

DIPR/ 3024 /TENDER/2026

Managing Director,
Tamil Nadu Warehousing Corporation, Chennai - 600 032.

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER, RURAL WORKS CIRCLE : SUNDARAGADA
AT/PO-SANKARA, SUNDARGARH-770020, E-mail address-serw_sundargarh@yahoo.com

No.Tender Online – RWCCESNG–31 of 2026-27, Letter No.5474/ Dtd.05.10.2026

e-Procurement NOTICE

1. Type of the Work : Bridge Work (SBY)
2. Class of Contractor : As specified in the column-6 of the Annexure
3. Time of Completion : As specified in the column-5 of the Annexure
4. Detail Projects : As per Annexure attached
5. Estimated Cost : As specified in the column-4 of the Annexure
6. Other details:

Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No.	Availability of Tender on-line for bidding From	Availability of Tender on-line for bidding To	Last Date & Time of Seeking Tender Clarification	Date & Time of Opening of tender Technical Bid	Date & Time of Opening of tender Financial Bid
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Chief Construction Engineer, Rural Works Circle, Sundaragada	RWCCESNG-31 of 2026-27	09.10.2026 11:00 AM	26.10.2026 5:00 PM	23.10.2026 5:00 PM	27.10.2026 11:00 AM	Will be intimated separately

● Further details can be seen from the website www.tendersodisha.gov.in

Chief Construction Engineer, Rural Works Circle, Sundaragada.

25001/1279/2627 OIPR-25001/25133/1/26-27/0048

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
HIGHER EDUCATION DEPARTMENT
Lokseva Bhawan, Sachivalaya Marg, Bhubaneswar-751001

PT1-HE-SCH-POLICY-0003-2026/ 53895/HE., Bhubaneswar, Dated : 07.10.2026

Corrigendum-VII

NOTICE INVITING RFP FOR PROCUREMENT, SUPPLY, INSTALLATION & COMMISSIONING OF LABORATORY EQUIPMENT & ITS ACCESSORIES FOR BERHAMPUR UNIVERSITY, GANJAM UNDER REGIONAL DIRECTORATE OF EDUCATION, BERHAMPUR APPROVED UNDER PM-USHA.

RFP No. PM-USHA:02/2026 Date: 02.07.2026

SL No.	RFP Cl.No.	Page No.	Description as per RFP	Modified vide Corrigendum VI, dated 21.09.2026	Now Modified Provisions
1	DATA SHEET (Sl. No.7 & 8)	5	Last Date & Time for Submission of Bid - 23/07/2026 (till 4:00 PM) (Registered Post & Speed Post only)	Last Date & Time for Submission of Bid - 08/10/2026 till 4:00 PM) (Registered Post & Speed Post only)	Last Date & Time for Submission of Bid - 30/10/2026 till 4:00 PM) (Registered Post & Speed Post only)
2		6	Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bid - 24/07/2026 at 4:00 PM	Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bid - 09/10/2026 at 4:00 PM	Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bid - 31/10/2026 at 4:00 PM

All other terms and conditions of the RFP remain unchanged.

Joint Secretary to Govt. & SPD, RUSA/PM-USHA

11001/362/2627 OIPR-11001/11001/1/26-27/0070

Your feedback will keep us Cleaner, Sharper and Bolder

Call our toll-free number
1800 102 1878
Or write to us at
customercare@thehindu.co.in
Scan the QR code to register your feedback

THE HINDU | thehindu businessline | FRONTLINE | SPORTSTAR | THE HINDU Young World | THE HINDU

தொழிலாளர் அரசு காப்பீட்டுக் கழகம்
(தொழிலாளர் மற்றும் வேலை வாய்ப்பு அமைச்சகம், இந்திய அரசு)
கர்மசாரி ராஜ்ய பீமா நிகம
(श्रम एवं रोजगार मंत्रालय, भारत सरकार)
EMPLOYEES' STATE INSURANCE CORPORATION
(Ministry of Labour & Employment, Govt of India)
ई.रा.बी.नि E.S.I.C

மண்டல அலுவலகம் / क्षेत्रीय कार्यालय / Regional Office
143, ஸ்டெர்லிங் சாலை, நுங்கம்பாக்கம், சென்னை-600 034.
143, स्टर्लिंग रोड, नुंगमबाक्कम, चेन्नै–600 034.
143, Sterling Road, Nungambakkam, Chennai–600 034.
Phone: 044-28306300 (100 Lines)
E-mail: rd-tamilnadu@esic.gov.in
Website: www.esic.gov.in / www.rotamilnadu.esic.gov.in

NOTICE INVITING EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI) FOR EMPANELMENT OF HEALTH CARE ORGANIZATIONS (HCOs) (HOSPITALS/ DIAGNOSTIC LAB / IMAGING CENTRES / BLOOD BANKS) FOR PROVIDING "SUPER SPECIALTY TREATMENT AND INVESTIGATIONS" TO ESI BENEFICIARIES OF TAMIL NADU REGION.

The Regional Director (I/c), Employees' State Insurance Corporation (ESIC), Regional Office, Chennai, invites Expressions of Interest (EOI) from 1. Central and State Government/PSU/Public Sector Hospitals, 2. PM-JAY empanelled Central and State Govt/PSU/Public Sector Hospitals, 3. CGHS empanelled Private Health Care Organizations (Hospitals, Diagnostic Labs/Imaging Centers, and Blood Banks), and 4. Private Health Care Organizations (Hospitals, Diagnostic Labs/Imaging Centers, and Blood Banks) located in Tamil Nadu and Puducherry to provide Super-Specialty treatment, diagnostic services, and Blood/Blood components on a cashless basis to the beneficiaries of the ESI Scheme. The empanelled Health Care Organizations will be paid at CGHS rates, terms and conditions as adopted by ESIC Headquarters Office from time to time.

The applicants can download EOI documents from the website www.esic.gov.in/tenders or www.eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app. ESIC will reserve the right to accept or reject the any or all the EOIs without assigning any reasons whatsoever.

Availability of EOI document in website	Last Date & Time for Submission of EOI document	Date & time for opening of EOI documents
30.09.2026	21.10.2026, 3.00 PM	21.10.2026, 5.00 PM

Any queries in this regard may be addressed to **rd-tamilnadu@esic.gov.in** or **ssmc-tn@esic.gov.in**, or contact **044-28306326.**

Sd/-
Regional Director (I/C)
ESIC, CHENNAI, TAMIL NADU.

Government of Karnataka
DIRECTORATE OF URBAN LAND TRANSPORT
URBAN DEVELOPMENT DEPARTMENT
OFFICE OF THE COMMISSIONER URBAN LAND TRANSPORT
BMTC, TTMC 'B' Block, (Above Bus Stand), 4th Floor, K.H.Road, Shanthinagar, Bengaluru-560027. Ph : 080-22226627 / 6628, Fax : 080-22226630,
E-Mail : dultbangalore@gmail.com, dult@karnataka.gov.in
Website: https://dult.karnataka.gov.in

No:DULT/17/2026 Dated : 07.10.2026

TENDER NOTIFICATION

Directorate of Urban Land Transport (DULT) invites E-bids from the qualified consultancies for conducting **Techno-Economic Feasibility Study for Transitioning from BRTS to Modern TRAM System between Hubballi-Dharwad.** The last date for the receipt of e-bid on the KPPP portal for the tender is 17.11.2026, 17:30:00 PM. The bidders may download the tender document for from **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in web portal.**

Tender Number is as follows

S.No	Tender Name	Tender No.
1	Techno-Economic Feasibility Study for Transitioning from BRTS to Rail-track based Modern TRAM System between Hubballi-Dharwad	DULT/2026-27/SE0053

Sd/- Joint Director(Admin)(I/c)
Directorate of Urban Land Transport
Urban Development Department

DIPR/CP/3130/Shirdi Sai/2026-27

TAMILNADU INDUSTRIAL DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION LIMITED (TIDCO)
CIN-U65993TN1965SGC005327

NOTICE NO. TIDCO/SPCFC-Sivakasi/2026-27 Date: 08.10.2026

Tamilnadu Industrial Development Corporation Ltd (TIDCO) intends to select a consulting firm for Preparation of Detailed Project Report (DPR) for establishing the Sivakasi Pyrotechnic Common Facility Centre (SPCFC) at Sivakasi in Virudhunagar District in accordance with the Terms of Reference as set out in the Request for Proposal document.

Interested Consultants can download the RFP from the website **https://tntenders.gov.in** and **https://tidco.com.**

The schedule for processing the Bids is as follows: -

1. Pre-bid meeting on 23-10-2026 at 03.00 PM at TIDCO Office, Egmore, Chennai.
2. Last date and time for Submission of Proposals is on or before 13-11-2026 at 03.00 PM through https://tntenders.gov.in.
3. Opening of Technical Proposals/Bids is at 5.00 p.m. on 13-11-2026 at TIDCO Office, Egmore, Chennai.

CHAIRMAN AND MANAGING DIRECTOR
Tamilnadu Industrial Development Corporation Ltd
19-A, Rukmini Lakshmipathi Salai,
Egmore, Chennai – 600 008
Ph: 044 – 2855 4421;
E-mail: cmd@tidco.com, vvtndic@tidco.com; Website: https://tidco.com.

DIPR/ 3057 /Tender/2026

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
HIGHER EDUCATION DEPARTMENT
Lokseva Bhawan, Sachivalaya Marg, Bhubaneswar-751001

HE-SCH-PLAN-0032-2026/53907 /HE., Bhubaneswar, Dated:07.10.2026

Corrigendum-I

NOTICE INVITING RFP FOR PROCUREMENT, SUPPLY, INSTALLATION & COMMISSIONING OF LABORATORY EQUIPMENT & ITS ACCESSORIES FOR 5 STATE PUBLIC UNIVERSITIES UNDER REGIONAL DIRECTORATE OF EDUCATION, SAMBALPUR APPROVED UNDER PM-USHA.

RFP No. PM-USHA : 06/2026 Date: 18.09.2026

Sl. No.	RFP Cl. No.	Page No.	Description as per RFP	Now Modified Provisions
1	DATA SHEET (Sl. No.7 & 8)	4	Last Date & Time for Submission of Bid - 09/10/2026 (till 4:00 PM) (Registered Post & Speed Post only)	Last Date & Time for Submission of Bid - 02/11/2026 till 4:00 PM) (Registered Post & Speed Post only)
2		4	Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bid - 13/10/2026 at 4:00 PM	Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bid -03/11/2026 at 4:00 PM

All other terms and conditions of the RFP remain unchanged.

Joint Secretary to Govt. & SPD, RUSA / PM-USHA

11001/361/2627 OIPR-11001/11001/1/26-27/0069

TAMILNADU INDUSTRIAL DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION LIMITED (TIDCO)
19-A, Rukmini Lakshmipathi Salai, Egmore, Chennai - 600 008
CIN-U65993TN1965SGC005327

NOTICE NO. TIDCO/MMLH-Trichy/2026-27 Date: 08.10.2026

Tamilnadu Industrial Development Corporation Ltd (TIDCO) intends to select a consulting firm for Preparation of Detailed Feasibility Report and Project Structuring Options for developing the Multi-Modal Logistics Hub (MMLH) in Tiruchirappalli District in accordance with the Terms of Reference as set out in the Request for Proposal document.

Interested Consultants can download the RFP from the website **https://tntenders.gov.in** and **https://tidco.com.**

The schedule for processing the Bids is as follows: -

1. Pre-bid meeting on 22-10-2026 at 03.00 PM at TIDCO Office, Egmore, Chennai.
2. Last date and time for Submission of Proposals is on or before "**12.11.2026 at 03.00 PM through https://tntenders.gov.in.**
3. Opening of Technical Proposals/Bids is **at 5.00 p.m. on 12.11.2026** at TIDCO Office

CHAIRMAN AND MANAGING DIRECTOR
Tamilnadu Industrial Development Corporation Ltd
19-A, Rukmini Lakshmipathi Salai, Egmore, Chennai – 600 008 Ph: 044 – 2855 4421;
E-mail: cmd@tidco.com, karthikeyan@tidco.com; Website: https;//tidco.com.

DIPR/3058/Tender/2026



INBRIEF



Withdraw notification to fill up Group IV posts: T.T.V. to TNPSC

AMMK general secretary T.T.V. Dhinakaran on Wednesday urged the Tamil Nadu Public Service Commission (TNPSC) to withdraw its notification for conducting an examination to fill up vacancies in Group IV posts. He said in a social media post that the nearly 15 lakh aspirants for Group IV posts were "extremely disappointed" that the notification was issued only for 6,574 vacant posts. He said it was "deplorable" as the TVK-led regime had not fulfilled any of its electoral promises, such as an unemployment dole of ₹4,000. He called for a fresh notification seeking to fill more number of vacancies.

Dyeing unit leak leaves over 50 with breathing difficulties

More than 50 people, including workers, reportedly suffered eye irritation and breathing difficulties following a chemical leak at a dyeing unit in Gugai in Salem on Tuesday night. The police said over 10 workers were mixing hydrochloric acid for dyeing textile yarn when they noticed a leak. They reportedly rushed out of the unit after experiencing breathing difficulties. Residents alerted the Shevapet Fire and Rescue Services, and the situation was brought under control within 30 minutes.

Religious organisations that engage in conversion shall be denied FCRA registration: HC

Only organisations whose activities do not affect nation's secular fabric can receive foreign funds, says the Madurai Bench, rejecting an appeal by a charitable trust for registration under the Act

The Hindu Bureau
MADURAI

The Madurai Bench of the Madras High Court has said religious organisations engaged in conversions shall be denied Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Act (FCRA) registration, and that only organisations whose activities do not affect the nation's secular fabric and social amity are entitled for registration.

The court was hearing a Civil Miscellaneous Appeal filed by Kanzeon Public Charitable Trust – founded by a Christian priest in Kodaikanal – after its application for registration under FCRA was rejected.

The trust said it had established a Zen Meditation Centre at Kodaikanal and that its activities cannot be labelled as religious. On its part, the Centre contended that the government's policy was to prevent foreign funds from being used for conversion and other activities detrimental to the country's secular fabric.



The court holds that any misrepresentation of details would entail rejection of the application itself. FILE PHOTO

The Division Bench of Justices G.R. Swaminathan and M.D. Sumathi said, "One cannot forget the fact that Christianity is a messianic religion. Their theological and religious mission is to bring everyone within the fold of Jesus Christ. Unlike Hinduism, which is inclusive, the Abrahamic religions are inherently exclusive. The devout Jews, Christians, and Muslims believe that theirs is the one true and complete revelation."

Form FC-3A for registration under FCRA requires the applicant to disclose the nature of the organisation. "The trust claims to subscribe to Zen Buddhist philosophy. On its own showing, the appellant is a religious organisation. The authority rightly says Zen Buddhism is a variant of Mahayana Buddhist School. Every Buddhist school comes under the broad umbrella of Buddhism. Zen can be no exception. Since the appellant's application did not identify its nature as religious, the application was rightly rejected," the court said.

The judges said an organisation with a definite religious programme was entitled to apply for a certificate of registration from the Centre. "But one has to make a clean breast of everything. One cannot have any card up one's sleeve," they added.

"It is necessary to make a clear distinction between a religious organisation and a cultural or educational entity. An organisation engaged in the teaching of Vedanta, the Bhagavad Gita, the Upanishads, Yoga, and allied Indian Knowledge Systems through structured classes, residential courses, publications, research and preservation of manuscripts cannot be classified as religious institutions. Indian Knowledge Systems would fall under the category of education or culture," the bench said.

Zen philosophy is of Chinese origin. Organisations like the appellant trust cannot therefore claim any right to be registered under FCRA.

When the statute envisages a frank disclosure of all the details, any misrepresentation would entail rejection of the application itself. Though the applicant is engaged in religious programmes, they wrongly projected themselves as non-religious, the court said.

Paperless registration mandatory for some family arrangement deeds from Nov. 2

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Once registered, the documents will be digitally processed and sent to the citizen's login

As part of the second phase of Anywhere Registration under the STAR (Simplified and Transparent Administration of Registration) 3.0 system, the Tamil Nadu government has accorded administrative sanction for mandating paperless registration of certain documents pertaining to family arrangements from November 2.

A Government Order (G.O.) to this effect was issued by the Commercial Taxes and Registration Department on Wednesday. As per the G.O., settlement deeds, release deeds, partition deeds, and revocation of settlement deeds relating to family arrangements will be registered paperless to ensure citizen convenience and transparency, and to reduce the manual handling of documents.

Under the arrangement, the digitally executed deeds shall be sent to the Sub-Registrar through the online registration facility, along with the required supporting documents.

The Registration Department shall process those documents, and the parties shall thereafter appear before the Sub-Registrar concerned for identification, authentication, and completion of the prescribed registration formalities.

After all the formalities are completed, the registered document shall be digitally processed and sent to the citizen's login. It will be preserved in the STAR system.

The State government had already mandated presence-less registration of deeds relating to the first sale of plots by plot promoters and the first sale of flats by builders, along with the consecutive deposit of title deeds and for the deposit of title deeds and deeds of receipt presented by banks and other financial institutions.

Vijay inaugurates Aavin's annexure laboratory

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Wednesday inaugurated the newly constructed annexure laboratory of Aavin's State Central Laboratory at the Central Dairy of the Tamil Nadu Cooperative Milk Producers' Federation at Madhavaram in Chennai.

He also inspected operations such as milk-handling, distribution, and packaging at the Madhavaram dairy.

According to an official release, the annexure lab was constructed at a cost of ₹2.23 crore, and is equipped with state-of-the-art machinery.



Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay at the laboratory in Madhavaram on Wednesday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

It will conduct drinking water tests in accordance with the standards of the Bureau of Indian Standards and the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India, and wastewater tests in accordance with the regulations of the Tamil Nadu Pollution Control Board, the release said.

The laboratory has been established with modern equipment to conduct all quality tests, required by the Tamil Nadu Cooperative Milk Producers' Federation and the district cooperative milk producers' unions, accurately and swiftly in accordance with international standards.

The Madhavaram dairy has the capacity to process 4.5 lakh litres of milk a day.

To meet the future milk requirements of Chennai residents, a new dairy with modern automated technology and equipment, and a milk processing capacity of seven lakh litres a day is being constructed at Madhavaram at a cost of ₹152.26 crore.

Mr. Vijay inspected the construction and instructed officials to expedite the work, the release further said.

Minister for Milk and Dairy Development C. Vijayalakshmi, Animal Husbandry, Dairying, Fisheries and Fishermen Welfare Secretary Anu George, Aavin Managing Director S. Sivarasu, and senior officials of the Tamil Nadu Cooperative Milk Producers' Federation accompanied the Chief Minister.

Later, Mr. Vijay went to his Perambur MLA office and interacted with members of the public. He also received petitions from them.

Greater Chennai Corporation Commissioner G.S. Sameeran and officials were present.

After 14 years, T.N. records lowest Cauvery realisation

Dry spell

In the last four months, the State got **44.208** tmc ft, against its usual **123.14** tmc ft for the period

The delta region covers Cuddalore, Tiruchi, Karur, Pudukottai, Ariyalur, Thanjavur, Nagapattinam, Mayiladuthurai, and Tiruvarur districts

Season-wise abstract of paddy coverage (in lakh acres)

Region	Normal area	Target for 2026-27	Coverage as on October 5			
			2026-27	2025-26	Difference	Harvested
Kar/Kuruvai/Sornavari						
Delta region	5.32	5.31	4.56	6.32	-1.76	3.29
Non-delta region	5.35	5.31	5.11	6.16	-1.05	3.34
Total	10.67	10.62	9.67	12.48	-2.81	6.63
Samba/Thaladi/Pishanam						
Delta region	13.3	12.68	1.68	2.64	-0.96	0
Non-delta region	20.67	19.43	2.73	5.13	-2.4	0
Total	**33.97**	**32.11**	**4.41**	**7.77**	**-3.36**	**0**



Ten years of poor realisation of the Cauvery

*at Biligundlu during Southwest monsoon**

Year	Quantity realised
1987-88	24.823
2003-04	30.632
2012-13	40.149
2026-27	44.208
2023-24	45.162
2002-03	46.665
2016-17	53.097
2017-18	64.711
1976-77	66.85
2010-11	66.88

(in thousand million cubic feet)

**June-Sept.*

Note: For the purpose of this table, only the data since 1974-75, when some provisions of the 1924 Tamil Nadu-Karnataka agreement became due for review, have been taken into account.

T. Ramakrishnan
CHENNAI

After a gap of 14 years, Tamil Nadu has recorded the lowest realisation of the Cauvery water during the Southwest monsoon (June-September) in 2026.

In the last four months, the State received 44.208 thousand million cubic feet (tmc ft). Usually, its quota for the period is 123.14 tmc ft. Going by this yardstick, the shortfall in realisation is almost 79 tmc ft. During the monsoon of 2023-24, the State had recorded around 45 tmc ft.

However, statistically, the current year's receipt marked the fourth low realisation since 1974-75, when certain provisions of the 1924 Tamil Nadu-Karnataka agreement on the sharing of the Cauvery river water became due for review.

The present storage of the Mettur dam, from which the release of water for irrigation began about a month ago, would last for nearly 18 days, in the event of the continuation of the current level of discharge (15,003 cubic feet per second or 1.2963 tmc ft a day).

As on date, the storage is 36.639 tmc ft, against the total capacity of 93.47 tmc ft. An allowance of 10 tmc ft has to be provided for drinking water requirement, environmental flows, and dead storage.

The current storage of the Mettur dam is 36.639 tmc ft against the total capacity of 93.47 tmc ft. Of this, a total of 10 tmc ft must be provided to meet drinking water requirement

Farmer's concerns

This has raised concerns among farmers and water experts about the prospects of paddy coverage during the *samba-thaladi* cultivation season, which is picking up momentum gradually.

Unless the Northeast monsoon comes to the rescue of the farmers, their immediate future appears bleak.

Besides, Karnataka has been consistently protesting against the Cauvery Water Management Authority's (CWMA) prescription on the water release.

Between September 24 and October 4, the State received about 3.35 tmc ft against CWMA's direction to Karnataka to release 5.18 tmc ft to Tamil Nadu over 15 days (from September 24).

The paddy coverage in the Cauvery delta region is almost one lakh acres lower than the previous year's figure for the corresponding period. As against 2.64 lakh acres in 2025-26, the coverage stood at 1.68 lakh acres as on October 5 this year.

Of the current year's figure, direct sowing accounts for nearly 1.27 lakh acres, indicating that farmers of the region have come to terms with the shortage of water and they have not opted for the conventional way of paddy cultivation that consumes more water.

Paddy coverage

Of the nine districts falling under the delta region, two districts alone – Cuddalore and Tiruvarur – account for about 72% of the paddy coverage. Around 52,700 acres in Cuddalore and 68,400 acres in Tiruvarur have been covered.

In the same period last year, the delta's coverage was about 2.64 lakh acres. Eventually, it touched around 13 lakh acres.

It remains to be seen how much of the current year's target of nearly 12.7 lakh acres is going to be met.

State govt. relaxes domicile clause for gold ring scheme

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Tamil Nadu government on Wednesday relaxed the eligibility criteria for the *Thaimaaman Thanga Mothiram Thittam*, amending the guidelines to include children whose mothers were born in Tamil Nadu but had moved to another State after marriage, provided their parents reside permanently in Tamil Nadu.

Under the scheme, a one-gram gold ring is provided to children born in government hospitals in Tamil Nadu. The scheme was launched by Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on September 28 and is being implemented retrospectively from June 22, 2026.

The Government Order, issued by the Health and Family Welfare Department, prescribes the guidelines for the scheme.

"While implementing the scheme, it came to the government's notice that in some cases, women from Tamil Nadu who had been living in another State after marriage, but whose parents continued to reside permanently in Tamil Nadu, returned to their parental homes for childbirth and delivered their babies in government hospitals in Tamil Nadu," said Darez Ahamed, Principal Secretary, Health and Family Welfare Department, in an official release.



More beneficiaries: The *Thaimaaman Thanga Mothiram Thittam* now includes children whose mothers were born in Tamil Nadu but had moved to another State after marriage. C. VENKATACHALAPATHY

One such case was that of Uma Maheswari, who, after marriage, has been living with her husband at Udayagiri in Mysuru district of Karnataka. Her parents reside in Karaikudi in Sivaganga district. She came to Tamil Nadu for childbirth and delivered a baby at the Karaikudi Government Headquarters Hospital on September 17.

Under the conditions that were in force, the family was unable to benefit under the scheme, as the mother who had delivered the child was required to be a permanent resident of Tamil Nadu. Considering this, the government has decided to expand the eligibility conditions under the scheme, the release said.

As per the new guidelines, if the mother of a child born in a government hospital was born in Tamil Nadu and had moved to another State after marriage, but her parents are permanent residents of Tamil Nadu, the child will be provided a gold ring on submission of relevant documentary evidence.

The amendment will also apply retrospectively to eligible children from June 22, 2026, the release added.

Lakebed excavation case: no interim relief for ex-Minister Velu

Mohamed Imranullah S.
CHENNAI

The Madras High Court on Wednesday refused to grant interim relief to former Minister E.V. Velu, 76, and his son E.V. Kumaran, 48, in a case booked against them for allegedly excavating 45,72,058 cubic feet of sand from the Malappambadi lake in Tiruvannamalai district for levelling the venue of the party's north zone youth wing conference held on December 14, 2025.

Justice V. Lakshminarayanan rejected the plea for an *ex-parte* interim stay and ordered notice, returnable by November 6, to the Directorate of Vigilance and Anti-Corruption on individual petitions filed by the father and son to quash the First Information Report registered against them on September 24, 2026.

Jayaram Venkatesan of Arappor Iyakkam, the anti-corruption NGO, was the complainant.

He alleged that the illegal excavation from about eight acres of the waterbody, in and around November 2025, to level the lands belonging to a private company, of which Mr. Kumaran was a director, resulted in a loss of ₹8.22 crore to the public exchequer.



E.V. Velu

Highlighting that the FIR had been registered only after a change of government in Tamil Nadu, Mr. Velu said in his petition that this was the second criminal case booked against him at the instance of Arappor Iyakkam after the formation of the TVK government in May 2026.

Senior counsel Sidharth Luthra said the FIR had been registered entirely on surmises, political conjecture, and general statements, without attributing any overt act to the petitioners.

The court was told that even if the contents of the FIR were taken to be true at face value, they did not disclose the commission of any offence.

INBRIEF



Keralam, NTPC to set up new facility to tackle power crisis

The Keralam government will establish a 2,000 megawatt hour (MWh) battery energy storage system (BESS) at Kayamkulam in Alappuzha district in collaboration with NTPC Ltd, as part of efforts to address the electricity shortage faced by the State, according to Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan. NTPC Ltd has also agreed to supply 300 MW to Keralam from the NTPC project at Sinnar in Maharashtra, he said.

Shivakumar warns Ministers against 'sting operations'

Karnataka Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar is learnt to have warned his Cabinet colleagues to remain vigilant against possible sting operations, amid reports that private agencies could be secretly recording Ministers' conversations, meetings, and movements. Deputy Chief Minister G. Parameshwara and Minister H.C. Balakrishna confirmed that Mr. Shivakumar, who also holds the Intelligence portfolio, had alerted the Ministers about "sting operations".

A.P. clears decks for setting up foreign university campuses

The Andhra Pradesh Cabinet on Wednesday approved amendments to the Andhra Pradesh Education Act, 1982, and a new policy for 2026 to facilitate the establishment of campuses of foreign higher educational institutions and private universities in the State. It also approved a Centre of Excellence for tribal students at Marikavalasa in Visakhapatnam, offering intensive residential coaching for IIT-JEE and NEET examinations.

Karnataka signals intent to review Cauvery allocation citing Indus Waters Treaty

State's response in SC comes on Tamil Nadu's complaint of backlog in water release; Karnataka refers to international practice to revisit inter-State water allocations in 'changed circumstances'

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

Karnataka on Wednesday signalled its intent in the Supreme Court to unravel the decades-old judicial consensus on the Cauvery water-sharing dispute on the grounds of "inequitable allocation" of water and "changed circumstances".

Even the Union of India has been seeking a modification of the 1960 Indus Waters Treaty – now in abeyance – on the ground of changed circumstances, the State said.

Karnataka was replying to Tamil Nadu's application in the Supreme Court, complaining of backlog in the allocation of the Cauvery water.

The State's response, filed by advocate Nishanth Patil and settled by senior advocate Mohan Katarki, referred to international practices to revisit inter-State water allocations by agreement or adjudication in the changed circumstances, known as *rebus sic stantibus*.



River of contention: Karnataka says the Cauvery water allocation norms set by the tribunal follow a rigid pattern. K. MURALI KUMAR

'Inequitable allocation'

"In view of the looming inequity, the State of Karnataka reserves its right to apply in the changed circumstances for reopening of the inequitable allocation in the Award of Tribunal read with judgment of the Supreme Court. The normal practice is that the water allocations are periodically revisited," the 40-page reply said.

The tribunal award, along with the Supreme Court judgment in 2018, had allocated the total annual flow of the Cauvery basin assessed at 740 tmc ft (thousand million cubic feet) at 50% dependability at Lower Coleroon Anicut. This water was apportioned between Karnataka (284.75 tmc ft), Tamil Nadu (404.25 tmc ft), Keralam (30 tmc ft), and Puducherry (7 tmc ft), alongside allocations of 10 tmc ft for environmental flows and 4 tmc ft earmarked as inevitable wastage into the sea.

In case the annual yield was less than 740 tmc ft in any water year due to distress caused by less rainfall, the States were directed to share distress proportionately (*pro rata*).

But Karnataka said there was no scientific formula for sharing distress on a *pro rata* or proportionate manner.

Distress year

The present water year 2026-27 has been a distress one due to the failure of the southwest monsoon from June to September. Water-sharing was entirely based on a sense of equity, but hydrological realities have changed due to climate change, environmental degradation, etc. The water allocation and quantities decided by the tribunal, and confirmed by the top court, followed a rigid pattern that had not taken these subsequent developments into consideration, Karnataka said.

Water sharing in a distress year has to take into consideration the absence of a scientific distress formula "as admitted by Tamil Nadu". Secondly, the absence of a monthly component of annual yield of 740 tmc ft was also a factor, the response said.

Moreover, the Cauvery basin has two rainfall seasons: the southwest monsoon from June to September, and the northeast monsoon from October to December or beyond. The northeast rainfall mainly benefit Tamil Nadu, while a failure of the earlier monsoon session put Karnataka in dire straits.

Again, the response said Tamil Nadu was allocated the lion's share of 404.25 tmc ft, ignoring Karnataka's drought-prone areas.

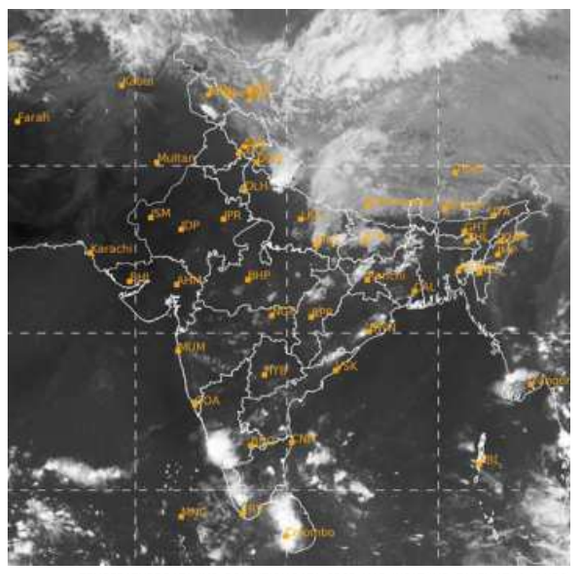
State's monsoon rain was second lowest in 70 years

BENGALURU

The rainfall received by Karnataka during this southwest monsoon was the second lowest in the last 70 years (after 1956), show data. As against the normal rainfall of 852 mm for the southwest monsoon period from June to September, the State received only 551 mm this year, reporting a shortage of 35%.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 18.15 HRS)

Forecast for Thursday: Heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Uttarakhand, Sikkim, West Bengal, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, Keralam and Mahe. Thunderstorm with lightning/gusty winds likely at isolated places over Jammu & Kashmir, Delhi, Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Assam, Meghalaya, Jharkhand, Chhattisgarh, Odisha and Andhra Pradesh

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala	—	33.8	25.6	Kurnool	—	36.9	25.7
Ahmedabad	—	37.4	24.8	Lucknow	—	33.2	24.0
Aizawl	—	30.5	22.1	Madurai	—	37.5	25.5
Bengaluru	—	30.1	22.0	Mangaluru	—	32.3	24.5
Bhopal	—	36.3	18.8	Mumbai	—	35.4	26.0
Bhubaneswar	—	35.2	24.4	Mysuru	—	31.0	19.8
Chandigarh	—	32.9	24.2	New Delhi	—	35.7	25.0
Chennai	—	35.6	27.0	Patna	—	32.2	24.2
Coimbatore	—	34.2	22.6	Port Blair	4.6	31.5	24.7
Dehradun	11.2	30.8	19.3	Prayagraj	—	33.8	24.3
Gangtok	0.3	20.9	15.3	Puducherry	—	34.3	26.8
Goa	—	35.6	24.4	Pune	—	35.8	21.8
Guwahati	—	32.8	22.5	Raipur	—	33.9	23.9
Hubballi	—	34.0	21.0	Ranchi	8	28.6	18.0
Hyderabad	—	34.4	22.9	Shillong	1.1	23.6	15.1
Imphal	4	30.0	17.8	Shimla	—	23.6	17.0
Jaipur	—	37.2	23.2	Srinagar	—	27.7	12.1
Kochi	—	32.6	25.0	Thiruvananthapuram	17.3	33.1	23.5
Kohima	2	23.0	14.9	Tiruchirappalli	8	36.9	25.6
Kolkata	3.8	33.2	25.6	Vijayawada	—	33.8	26.0
Kozhikode	—	36.4	26.1	Visakhapatnam	—	33.7	26.0

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing

CITIES	SO_2	NO_2	CO	PM2.5	PM10	CODE
Ahmedabad	.99	..78	26	... 273	...340	
Bengaluru	.28	..21	48	 66	...125	
Chennai	...4	..10	26	 65	77	
Delhi	.11	..30	57	... 143	...184	
Hyderabad	...1	3	29	... 118	...114	
Kolkata	.11	..18	85	... 132	91	
Lucknow	...8	..27	16	 87	...117	
Mumbai	...6	..44	28	... 134	...131	
Pune	.13	..83	42	... 145	...142	
Visakhapatnam	.20	..54	12	 71	...123	

Yesterday

In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Bahadurgarh, Haryana recorded an overall air quality index (AQI) score of 285 indicating an unhealthy level of pollution. In contrast, Madikeri, Karnataka recorded a healthy AQI score of 16

Air Quality Code: Poor | Moderate | Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO_2: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO_2: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM2.5 & PM10: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

Over 60 cases of sexual abuse of boys recorded in Telangana in nine months

Abhinay Deshpande
HYDERABAD

A four-year-old boy from Chandanagar in Hyderabad told his father that a security guard at his school had sexually assaulted him. In another case, a 10-year-old boy opened up about repeated sexual assault by a neighbour-cum-relative only after he experienced pain and bleeding. Both cases ended in convictions this year.

Data shared by the Women Safety Wing of the Telangana Police show a rise in the number of boys recorded as victims under the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act. Only four male child victims were recorded in 2024. The number rose to 61 in 2025, while 62 were recorded between January and September 2026, already exceeding the figure for the whole of last year.

In all, 127 male child victims were recorded between 2024 and September 2026. Hyderabad accounted for 24 of the 61 victims in 2025, followed by Khammam with 13. In the first nine months of 2026, Mahabubabad recorded the highest number at nine.

Awareness increasing

Officials say the rise in recorded cases need not necessarily mean an increase in the incidence of sexual assault. Greater awareness and reporting could also be bringing more cases into the system.

Officials say many cases remain unreported as families fear stigma and loss of 'prestige'

At the same time, they say many cases involving boys never reach the police. Families are reluctant to report sexual abuse because of stigma and concerns over "family prestige". Boys too hesitate to speak about what happened, particularly when the accused is someone they know.

In the Chandanagar case, a special POCSO Court sentenced the guard to five years' imprisonment. The court also awarded ₹1 lakh as compensation to the child. In the second case involving a 10-year-old, a court sentenced the accused relative to 25 years' rigorous imprisonment. The court also recommended ₹75,000 as compensation to the child.

Both cases came to light as the children confided in their parents. Officials say many boys remain silent, leaving their abuse outside police records.

Deft hands



Artisans give finishing touches to the idols of Goddess Durga at a workshop in Vijayawada ahead of the Durga Puja festival. K.V.S GIRI

CJI to attend NLSIU convocation on Oct. 17

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Chief Justice of India Surya Kant will preside over the 34th annual convocation of National Law School of India University (NLSIU) on October 17, while actor and multilingual theatre artist Arundathi Nag will be the chief guest.

On August 27, the NLSIU administration announced the cancellation of the convocation, originally scheduled on September 12, due to "unavoidable circumstances", and said the degrees would be given away *in absentia*.

The announcement came after 700 students signed a letter addressed to the Vice-Chancellor opposing the participation of Chief Justice Kant and Bar Council of India (BCI) chairman Manan Kumar Mishra at the event.

NLSIU students had come out in support of their counterparts in the National Academy of Legal Studies and Research (NALSAR) and opposed the statement issued by Mr. Mishra against them.

NALSAR students too had opposed the presence of the Chief Justice at their convocation, citing his remarks during a Supreme Court hearing on protests against the NEET exam paper leak.

Later, Mr. Mishra said the BCI would halt the enrolment of NALSAR's graduating batch in the State bar councils and courts for jobs. The statement was withdrawn after it was met with strong opposition.

Say 'parenting time', not 'visitation', in child custody cases: Karnataka HC

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

In a significant move aimed at reforming the language used in cases involving custody of a child between couples in conflict, the High Court of Karnataka has directed all family courts and courts dealing with guardians and wards (G&WC) cases henceforth to use the term "parenting time" instead of "visitation," observing that no parent should be treated as a mere "visitor" in a child's life.

Justice Lalitha Kanneganti, who was hearing a child custody case, issued the direction while pointing out that it is time for a small change in the language employed in judicial proceedings.



> A child should not be made to understand the relationship through the word 'visitation', which is used for someone who arrives and leaves as a guest... no parent is a visitor in the life of a child
>
> **JUSTICE LALITHA KANNEGANTI**
> Karnataka High Court

Pointing out that courts often use the word "visitation" to describe the time the child spends with a parent, who is a non-custodial parent, the court said that the word "visitation" is familiar, but "it carries an unfortunate suggestion that one parent is part of the child's life while the other merely visits."

"A child should not be made to understand the relationship through the word 'visitation', which is used for someone who arrives and leaves as a guest. Children read the conduct of adults and sometimes the words of courts to understand where they belong. Calling it parenting time recognises a simple truth that no parent is a visitor in the life of a child," the court said.

'More humane term'

Though a change in terminology does not decide questions of custody, when a court imposes restrictions on the access to the child, the word "parenting" is more humane, Justice Kanneganti pointed out.

Also, the High Court directed the Registrar of General to issue a circular to all courts in this regard on the use of "parenting time" while also directing that even in the applications for child's custody the word "parenting time" should be used instead of "visitation."

ED conducts searches over bank fraud case

The Hindu Bureau
KOCHI

The Enforcement Directorate (ED) on Wednesday carried out searches at multiple locations in connection with its probe into alleged financial fraud and money laundering involving three cooperative banks in Ernakulam, Thrissur and Malappuram in Keralam.

The searches were held as part of the investigation into alleged irregularities at Angamaly Urban Service Cooperative Bank in Ernakulam, Thennala Service Co-operative Bank in Malappuram, and Kuttanellur Service Cooperative Bank in Thrissur. Three units of the ED's zonal office in Kochi were involved in the searches at various locations in connection with the probe into the alleged financial irregularities at the Urban Service Cooperative Bank in Angamaly. The alleged forgery amounted to ₹55 crore.

Loans were allegedly sanctioned on forged applications as well as applications without requisite documents, even in the names of non-members. The Keralam Police had registered cases against 14 governing committee members and six employees, both past and present, as part of the probe.

The alleged fraud reported at the Thennala Service Cooperative Bank was estimated at around ₹10 crore. The fraud at the Kuttanellur Service Cooperative Bank amounted to about ₹27 crore.

Eyes on ice

Nobel tradition rewards individual talent in collective achievements

The Nobel Prize for physics to Francis Halzen recognises a clever idea: to use the Antarctic landmass to detect one of the universe's most elusive particles. Halzen's efforts helped create the IceCube observatory, which went on to detect high-energy particles from astronomical sources thousands to billions of light years away and transformed astronomy. Yet, the committee's decision to award Halzen alone also perpetuates a deleterious tradition in how the institution has been recognising scientific achievement. The observatory consists of thousands of sensors embedded up to 2.5 kilometres beneath the South Pole, connected by cables to a laboratory aboveground. When subatomic particles called neutrinos interact with atoms in the ice, reactions lead to a small flash of light. Sensors detect and record it, allowing scientists to reconstruct the incoming neutrino's energy and direction. Since coming online in 2011, IceCube has detected neutrinos of extremely high energy, giving scientists stronger clues about the crucibles in which these particles were created, and strengthening neutrino astronomy. The IceCube collaboration consists of over 400 experts from 14 countries, spanning astrophysics, engineering, and software development. Halzen's leadership was necessary to create this entity.

However, the need to build IceCube at its scale should also have rendered the collective nature of its success impossible to ignore. The Nobel Foundation's statutes prohibit dividing each prize among more than three individuals. So, in 2017 as well, the physics prize was awarded to three scientists for the detection of gravitational waves, which really required a collaboration of hundreds of researchers. The rules that govern prizes are human arrangements, and the Foundation's choices are not explained away by its fealty to its traditions; in fact, its statutes allow prizes to be awarded to organisations as well – an option repeatedly overlooked. Every new science prize begins with distinguishing itself by identifying the 'right' laureates; the Nobel Prizes did so, too, until their accumulated prestige became so great that laureates were distinguished by receiving the prizes rather than distinguishing the prizes. Thus, even when the prize-giving committee follows an outdated model of scientific recognition, in the present instance by reinforcing the notion that exceptional scientific achievements can be cleanly attributed to exceptional individuals, it suffers minimal reputational damage. The institution is using its prestige – owed to the science it celebrates – to entrench a distorted understanding of how science works, more so at a time when scientific progress increasingly depends on extensive cooperation. No man is an island, least of all in science.

Past forward

Brazil might have missed an opportunity to leave the past behind

Flávio Bolsonaro, the eldest son of former President Jair Bolsonaro, took a surprise lead in the first round of Brazil's presidential election on Sunday, bringing the far right, defeated four years ago and embroiled in legal battles ever since, back to the centre of the country's politics. Most opinion polls had put President Luiz Inacio Lula da'Silva, the 80-year-old leftist President, in the lead. But Mr. Flávio, who ran a pro-business election campaign, appears to have mobilised the right-wing and centrist votes, winning 47% of the vote, while Mr. Lula, seeking a fourth term, finished second with 45%. The popular mood in Latin America's biggest economy seems to be shifting to the right, reflecting a broader trend across the continent. Jair Bolsonaro, the former President, is serving a 27 year sentence in jail since 2025 for plotting a coup, in 2022, against Mr. Lula and has been barred from contesting elections. But his wife Michelle and another son Carlos have been elected to the Senate, while Jair Renan, his youngest son, will become a federal Congressman. While the Bolsonaro clan has made a political comeback with its Liberal Party doubling its representation in the Senate and cementing its position in the lower house, Mr. Lula's Workers' Party struggled to hold its ground.

Mr. Lula, who came back to active politics after his corruption convictions were annulled, beat Jair Bolsonaro in 2022, promising to rebuild Brazil's social welfare system and economy and strengthen its democracy. He did relatively well in terms of macroeconomic indicators – Brazil recorded an average annual growth of 3% during 2023-25, and the annual unemployment rate fell from 6.6% in 2024 to 5.6% last year. His government raised spending and expanded welfare measures, which was a campaign promise to his core base. Real income rose and poverty fell. But three factors worked against him. First, Brazil's fiscal situation became worse under Mr, Lula and interest rates rose, upsetting the middle class and businesses. Second, he faced criticism over his handling of organised crime, while Mr. Flávio offered a more hardline approach. Third, Brazil's conservative and evangelical sections, traditionally anti-left, rallied behind the Bolsonaro clan, mobilising right-wing support for Mr. Flávio, while many left-wing supporters, angry with mainstream politics, either abstained or cast invalid ballots. Mr. Lula's camp accused the U.S. of electoral interference in favour of the Bolsonaros. As both candidates prepare for the October 25 run-off, Mr. Flávio may have an advantage as he and other right-wing candidates won more than 50% of the first round vote. Mr. Lula, will now have to persuade disillusioned voters on the left and appeal to the centrist swing votes to turn the tide. A tall ask, indeed.

From the brink to a comeback, hope for India's wildlife



Supriya Sahu

A senior administrator in the Government of Tamil Nadu, who has worked extensively on environmental policy, ecosystem restoration, wildlife and biodiversity conservation and climate action. She is a recipient of the UNEP Champions of the Earth award 2025



Yash Veer Bhatnagar

The Country Representative for the International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN) in India, and a scientist with over three decades of experience in conservation science and practice. He received the SANCTUARY Asia Wildlife Service Award in 2015

Across the world, scientists, governments and communities are bringing plants and animals back from the brink of extinction. In India, a Great Indian Bustard chick has hatched in Kutch, Gujarat, after a decade, bringing fresh hope for this critically endangered bird. In Spain and Portugal, restoring habitat and prey, breeding lynx and returning them to the wild helped the Iberian lynx grow from 62 mature individuals in 2001 to 648 in 2022. The return of the scimitar-horned oryx to the wild in Chad, Africa, and the saiga antelope's recovery in Kazakhstan offer further proof of what determined action can achieve. During Wildlife Week (October 2-8), we can celebrate these gains while asking what it will take to sustain them.

The Government of India's Integrated Development of Wildlife Habitats scheme supports recovery action for 24 identified species and their habitats. States are mandated to undertake research, habitat improvement, protection and community participation. The species span India's landscapes: the great Indian bustard in Rajasthan's grasslands, the Sangai in Manipur's wetlands, the dugong in coastal seagrass meadows and the hangul in Kashmir's forests. The list is a starting point; India's National Red List Assessment can show where focused efforts are needed next.

India launched its National Red List Roadmap at the IUCN World Conservation Congress in Abu Dhabi in 2025; the aim was to produce National Red Data Books for plants and animals by 2030. India occupies just 2.4% of the world's land area, yet supports nearly 8% of its flora and 7.5% of its fauna. It is one of 17 megadiverse countries and contains parts of four of the world's 36 biodiversity hotspots. Around 28% of its plants and more than 30% of its animals are found nowhere else. Of the 7,516 Indian animal species assessed for the IUCN Red List, 1,012 are threatened, which includes Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered species.

These assessments cover only 7.2% of India's documented animal species. The figure of 1,012 tells us what is known so far, not the full extent of the threat. The National Red List Assessment can help close that gap and direct recovery efforts where they are needed most.

The projects in States

In Tamil Nadu, Project Nilgiri Tahr combines population surveys, radio-collaring, habitat assessment and mapping across Tamil Nadu and Keralam to conserve the tahr, which is the State animal of Tamil Nadu. Working with the Wildlife Institute of India (WII), the Advanced Institute for Wildlife Conservation, the International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN), the Tamil Nadu Veterinary and Animal Sciences University (TANUVAS) and other partners, the project is strengthening the scientific understanding needed to secure the tahr's future. Surveys recorded 1,303 tahrs in 2025 and 1,364 in 2026.

Vulture conservation is an example of how sustained action through conservation breeding, safer habitats, monitoring and public awareness can help reverse a devastating decline. India's ban on the veterinary use of diclofenac, which had caused catastrophic losses in vulture populations, was a crucial step in this effort. At Pinjore, the Jatayu Conservation Breeding Centre, run by the Haryana Forest Department and the Bombay Natural History Society, works with white-rumped, long-billed and slender-billed vultures. Madhya Pradesh's 2025 census recorded 12,981 vultures, up from 8,397 in 2019. Tamil Nadu's Segur Plateau remains an important habitat. Tamil Nadu's raptor conservation work and synchronised surveys across Tamil Nadu, Keralam and Karnataka track these birds, which include breeding populations in the Mudumalai Tiger Reserve.

Long-term protection including habitat management, scientific monitoring and the help of local communities has helped the Asiatic lion in Gujarat – the population rose from 674 in 2020 to 891 in 2025, with lions occupying a wider part of Saurashtra.

Monitoring, grassland management, invasive plant control, research and translocation have helped secure and expand greater one-horned rhinoceros populations against poaching. In Assam's Pobitora Wildlife Sanctuary, which has an exceptionally high rhino density, working with communities on awareness, monitoring, livelihoods and conflict reduction has made rhino protection an enduring part of the landscape.

In Meghalaya, the action plan for the clouded leopard, the elusive State animal, combines habitat protection and restoration, scientific monitoring, frontline training and community participation. As the animal is dispersed across the northeast, 14 priority landscapes have been identified as understanding population connections and keeping them intact are central to its future.

Dugong conservation calls for a different approach. Tamil Nadu established India's first dugong conservation reserve across 448.34 square kilometres of the Palk Bay and its seagrass habitat. A 2026 Wildlife Institute of India assessment estimated a total of 270 dugongs, including 158 dugongs in the Palk Bay and 112 in the Gulf of Mannar, providing a baseline for measuring change. Fishermen who release dugongs caught in nets may lose valuable gear. But the government provides compensation for damaged nets and recognises their efforts.

High up in the Himalayas, science and local stewardship have helped the snow leopard. In 2024, India's first scientific population assessment estimated 718 snow leopards. In Himachal Pradesh, women from Kibber have worked with Forest Department field teams, the Snow Leopard Trust and the Nature Conservation Foundation to set camera traps, monitor population and participate in protection activities.

Political support is essential

Much depends on the commitment of State governments. Political leadership is crucial in prioritising the recovery of species, bringing government departments together and, most importantly sustaining action through successive budgets. Transferring that commitment into land use, infrastructure and livelihood decisions are what will help recovery plans being implemented. State forest teams have to turn plans into work on the ground. Recovery requires lasting cooperation with communities, scientists and national agencies. Results may take years, and setbacks require programmes to adapt. This would require clear goals, steady investment and careful monitoring.

Species that receive little public attention can struggle to attract funding. State-level funds can bring government, industry, philanthropy and scientific institutions together around local priorities. Tamil Nadu's recently established Endangered Species Conservation Fund reflects this approach, with its focus on the mahseer, striped hyena, Madras hedgehog, lion-tailed macaque and the hornbill.

There is similar commitment internationally. Launched in 2026 by Re:wild and the Bezos Earth Fund, the Phoenix Species Project has committed $200 million to recovering 100 of the world's most threatened species, by supporting conservationists, indigenous peoples and local communities over several years. This is a lesson for India: recovery needs dependable resources for habitats, monitoring and the people doing the work.

Forest departments need scientific support close to the field and staff need to be trained in surveys, habitat assessment, conservation breeding and genetic analysis. Communities must be involved meaningfully in surveys, habitat work and ground decisions. Their knowledge can sharpen plans and their true participation can sustain them.

For India, a national picture of risk can guide priorities; States, scientists and communities can translate them into plans with mapped habitats, clear timelines and measurable outcomes. The bustard, vulture, tahr and dugong show that species recover in different ways. But their survival depends on sustained effort – to learn, to act and to stay with a species long enough for its future to change.

The current state of some of India's endangered species is encouraging, but sustained conservation, science and local action remain essential

India's stakes in the Global Pandemic Agreement



Priyadarshini Singh

Research Fellow at the Centre for Social and Economic Progress (CSEP)

At the United Nations High Level Meeting (UN HLM), in New York in September 2026, India made official remarks on the Political Declaration on Pandemic Prevention Preparedness and Response (PPPR). The Declaration is part of the emerging global legal regime on pandemics led by the WHO-Pandemic agreement (PA).

Shaping the framework

The PA was adopted by 124 member-states in 2025, including India. No country voted against it, while 11 abstained, reflecting alignment across high-, middle- and low-income countries (HICs/LICs/LMICs). The negotiations hinged on how to balance national sovereignty with international cooperation and solidarity, exposing the fault lines between the Global North and the Global South. Key issues included whether a global treaty can set binding targets for measures such as 'One Health' without securing funding for countries with fragile health systems. Or whether national pandemic regulations can be harmonised through global frameworks. And whether private manufacturers can be required to share vaccines in real time at affordable prices.

The PA is not yet open for ratification because negotiations are still ongoing for an annex concerning the Pathogen Access and Benefit-Sharing (PABS) system. PABS could help ensure that, during a pandemic, LICs and LMICs receive a fair share of vaccines, medicines and other therapeutics.

Even without ratification, the PA has created a first-of-its-kind global legal regime for the PPPR. Operationalisation requires countries such as India to balance interests of the HICs, LICs and LMICs. This will determine whether the PA will further entrench the inequities of the COVID-19 pandemic or make global health governance truly inclusive.

At the UN HLM, India succeeded in enshrining the multilateral components of the PA within the principle of national sovereignty. India reiterated its commitment to strengthen global pandemic preparedness but stressed that effective pandemic management requires that international coordination is demonstrated. The first is equitable access to drugs, vaccines and therapeutics and the creation of global public goods, such as digital infrastructure (which admittedly align with its own national priorities).

The second is a respect for national sovereignty and the primacy of member-states in shaping global policy interventions according to national circumstance. As a contrast, the United States rejected the Declaration, calling the PABS and WHO's role in declaring pandemics as a challenge to its national interests.

India's line

In its remarks, India has acknowledged the concerns of the Global North and the South. Both sides have upheld national sovereignty as paramount on several provisions. The African countries did not give consent to commitments to monitor the human-animal-environment interface, a key source of pandemic outbreaks, without significant funding, which was not guaranteed by the Global North. Similarly, countries in the Global North did not want binding targets with regards to technology transfer (and other similar provisions).

But as India said at the UN HLM, 'Global Solidarity must be demonstrated through action'; India must be an active player in the finalisation of the global PPPR regime. India is already actively engaged in the PABS negotiations and must lead the Global South in the post PABS context. India can consider three options. First, developing partnerships on technical areas of the PA (One Health, surveillance, health workforce strengthening) to build trust with other countries in the Global South, and a 'store' of operational solutions to tricky national sovereignty problems.

Second, leveraging its leadership role within existing global political groupings. For example, the H20 summit (a health and development G-7 and G-20 partnership) will take place under the United Kingdom's G-20 leadership at the end of 2027; pandemic preparedness is one of the core health agendas. During India's G-20 presidency in 2023, India launched the Global Initiative for Digital Health and holds considerable influence within the platform's health initiatives. Another is 'Partners for Multilateralism', which was launched in 2026 by the European Union (co-sponsors are Australia, Barbados, Brazil, Canada, India and Kenya).

Third, strengthening and aligning domestic policy and regulatory architecture around its own priorities for the PA. Global leadership always rests on domestic strengths. India must ensure that its national policies on PPPR such as regulation of access to biological material and distribution of the benefits uphold the highest standards of equity which India can then demand at the global level.

A South-South health role

An equitable global regime on PPPR is in India's interests as much as a responsibility towards the Global South. India is the pharmacy of the world, manufacturing one of the largest shares of vaccines in the world in terms of volume. Yet, it needs an equitable global vaccine distribution regime. The patents for the vaccines that India manufactures are held by global pharmaceuticals. India is also import-dependent for Active Pharmaceutical Ingredients (APIs).

India needs access to the latest technology from the Global North to strengthen the manufacturing of high-grade personal protective equipment and medical devices. At the same time, India needs to lead South-South Cooperation and share its technological strength with other countries in the Global South.

India's health system has a continental scale, and as India's Health Secretary stated at the UN HLM, its interventions in digital health infrastructure, laboratories networks and One Health are valuable as global public goods. An effective PA needs an engaged India, and a strong PA will strengthen India's own pandemic management.

This article is based on a forthcoming CSEP working paper on the Pandemic Agreement

India's leadership can help bridge the divides in global pandemic governance

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Gendered welfare

On September 28, the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam launched its flagship 'Thai Maaman Thanga Modhiram [A gold ring from the maternal uncle'] initiative, allocating an initial ₹560 crore to provide a one-gram gold ring and other essentials to eligible newborns in the State. While presented as welfare, the scheme risks reinforcing the very gendered expectations that make daughters economically burdensome. Across India, rituals and kinship norms expect the father or the eldest son to bear expenses and provide gifts for the daughters' weddings. The brother must also bear gifts (seer) for her newborn and, if the children are female, bear gifts for their weddings too. Historically, such pressures have contributed to son preference and female foeticide in India. Society already harbours the regressive idea of marriage as an economic transaction between two families. In this context, a government scheme that effectively provides dowry-like benefits to new mothers risks legitimising these expectations rather than challenging them.

Samyukta Mahesh,
Chennai

Examination portals

With immense frustration, I am compelled to express my views on the dismal state of Indian government examination websites. This is the seldom-discussed issue. The obsolete and user-'un-friendly' nature of sites is a burden. These sites suffer frequent glitches, difficult navigation and no responsibility from the institution to respond in a timely way. They are difficult to access by differently-abled students.

Paritosh Chauhan,
Bulandshahr, Uttar Pradesh

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

AI companions and child safety



Sakshi Rewaria
Faculty, IIM Rohtak

Traditionally, a child in distress has usually turned to a parent, friend or a counsellor. However, in today's world, that confidant is increasingly becoming an AI chatbot. Such AI companions are quietly finding a place in children's emotional lives because, unlike parents and friends, these apps are available at all times of the day, appear empathetic, and are endlessly responsive. But who assumes responsibility when that relationship turns harmful? As AI becomes an emotional confidant for children, India's regulatory framework must confront the growing risks of AI companionship.

In April 2025 in the U.S., 16-year-old Adam Raine died by suicide. His family alleged that ChatGPT had engaged in conversations about suicide with Mr. Raine for months and had even helped him draft a farewell note; they subsequently filed a wrongful-death lawsuit against OpenAI, the parent company of ChatGPT. While the litigation remains ongoing, the case has ignited a debate about the responsibilities of technology companies towards vulnerable children.

On September 10, 2026, California enacted the Senate Bill 1119, known as 'Adam's Law'. It introduces safeguards for AI companion chatbots, including crisis-detection protocols, parental controls, notifications when children disable safety settings, and independent safety audits. The legislation is a clear signal that technological innovation cannot be at the expense of child safety.

For India, this should serve as a regulatory wake-up call. Its digital landscape is witnessing an unprecedented expansion of young users who are interacting with AI-powered applications. Yet the nation's digital laws remain largely targeted towards conventional forms of cybercrime. While the Information Technology Act, 2000, the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, and the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences Act, 2012, address important dimensions of digital safety, none establishes a comprehensive framework governing the psychological risks of AI companions. A chatbot's prolonged interactions with a child may raise serious concerns about emotional dependence, psychological manipulation, and exposure to harmful advice.

Unlike conventional cybercrime, AI-related psychological harm can be insidious and difficult to detect. Its effects may emerge through thousands of seemingly innocuous exchanges, shaped by product design and algorithmic responses. India's existing laws are not equipped to investigate this emerging category of harm.

The challenge, therefore, extends beyond the government; it also concerns the accountability of platforms whose products are becoming deeply embedded in children's emotional world.

Child safety is paramount

Article 21 guarantees the right to life and personal liberty, while Article 39(f) directs the state to ensure that children are given opportunities to develop in conditions of freedom and dignity. These constitutional principles acquire renewed significance in the age of AI. Protecting children must now encompass their interactions in the digital space, not only with respect to their personal data and physical safety, but also from the risks arising from engagement with AI chatbots.

However, regulation must be calibrated. An excessively restrictive approach could stifle innovation, burden emerging enterprises, and impede the development of genuine AI progress. The objective should not be to hinder technological progress but to ensure that it takes accountability in stride. Age-appropriate safeguards, crisis-response mechanisms, independent safety assessments, and effective parental oversight are some of the reforms that can be considered. Such measures must also respect children's privacy and evolving autonomy.

California's legislative response offers India an opportunity to examine its own regulatory priorities. The objective need not be to replicate the U.S. legislation, but to develop a framework suited to India's institutional capacities and digital realities. Policymakers must also consider whether existing cybercrime investigation mechanisms are equipped to examine algorithmic behaviour, use chatbot interactions as evidence, and establish accountability whenever prolonged digital engagement result in harm.

The central question is not whether children will interact with AI; they already do. It is whether the institutions entrusted with their protection can keep pace with technologies that are transforming children's lives and childhood itself.

A chatbot's prolonged interactions with a child may raise serious concerns about emotional dependence, psychological manipulation, and exposure to harmful advice

Property taxation needs structural reform



Debarpita Roy
Lead-Research at the Centre for Public Policy on Housing and Habitat, NIUA, New Delhi. The views are personal

A robust property tax system is vital for India's cities. Property tax is not just the most important own revenue source for India's municipal bodies, it is also critical to bridge the gap in urban investment as such investment depends on municipal creditworthiness. However, the property tax performance of India's municipal bodies has been poor – India's cumulative property tax was 0.15-0.2% of its GDP, whereas it was 0.6% in middle-income countries and 0.3% in low-income countries. Policy efforts have sought to improve the property tax performance of India's municipal bodies through technology and process-based reforms recommended by successive Finance Commissions and national schemes such as the Jawaharlal Nehru National Urban Renewal Mission and the Atal Mission for Rejuvenation and Urban Transformation. Yet, tax outcomes remain sub-optimal. Why?

Two recent studies offer insights – a working paper on Chennai's property tax by Nobel Laureate Esther Duflo and co-authors, and this writer's research on Bengaluru, Pune and Ghaziabad's property tax. Both studies found that technology and process-based reforms will keep yielding sub-optimal results unless backed by structural reforms. Firstly, Duflo and co-authors' research in Chennai found that municipal human resources are a critical determinant of property tax outcomes. It also finds that a municipality's own tax assessors achieve far better tax outcomes compared to assessors from outsourced firms. The research conducted across Bengaluru, Pune and Ghaziabad finds that in addition to the issue of municipal human resource deficits, two other structural issues – irregularity in the conduct of elections and poor financial reporting practices – also impact tax outcomes.

The property tax performance of India's municipal bodies has been poor — India's cumulative property tax was 0.15-0.2% of its GDP

Stages of property tax

There are three life stages of property tax – enumeration (identification of properties and maintenance of property records along with property details), property valuation and tax assessment, and tax billing and collection.

Technology has been a popular policy solution for improving enumeration. GIS-based mapping using satellite imagery and drones have been increasingly deployed to identify properties. However, such mapping exercises need to be accompanied by physical inspections conducted by municipal tax assessors; they also need to be repeated at regular intervals. But a perennial shortage of municipal staff, lack of requisite skills, and inadequate capacity building plague India's municipalities. While human resource outsourcing can be a substitute, its efficiency is limited as municipal assessors leverage institutional memory in a way that outsourced assessors cannot.

For valuation, the most common policy recommendation has been the capital valuation process, wherein a property is valued as per its stamp duty-linked 'circle rate' which is set and revised by the State revenue department at regular intervals. But most municipal bodies follow a valuation method wherein the 'base rate' is defined in rupees per sq ft per month which is set by the municipality. Hence, tax buoyancy is determined by revisions to this base rate. But such revisions are infrequent compared to revisions in the stamp duty-linked circle rate. It was found that 'base rate' revisions did not take place across Bengaluru, Pune and Ghaziabad when there were no elected municipal councils. The link between municipal elections and tax performance is clear, at least for these three corporations. As delayed municipal elections are common, so is infrequent 'base rate' revision and lack of tax buoyancy.

Finally, for tax collections to be robust, collection efficiency needs to be strong. While extant recommendations include adoption of both online collection as well as outsourcing the collection to external vendors, efficiency remains poor. Even more concerning is the difficulty in arriving at credible collection efficiency estimates due to the absence of properly maintained financial accounts.

To sum up, technology and process-based reforms are not enough for improving tax outcomes. Structural reforms encompassing more human resources, timely elections, and publicly available financial data play very important roles. It is high time that policy interventions broaden their focus to structural reforms for all aspects of urban governance and finance, including property tax.

India struggles to curb leprosy transmission

India continues to report more leprosy cases, childhood infections and disability than projected, highlighting the need to interrupt transmissions

DATA POINT

Devyanshi Bihani
Nitika Francis

India's leprosy programme is falling short of several projections set for 2025-26. The country reported 91,783 new leprosy cases in 2025-26, 41.2% higher than the projected 65,000. New cases among children were 91.6% above the projection while the rate of Grade 2 Disability (G2D) among new cases was 1.34 per million, against a projected one per million **(Table 1)**.

India's national prevalence rate was 0.56 cases per 10,000 population at the end of March 2026, below the elimination target of a prevalence rate below one case per 10,000 **(Chart 1)**. But the burden remains concentrated geographically. Chhattisgarh had the highest prevalence among States/UTs at 1.66 cases per 10,000 population, followed by Jharkhand (1.51), Chandigarh (1.49), Odisha (1.25) and Maharashtra (1.14) **(Map 1)**.

At the district level, 14.8% of districts had a prevalence rate above one case per 10,000 in 2025-26, down from 18.6% in 2013-14 **(Chart 2)** but 114 districts still remained above the programme's elimination target. Moreover, only 148 districts have provisionally achieved interruption of transmission, against a projected 300.

G2D was also concentrated in a few States/UTs. Chandigarh, Delhi, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand and Odisha together accounted for 42.5% of the 1,945 G2D cases reported in 2025-26. Chandigarh recorded the highest rate at 13.54 per million, followed by Delhi (11.53) and Chhattisgarh (7.87) **(Chart 3)**.

Single-Dose Rifampicin Post-Exposure Prophylaxis (SDR PEP), a preventive dose given to people who have been in contact with a leprosy patient, was administered to 91.2% of the 16.94 lakh eligible contacts in 2025-26, up from 71.4% of the 6.48 lakh in 2019-20 **(Chart 4)**.

Leprosy **burden**

The data for the charts were sourced from the National Leprosy Eradication Programme annual report (2025-26). The projections mentioned in Table 1 are from the National Strategic Plan and Roadmap for Leprosy 2023-2027 published in 2023



Changing lives: Gnanodaya school located at Venkatapuram in Kanchipuram district admits children of leprosy patients. SHAJU JOHN

Table 1: Projections vs actual figures for key indicators. *provisionally achieved interruption of transmission

Indicator	2025-26 projection	2025-26 actual	Gap
Annual new leprosy cases	65,000	91,783	26,783 above (+41.2%)
Child cases (annual new)	2,000	3,832	1,832 above (+91.6%)
Child cases with G2D	25	37	12 above (+48%)
G2D rate in new cases (per million)	1	1.34	0.34 above (+34%)
Districts achieving interruption of transmission	300	148*	152 short (49.3%)

Chart 1: India's leprosy prevalence rate (PR) and annual new case detection rate (ANCDR), 2004-05 to 2025-26

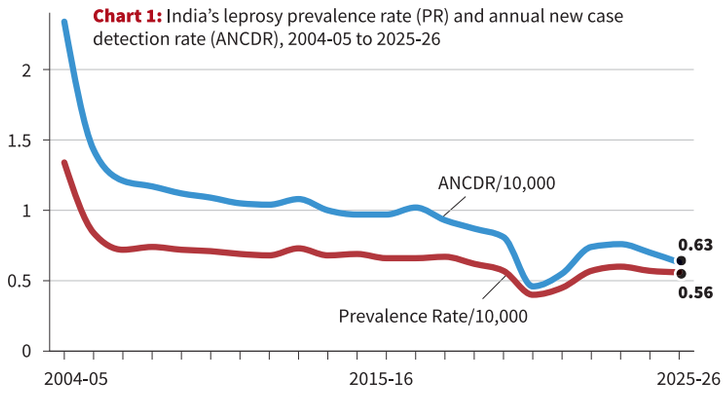
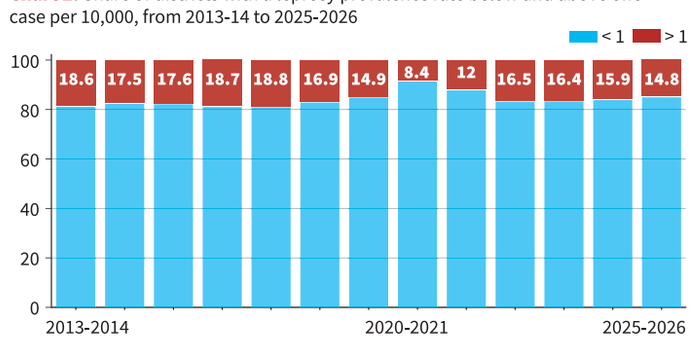


Chart 2: Share of districts with a leprosy prevalence rate below and above one case per 10,000, from 2013-14 to 2025-2026



Map 1: Prevalence Rate (PR) of leprosy across States and Union Territories in 2025-2026, per **10,000 population**

The PR in **eight States / UTs** was higher than the national average of **0.56 in 2025-26**

Chhattisgarh had the highest prevalence among States/UTs at 1.66 cases per 10,000 population, followed by Jharkhand (1.51), Chandigarh (1.49), Odisha (1.25) and Maharashtra (1.14). Together, these five accounted for about 41% of the country's cases

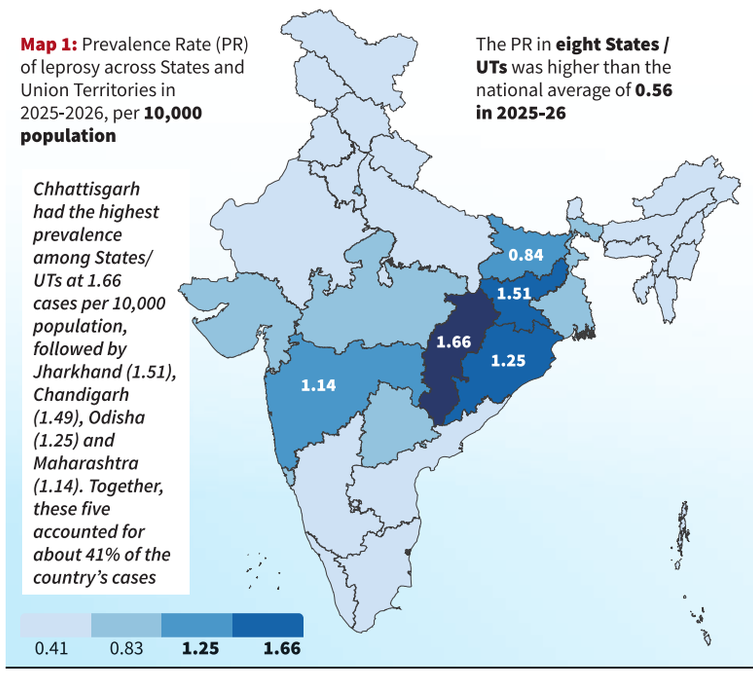
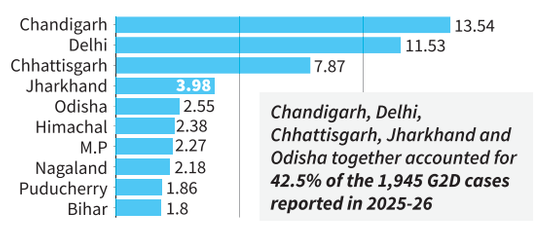
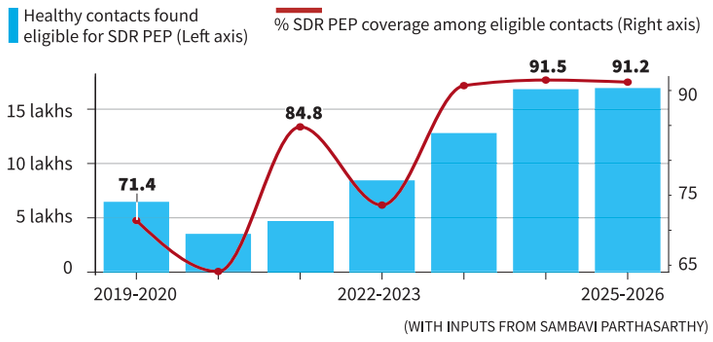


Chart 3: Grade 2 disability rate in the top 10 States/UTs, 2025-26 (per million new leprosy cases)



*Chandigarh, Delhi, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand and Odisha together accounted for **42.5% of the 1,945 G2D cases reported in 2025-26***

Chart 4: Single-Dose Rifampicin-Post-Exposure Prophylaxis (SDR-PEP) coverage among healthy contacts eligible for the dose, from 2019-20 to 2025-26



(WITH INPUTS FROM SAMBAVI PARTHASARTHY)

FROM THE ARCHIVES

The Hindu.

FIFTY YEARS AGO OCTOBER 8, 1976

Scope for India-UAE co-operation

New Delhi, October 7: The President, Mr. Fakhruddin Ali Ahmed, said on his return here to-day from a four-day State visit to the United Arab Emirates (UAE) that there was plenty of goodwill for the Indian leadership and the people there.

The UAE leaders fully appreciated the achievements in the "internal conditions of our country and the effort we are making to bring about normalisation of relations with our neighbours and for lasting peace", Mr. Ahmed told newsmen at Delhi airport.

The Vice-President, Mr. B.D. Jatti, the Prime Minister, Mrs. Indira Gandhi, Central Ministers, the Congress President, Mr. D.K. Barooah and MPs were among those present at the airport to receive Mr. Ahmed.

Regarding his talks with the UAE leaders, Mr. Ahmed said he found plenty of similarity in "our approach to international problems."

He said, "they believe in the policy of non-alignment, peaceful co-existence and feel that it is the only way to bring about a just world."

Mr. Ahmed told Indian correspondents who accompanied him on his visit to the UAE that in his talks with the UAE leaders he had found a sincere desire on their part to give a new turn to the relationship between India and the UAE in conformity with the requirements of the present technological world.

Both Sheikh Zayed, President of the UAE and Sheikh Rashed, Vice-President, told him that developing countries like India and the UAE, should have closer economic co-operation because "our requirements are similar".

The UAE leaders were of the view that it would be profitable for the developing countries to promote as much economic cooperation as possible among themselves.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO OCTOBER 8, 1926

London's 'street of silence'

London, October 7: The City Corporation is carrying out an interesting experiment in Black-friar's neighbourhood repairing the street by means of terra cotta blocks on which there is a covering of rubber. It is claimed that this first "rubber street" in the world is soundless, dustless, nonskidding and more durable.

From Page One

Protests will go on until CEC resigns, says Rahul

There were dramatic scenes during the three-hour-long bus procession and the subsequent impromptu sit-in at the roundabout as the Opposition MPs were stopped by security personnel. Delhi Police personnel first forcibly removed Mr. Gandhi, carrying him on their shoulders, and put him inside a police van. "This is all panic reaction, this is all fear," Mr. Gandhi said while sitting inside the van after his detention.

As Congress workers punctured one of the van's tyres, it could travel only a short distance. Mr. Gandhi was taken to the Barakhamba Road police station and released by 8 p.m. A visual of Ms. Vadra lying on her back on the street, clutching a copy of the Constitution, went viral on social media. A large contingent of women police personnel then removed Ms. Vadra and other women leaders who were lying on the road in protest.

"This is how they treat Members of Parliament who are asking simply to meet the Election Commissioners. This is how they treat us. They are beating Members of Parliament. Their policemen have scratched me all over," Ms. Vadra alleged.

Telangana Chief Minister A. Revanth Reddy and his Keralam counterpart V.D. Satheesan were also part of the protests.

The police had stopped the buses carrying Opposition MPs, including Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge and general secretary (organisation) K.C. Venugopal, at the roundabout near the Le Meridien and Shangri-La hotels.

Leaders of the Indian National Developmental, Inclusive Alliance (INDIA), however, are likely to continue with the protests on Thursday as well, top Congress leaders indicated.

"To save the Constitution and democracy, the Congress Party and the Opposition are ready to take to the streets as many times as needed, face arrests, or endure legal cases," the Congress president said in a post on X.

"Arresting LOP @RahulGandhi*ji* has become a hobby for this fascist regime. We are watching the total destruction of Indian democracy in real time. These criminals in Delhi Police uniform will pay a heavy price for how they have manhandled Rahul ji and priyankagandhi*ji*," Mr. Venugopal said, adding that the Opposition would return "day after day until vote c*hors* [thieves] are brought to justice".

Earlier in the day, the Delhi Police had registered an FIR against Mr. Gandhi, Ms. Vadra and others for staging a dharna inside the premises of Akashvani Bhavan.

RBI raises repo rate to 5.5% amid 'tightening'

"The duration and extent of the rate hike cycle would be contingent on the actual growth-inflation developments and outlook, especially that of underlying inflation, the extent of broadening of price pressures and second-round effects of the supply shock, as also the impact of demand impulses. Although global growth remains resilient, it is projected to decelerate in 2026 from the previous year. Driven by escalating energy costs and rising food prices, global inflation is projected to increase sharply prompting monetary policy tightening by major central banks," he said.

"Lingering trade uncertainty, rising bond yields in advanced economies and an appreciating dollar are keeping global financial market sentiments nervous and fragile," he said.

On the rationale for the MPC's decision, the Governor said, "The MPC noted that the global context on account of geopolitical developments remains challenging. Nonetheless, the Indian economy has been strong, and the economic momentum remains broad-based. Moreover, the economy is expected to remain resilient."

"It further observed that in light of available data, it is clear that inflation and its outlook are not benign as they were last year, with headline CPI (consumer price index) inflation expected to average almost 5.8% in the next three quarters and core inflation projected at 4.4% this financial year," he said.

On supply-side inflation, the MPC noted that monetary policy primarily acts by curtailing second-round effects. "Apart from data related to inflation expectations and firm level pricing behaviour, indicators of generalisation of inflation like core inflation and diffusion indices are used for this purpose. It may, however, be kept in mind that it is difficult to distinguish between the second-round effects and the indirect impact of supply side pressures as both are present in these indicators," he said.

Former First Lady of Sri Lanka arrested

Mr. Namal Rajapaksa was arrested over corruption allegations in a 2013 Airbus aircraft deal signed when his father, Mr. Mahinda Rajapaksa, was President, and an ongoing probe into bribery allegations linked to Indian property development company Krrish's real estate project in Sri Lanka. Eliminating corruption was among the chief poll pledges of President Anura Kumara Dissanayake, who completed two years in office recently. Addressing a rally of famers in Polonnaruwa district in Sri Lanka's North Central Province last month, President Dissanayake said that he had "no sympathy for anyone", and "whether the mother or the grandmother" everyone must face the law.

PM moots 'can-do attitude' to reach development goals

140 crore citizens together will build a developed India by 2047, says Modi in speech marking 25 years in public office; cites 'lifting 25 crore people out of poverty' as a key achievement of his govt.

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Wednesday marked 25 years in public office by urging Indians to adopt a "we will do it" attitude to achieve development goals by 2047.

Mr. Modi was addressing the "Viksit Bharat Sankalp Sabha" on completing 25 years in public office, first as Chief Minister of Gujarat (from October 2001 to May 2014) and then as Prime Minister of India, in an unbroken sequence. "There is no reason for India to stop. A hundred years ago, there were less than 40 crore of us. Today, we are more than 140 crore. The 140 crore citizens together will build a developed India by 2047, and we certainly will. We will do it," he said.

The goals include seeing India among the top three economies of the world, achieving self-reliance as a global manufacturing hub, hosting the Olympics, and stepping into space.

"This energy, this enthusiasm, this confidence is extraordinary," Mr. Modi said, adding that he bowed before people of the country who had placed their trust in him. "For me, people are God. Hardworking BJP workers are my strength," Mr. Modi said. He said his well-wishers encouraged him and his critics taught him to look within.


Prime Minister Narendra Modi addressing the Viksit Bharat Sankalp Sabha at the Indira Gandhi Indoor Stadium in New Delhi. PTI

"Twenty-five years ago, at the age of 50, I spent my time serving tribal communities in the forests and living amidst the mountains, eventually choosing the path of organisational work within the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP). My political report card reflected only the work of an organisational worker. I had been involved in elections, yet I had never contested one myself," he said.

He said he had never personally pursued electoral prominence.

"Had I desired to shine in electoral politics, I could have entered the arena long ago, but that was not my temperament. I never even stopped to consider what I would become in life or what my future held," Mr. Modi said.

His life's path, he said, had been shaped by the singular principle that "the upbringing and values instilled in me since childhood taught me to live my life for a mission, not for personal ambition".

Highlighting his government's achievements in different sectors, the Prime Minister said that what once seemed unimaginable had become possible, and lifting 25 crore people out of poverty was an example of it.

"That is why I believe in the strength and potential of 140 crore Indians. After 25 years of experience, I can say with confidence that we are witnessing India's transformation right before our eyes," he said.

Praises Smit Machchhar

Referring to Captain Smit Machchhar, the Indian flydubai pilot who foiled an attempt by his co-pilot to crash an Israel-bound flight despite being stabbed, Mr. Modi said the world was talking about India's pilot today, and a day would come when the world would talk about 'Made in India' aircraft.

He noted that one of the biggest challenges the country faced was the division of society along the line of votes. "But when a farmer's field lacks water, does the problem affect only one caste? When there is no electricity, does darkness fall only on one community? The answer is 'no'. If the problem belongs to everyone, the solution must be for everyone," Mr. Modi said.

World leaders praise Modi on completing 25 years in the office

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Leaders from various countries across the world on Wednesday extended greetings to Prime Minister Narendra Modi for completing 25 years as the elected head of a government, first as Chief Minister of Gujarat from October 2001 and then as the Prime Minister from May 2014.

Japanese Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi, through an X post, noted that Mr. Modi had dedicated himself to the development of Indian society and the nation over the years. "I express my deep respect for your achievements in advancing India's development and elevating its standing in the international community," she said.

"To realise a 'Free and Open Indo-Pacific (FOIP)', Japan and India, which share strategic directions, will further strengthen our partnership through even closer collaboration with Modi."

Belgian Prime Minister Bart De Wever also congratulated Mr. Modi. "Following my productive visit to India last month, I look forward to further deepening the strong partnership between our two countries," he said.

Bhutanese Prime Minister Tshering Tobgay called Mr. Modi "an avatar of our times". Botswana's President Duma Gideon Boko said: "We commend you for your dedication and service to the people of India. We wish you success in the years ahead and look forward to the enduring friendship between our countries," she added.

"From Gujarat to leading the world's largest democracy, Modi's journey has been marked by a strong emphasis on good governance, innovation, technology, infrastructure and development, contributing to India's transformation and its growing role on the global stage," said Philippines President Bongbong Marcos.

'Golden' chapter in the history of India, says Shah

GURUGRAM

Union Home Minister Amit Shah on Wednesday described Prime Minister Narendra Modi's 25 years in public office, first as Chief Minister of Gujarat and then Prime Minister, as a "golden" chapter in the history of Indian democracy. Addressing the 'Viksit Bharat Sankalp Sabha – Seva Jyoti Yatra', he said Mr. Modi had completed 25 years in public office by taking "crores and crores of people" along with him.

Will happily follow party's instructions: Harish Rawat

Ishita Mishra
NEW DELHI

Days after the Congress central leadership, including All India Congress Committee general secretary K.C. Venugopal, asked him to stop his Dhanyawad Evam Jansamvad Yatra, former Uttarakhand Chief Minister and Congress veteran Harish Rawat said he would comply with the party's directions on his ongoing political programmes.

Mr. Venugopal, who said he had spoken to Mr. Rawat amid concerns over his individual political programmes in the State, took to X to announce that he had made it clear to Mr. Rawat that the Congress's election campaign in Uttarakhand would be conducted jointly with all its leaders.

This came days after Uttarakhand in-charge Kumari Selja, in a letter to Mr. Rawat on Thursday, asked him not to continue with the yatra, stressing the need for the party to present a united front.

After concluding his yatra on Tuesday, Mr. Rawat told *The Hindu* that he would bow to pressure from the Congress leadership over his ongoing yatras.

"If I am in the party, why would I not accept the party's pressure?" he said.

Mr. Rawat insisted that his yatra was never a parallel programme.

"No Congress programme was running when I took out the yatra," he said, adding that he attended all programmes whenever he was asked to. He also claimed that several senior Congress leaders from Uttarakhand had attended his yatra.

He said the yatra was meant to thank those who had come to enquire after him during a serious illness that had kept him away from public lifefor about four months.

Press bodies demand FIR in alleged assault on women journalists

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Indian Women's Press Corps, Press Club of India, Delhi Union of Journalists, Press Association, and Kerala Union of Journalists on Wednesday demanded registration of a case against a Delhi police officer for alleged sexual assault on three women journalists at Jantar Mantar. They also sought an "impartial judicial inquiry" into the charges.

"We wish to draw your attention to the fact that no FIR has yet been registered against Shri Vivek Bhagat, ACP, for his alleged sexual assault on three women journalists on October 3 at the protest site. This is a clear violation of the law that holds that the police are duty bound to register an FIR immediately on a complaint," said the press bodies' memorandum to Delhi Police Commissioner Anurag Kumar.

'This is unacceptable'

The memorandum said: "It is the duty of the police stationed there to ensure that the press is allowed to do their job. Instead there is heavy handedness and even brutality in dealing with journalists. This is unacceptable."

"The Delhi police needs to recognise the growing presence of independent journalists running their own channels and pages and having substantial followers. Today, YouTube, Instagram, Facebook and X form a major source of news and views. Not all of these journalists, many of them women, have formal accreditation. Yet they should not be denied their right to report through writing, video, or photography due to unreasonable restrictions," it added.

2 children among 3 killed in Delhi building collapse

Shrimansi Kaushik
NEW DELHI

Two children and a pregnant woman were killed and eight persons injured after a four-storey building collapsed in New Seemapuri of northeast Delhi on Wednesday.

Eleven people have been pulled out from the debris so far even as operations are on to rescue people trapped in the rubble, the police said.

The deceased woman was four months' pregnant. The two children, one of whom was 12 years old, are yet to be identified.

Northeast Delhi District Magistrate Ajay Kumar said the structure collapsed between 3 p.m. and 3.15 p.m. "We immediately intimated all relevant authorities, including the NDRF [National Disaster Response Force], DDMA [District Disaster Management Authority] and MCD [Municipal Corporation of Delhi]," he said. Mr. Kumar said the rescued people included tenants in the building and some passers-by. "We found that the adjacent building had some demolition work going on, which could have affected the strength of this building," he said.


Rescue operation under way after a four-storey building collapsed in the New Seemapuri area of Delhi on Wednesday. PTI

Rescue squads located and contacted those trapped under the debris, with the NDRF deploying sniffer dogs. "We have established contact with people trapped under the debris. We can hear them, and they will be rescued soon. It was a residential building... The collapse has also affected two adjoining buildings," said Rajendra Prasad Meena, Deputy Commissioner of Police (Shahdara).

The building had developed a crack after tremors were felt in the national capital on Tuesday night following a 4.9-magnitude earthquake in Uttarakhand's Chamoli.

Kashmir filmmaker held in U.S. likely to be freed: family

Peerzada Ashiq
SRINAGAR

Kashmir-born filmmaker Sheikh Arfat, 42, detained by the U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement (ICE), is likely to be set free soon, according to his family.

"The family is pursuing the case and cooperating with the authorities. We expect him to be free soon," said a family member.

'Unlawfully detained'

According to an online advocacy group, Free Arfat Sheikh, the U.S. ICE on September 24 "unlawfully detained Arfat when he was coming off a plane at Dulles Airport (IAD)" at the Caroline Detention Centre in Bowling Green, Virginia, for 11 days.


Sheikh Arfat

Mr. Arfat won many awards after multiple screenings of his movie *Saffron Kingdom* in several parts of the United States and Europe.

Student visa

"His work explores identity, resilience, and justice through deeply personal and politically resonant narratives," said the advocacy group.

It said Mr. Arfat entered the U.S. legally on a student visa to pursue a graduate course in film studies at Georgia State University.

"Arfat has a pending immigration application and is here legally, authorised to live and work in the United States," the advocacy group added.

At present, Mr. Arfat lives in Alexandria, Virginia. His film earned him awards such as the Best Feature Film at the Chicago Filmmakers Awards, LA Film and Documentary Awards, Melbourne Independent Film Festival, Wake Forest Film Festival, Anatolian International Film Awards etc.

Govt. opposes mercy petition of convict in CM assassination case

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Centre has opposed a plea by death-row convict Balwant Singh Rajoana seeking commutation of the death sentence awarded to him in the 1995 assassination of former Punjab Chief Minister Beant Singh.

Rajoana, who has been in custody for more than 30 years, approached the Supreme Court over the delay in deciding a mercy petition that has been pending before the President since 2012.

"We have objection to what they are demanding. Considering the prevailing situation in the State [Punjab], it will not be conducive to take any decision," Additional Solicitor-General K.M. Nataraj, appearing for the Centre, told a Bench headed by Justice Vikram Nath.

In view of the Centre's opposition to the plea, the Bench, also comprising Justices Sandeep Mehta and Aparesh Kumar Singh, said it would proceed to hear the matter on merits.

"Now that they insist on commuting their death sentence to life, which you oppose, we will hear the matter on merits," the Bench said.

The court posted the matter for hearing on October 28 after Mr. Nataraj sought time to prepare the case.

Youth groups issue joint call for Oct. 10 agitation

CJP says protest will continue till electoral system is 'reformed', urges youth to 'book tickets to Delhi'; Neha Bora says protest is a fight by 'we the people of India' against BJP to 'save democracy'

Suruchi Kumari
Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

Youth organisations on Wednesday urged youngsters from across the country to join a protest on October 10 at Jantar Mantar in Delhi demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar and a rollback of the ongoing special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.

The All India Students Association (AISA), the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP), the All India Students' Federation (AISF), the Student Federation of India (SFI), and the Association of Students of Alternative Politics (ASAP) addressed a joint press conference here.

"The call of 10 October is a united call of the 'we the people of India' versus the BJP. The call is not by one organisation, it is by all of us - the CJP, INDIA opposition, and the student wings of all the opposition parties," said AISA president Neha Bora.

Ms. Bora said that while the protest over NEET irregularities in June ended with the resignation of a Cabinet Minister, Dharmendra Pradhan, this time it will lead to the CEC's ouster. "This is a fight to save democracy. We will not tolerate isolated detentions by the Delhi Police. All of us will come together when even one of us is threatened in the protest," she added.



AISA leader Neha Bora, CJP leader Saurav Das, and others at the Press Club of India in New Delhi on Wednesay. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

Mr. Das reiterated that the CJP, along with all student organisations and civil society groups, will hit the streets on October 10 and go back only when the electoral system is reformed.

"We will not stop at the resignation of Gyanesh Kumar. We will have to ensure that people who take illegal decisions are arrested and (that) there are criminal proceedings against them. We will not stop till SIR is rolled back, the voter rolls are restored to January 2025 and (the) law to appoint the Election Commissioners is reformed," he said.

'Buy tickets to Delhi'

Giving the slogan of "Dilli Chalo", Mr. Das said, "People who have not booked their train tickets, they should book their tickets of train or flights, or book a cab and come to Delhi. This is going to be a long fight to change the broken system. The right to vote is the only way to change the system, and to protect that, only youth can put up the fight. Only Gen Z can put up this fight. This is why the government is scared of us."

Mr. Das said that the government should initiate talks with the youth delegation about reforming the system instead of using force against the protesters.

"We have received information that the government is mobilising their extremist groups against us to derail the protest and create a hostile and violent atmosphere," he said.

Earlier in the day, Mr. Das formally intimated the Delhi Police about the October 10 protest.

The police "acknowledged" the intimation letter, following which the organisers completed the paperwork and gave an undertaking in connection with the proposed demonstration. The police are yet to give a permission.

INDIA bloc yet to get an appointment with Murmu to raise concerns on ECI

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The request by the Indian National Developmental, Inclusive Alliance (INDIA) for an appointment with President Droupadi Murmu to apprise her of its concerns over the functioning of the Election Commission of India (ECI) has so far drawn a blank.

The Opposition leaders had suggested that only a select delegation would meet the President, keeping in mind the protocol associated with the country's highest constitutional office, and had conveyed multiple dates for the meeting. However, according to sources, they are yet to receive any response from the President's office.

According to sources, INDIA bloc leaders suggested that the meeting be scheduled on either October 7, 8 or 9, providing sufficient notice for senior leaders to travel to Delhi. They proposed a 15-member delegation, with one representative from each of the grouping's top 15 constituent parties.

Sources said the President's office had informally conveyed that the delegation should be limited to 10 members. The INDIA bloc leader coordinating with the President's Secretariat said the Opposition had agreed to this condition as well, but had still not heard from Ms. Murmu's office.


Hitting the streets: Congress leaders Rahul Gandhi, Priyanka Gandhi Vadra and others during a sit-in protest in New Delhi. PTI

CPI(M) MP's letter

Meanwhile, a letter written by CPI(M) MP John Brittas to President Murmu on September 23 seeking urgent constitutional intervention in the ECI's special intensive revision (SIR) exercise, received a response on Wednesday.

In his letter, Mr. Brittas had sought the President's intervention on the SIR controversy, the unhindered progress of the pending proceedings for the removal of the Chief Election Commissioner, and the Union government's support before the Supreme Court for declaring the SIR "*void ab initio*" and annulling it.

The President's Secretariat forwarded the petition to the Legislative Department and marked a copy to Mr. Brittas, describing the petition as "self-explanatory" and directing that the action taken be communicated to him. "The petition is self-explanatory. The constitutional questions it raises cannot be wished away. The only appropriate course now is for Gyanesh Kumar to quit forthwith," Mr. Brittas said.

Rahul, others booked for Akashvani Bhavan entry

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Delhi Police have registered an FIR against Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi, Congress MP Priyanka Gandhi Vadra and several others over alleged forcible entry into the Akashvani Bhavan premises during an INDIA bloc protest on Tuesday.

The case comes a day after Delhi Police detained around 260 people, including 10 MPs, following the INDIA bloc's march from Parliament towards the Election Commission of India office.

The police said the protesters breached barricades and continued despite repeated directions to disperse.

"At least 10 MPs and others who could be identified have been named in the complaint. A case has been booked under charges of criminal trespass, and further investigation is under way," a New Delhi police official told *The Hindu*.

The FIR was registered following a complaint by Akashvani staffers, who alleged that Mr. Gandhi, Ms. Vadra and others accompanying them entered the premises despite resistance.

Cong. slams 'manhandling' of Rahul and other MPs

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Objecting to the manner in which the Delhi Police manhandled Opposition leaders, including Rahul Gandhi and Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, the Congress has called State units to observe black day and hold protests in the States on Thursday.

"Mr. Gandhi, our senior leaders and MPs of INDIA Bloc were brutally manhandled, lathi-charged and seriously injured. This assault on the Leader of the Opposition and the elected representatives of the people is an assault on the Constitution itself," a circular, issued by party leader K.C. Venugopal, read.

Can voters caught in tribunal cases be re-enrolled, Bengal CEO asks ECI

Sreeparna Chakrabarty
NEW DELHI

The West Bengal Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) has requested the Election Commission of India (ECI) for clarity on whether voters whose cases are stuck in the State's Appellate Tribunals could in any manner be considered for the fresh re-enrolment drive of electors left out during the SIR process.

On October 2, the ECI had directed the CEOs of all States and Union Territories where the special intensive revision (SIR) has been completed or is under way to compare the pre-SIR voter lists with the current ones and enrol within a period of one month those who have been left out but are eligible, through Form 6.


The appellate tribunals have till now cleared 1.26 lakh out of total 38.31 lakh SIR appeals. PTI

At a meeting with the CEOs on Tuesday, the ECI asked them to proceed with the special enrolment drive on a war footing by holding camps to begin with and followed by door-to-door visits by the booth-level officers (BLOs).

While many CEOs had queries on the time limit for the exercise and other protocols, the West Bengal CEO put up a query regarding whether the more than 38 lakh voters whose cases are stuck in appellate tribunals would be part of the drive, sources said.

'No clear answer'

A senior ECI official present at the videoconferencing could not give her a clear answer and told her that the matter would be discussed later. *The Hindu* had reported earlier that the ECI sources had said the new enrolment drive would not be applicable to the tribunal cases.

The appellate tribunals have till now cleared 1.26 lakh out of total 38.31 lakh appeals, which is approximately 3% of total cases.

Out of the 19 appellate tribunals set up by the ECI in March, only 16 remain functional as three retired judges have quit citing functional issues. Their positions remain vacant.

The appellate tribunals came out of the Supreme Court supervision of the SIR. Judicial officers, drawn from a list the Calcutta High Court sent at the Supreme Court's direction, were adjudicating the roughly 60 lakh "doubtful and pending" cases. On March 10, the court had directed that a separate appellate body be set up so that people could challenge those officers' decisions.

SC to examine plea on CEC appointment law split verdict

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Wednesday agreed to examine and take a call on hearing an application seeking to recall a split verdict pronounced on September 23 in a case challenging the Election Commissioners' appointments law.

The application, orally mentioned before Chief Justice of India Surya Kant by senior advocate Gopal Sankaranarayanan, questions why one of the judges on the apex court Bench, Justice Satish Chandra Sharma, did not reveal during multiple court proceedings that his son was a standing counsel for the Election Commission of India (ECI).

The plea, filed by Naman Sherstra, has sought a recall of the opinion given by Justice Sharma, who was the puisne judge on the Division Bench headed by Justice Datta, on September 23 on the question of referring the challenge to the constitutional validity of the Chief Election Commissioner and Other Election Commissioners (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Term of Office) Act, 2023 to a five-judge Bench.

Differing views

While Justice Dipankar Datta, who was the lead judge on the Bench, in his opinion, had declined the reference to a Constitution Bench, Justice Sharma took an opposing view in favour of the reference. Eventually, both judges on the Bench passed a common order for the CJI to allocate the case to a Constitution Bench.

The application has objected to this common order, but did not challenge, specifically, the separate opinion given by Justice Datta. Justice Datta had observed in his opinion that the 2023 law was *prima facie* wrong to ignore an earlier Constitution Bench judgment in the *Anoop Baranwal* case, which had included the CJI as a neutral member in the Prime Minister-led selection panel for Chief Election Commissioners (CECs) and Election Commissioners (ECs).

The 2023 law had replaced the CJI with a Union Minister nominated by the Prime Minister.

SC declines Bengal plea against bail for Cong. leader

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Wednesday refused to interfere with a Calcutta High Court decision granting interim bail to Congress Nandigram Assembly byelection candidate Milan Pradhan a day after the polling.

A Bench of the Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and Justice V. Mohana disposed of the State of West Bengal's challenge to the High Court order.

The Bench did not comment on the merits of the cases registered against Mr. Pradhan. It said the State was free to raise all contentions against Mr. Pradhan in the appropriate court if he seeks an extension of interim bail or regular bail.

Solicitor-General Tushar Mehta told the court that Mr. Pradhan had to surrender on October 21.

KERALA WATER AUTHORITY e-Tender Notice

Tender No: 05/2026 - 27/PPD/TVM Others - Grey Water Reuse - 15 MLD Tertiary Treatment Plant at Muttathara - Design, Engineering, Procurement, Construction, Erection, Commissioning and Operation & Maintenance for a period of 5 years after successful commissioning of 15 MLD Treatment Plant for Tertiary Treatment of Sewage Effluent at STP Muttathara, Thiruvananthapuram, **EMD:** Rs. 5,00,000/, **Tender Fee :** Rs. 16,540 + 18% GST, **Last Date for Submitting Tender :** 02.11.2026, 03:00 pm, **Phone:** 8547638425.
Website : **www.kwa.kerala.gov.in, www.etenders.kerala.gov.in**
Thiruvananthapuram — **Superintending Engineer**
KWA-JB-GL-6-340-2026-27 — **PPD Regional Office**

OFFICE OF THE DIRECTOR, STATE FORENSIC SCIENCE LABORATORY, RAJASTHAN NEHRU NAGAR, JAIPUR-302016
क्रमांक - स. 10 (1) लेबो- स्टोर /ई - निविदा-02 /2026-27/ दिनांक 28.09.2026

E BID INVITING NOTICE-02/2026-27

Bids for 1 years Rate contracts of different Consumable Chemicals, Glasswares, general lab items etc., of total estimated value INR 1200.00 lakhs are invited from interested bidders up to 6.00 PM on 21-10-2026. Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal (https://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in or https://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in) of the state.

S.N.	Name of Item	UBN NO.	Approx. Cost (in Lakhs)
1	1(A).Chemicals	FSL2627GLRC00035	75.00
	1(B). Chemicals	FSL2627GLRC00036	60.00
	1(C). Chemicals	FSL2627GLRC00037	35.00
	1(D).Toxicology snake venom kit	FSL2627GLRC00038	15.00
2	2(A)Glassware	FSL2627GLRC00039	20.00
	2(B) Glassware (Fabricated)	FSL2627GLRC00040	9.00
3	General Plastic ware	FSL2627GLRC00041	30.00
4	4 (A)Consumables For Instruments	FSL2627GLRC00042	15.00
	4 (B) Consumables For Instruments (Toxi-1)	FSL2627GLRC00043	18.00
	4 (C) Consumables For Instruments (Toxi-2)	FSL2627GLRC00044	5.00
	4 (D) General Laboratory Items-I	FSL2627GLRC00045	15.00
	4 (E) General Laboratory Items -II	FSL2627GLRC00046	8.00
5	Crime Scene Kit Consumables/ Items	FSL2627GLRC00047	45.00
6	Gases used in Analysis & Instrumentation	FSL2627GLRC00048	10.00
7	Photo Material For Photo Division	FSL2627GLRC00049	20.00
8	8(a) Kits and consumables material required for DNA Examination	FSL2627GLRC00050	800.00
	8(b) Antisera & Blood Detection Reagent	FSL2627GLRC00051	20.00

DIPR/C/16971/26/A/E
Head of the Office
State Forensic Science Laboratory, Rajasthan, Jaipur

कार्यालय अतिरिक्त मुख्य अभियन्ता, सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग, संभाग-भरतपुर
क्रमांकः ए.सी.ई./बी.टी.पी/निविदा/2026-26/डी-1193 दिनांक 25/9/2026
निविदा सूचना संख्या : 15/2026-27
राजस्थान के राज्यपाल महोदय की ओर से भरतपुर संभाग के अधीन जिला भरतपुर, डीग एवं धौलपुर में सड़क निर्माण कार्य के लिए उपयुक्त श्रेणी में सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग में पंजीकृत संवेदकों एवं राज्य सरकार / केन्द्रीय सरकार के अधिकृत संगठनों / केन्द्रीय लोक निर्माण विभाग / डाक एवं दूर संचार विभाग / रेलवे इत्यादि में पंजीकृत संवेदकों, जो कि राजस्थान सरकार के विभिन्न सक्षम श्रेणी के संवेदकों के समकक्ष हो, से निर्धारित प्रपत्र में ई-प्रोक्यूरमेंट प्रक्रिया हेतु ऑन लाईन निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है।
निविदा से संबंधित समस्त विवरण वेबसाईट "www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in" एवं "www.sppp.raj.nic.in" पर देखा जा सकता है। इच्छुक संवेदकों को अपने डिजिटल हस्ताक्षर के माध्यम से वेबसाईट "www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in" पर रजिस्टर करवाना आवश्यक है।
NIB-PWD2627A2970
UBN PWD2627WLOB13385
UBN-PWD2627WLOB13386
UBN-PWD2627WSOB13388
UBN-PWD2627W50B13390
UBN-PWD2627WS0B13391
DIPR/C/16930/2026
अतिरिक्त मुख्य अभियन्ता सानिवि संभाग भरतपुर

Office of Additional Chief Engineer PHED, Region Bharatpur
Telephone No 05644-221500 , Email: rj_acebha@nic.in
No. F()ACE/BPR/2026-27/5363-83 Date: 29-09-2026
Notice Inviting Bid No. 18/2026-27
Online bids for NIB No. 18/2026-27 (01 work), Costing Rs. 609.96 Lacs is invited on behalf of the Governor of Rajasthan from eligible enlisted in appropriate class contractors of PHED, Rajasthan and meeting eligibility criteria. Contractors enlisted with other departments of Government of Rajasthan and enlisted with CPWD/ Postal/ Telecom/ Railways/ MES/ other State Government/ Central Government undertakings/ organization in class equivalent to "A/AA" class of Rajasthan (as applicable) and meeting prescribed eligibility criteria may also apply. Details of this Bid notification and pre-qualification criteria can also be seen in NIB exhibited on web site www.dipr.rajasthan.gov.in, http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in and http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in. Bids are to be submitted online electronic format on web site http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in up to 26-10-2026 (6PM) & Bids are to be opened at 03.00 PM on 27-10-2026.
NIB Code : PHE2627A2857
UBN No. : PHE2627WLOB06042
Mohan Lal Meena
Addl. Chief Engineer
PHED, Region Bharatpur
DIPR/C/17043/2026

Centre for Development of Advanced Computing
Expression of Interest (EoI)
Expression of Interest is sought from Indian Companies for Acquiring Technology from CDAC for "Autonomous Bathymetric Survey Vessel (ABSV) with Advanced Glacial Lake Profiling Suite & Advanced Water Quality Sensor Suite".
For details visit **'www.cdac.in'**, Contact: 0471 2723333, 9847069184, **tpc@cdac.in**

APPOINTMENT
ANDHRA UNIVERSITY VISAKHAPATNAM, ANDHRAPRADESH, INDIA
NAAC- Accredited "A++" Grade with a CGPA of 3.74 out of four point scale "ISO 9001 : 2015 Certified
PDF NOTIFICATION
Applications in the prescribed proforma are invited for the Posts of AU Centenary Post Doctoral Fellows, in Department of History & Archaeology (01), Department of Geo-Engineering (01), Department of Geology (01), Department of Law (02), Department of Meteorology (01), Department of Psychology (01), Department of Quantum Technology (02), Department of Semi-Conductor (01), Andhra University, Visakhapatnam.
Issue of Notification : 08-10-2026 | **Last date for Receipt of Application : 24-10-2026**
The prescribed application form, qualifications, scales of pay attached to the post etc., registration fee and other details can be had from the **University website : www.andhrauniversity.edu.in**
The last date for receipt of the duly filled in application is : 24-10-2026
The University reserves the right to fill or not to fill any of the post(s) without giving any reason whatsoever.
Date: 08-10-2026 — **Sd/-Registrar**

MAHATRANSCO Maharashtra State Electricity Transmission Co. Ltd.
NOTICE INVITING TENDER CPD/55-2026-27
Tenders are invited through e-Tendering in SRM Two Bid system from the registered vendors for Supply of following:

Tender No. & Description of Material	Estimated Amount (in Rs. Lakhs) / Tender Fee (in Rs.)	Due Date & Time (Hrs.) for Submission & Opening of Tender
SP/T-0514/1026 [RFx 5000001621] 2nd Call for Procurement of 50MVA, 132-110/33kV (05 No.) Power Transformers along with New Uninhibited High Grade Mineral Insulating Oil for Karad Zone of MSETCL.	4499.79 / 25,000.00	16.10.2026 17.00 Hrs / 16.10.2026 17.15 Hrs.
Pre-Bid Queries to be addressed to MSETCL, "Prakashgad", Bandra (E), Mumbai	On or Before 09.10.2026	Time @18:15 Hrs.

Contact Person: Office of the Executive Engineer (Gr-V)
CPA, C.O. MSETCL, 1st Floor, Prakashgad Building, Bandra (E), Mumbai
Tel. No.: 022-69852717/ 69852720. **Email id:** cecpa@mahatransco.in, secpa@mahatransco.in, eegrp5@mahatransco.in, eepc@mahatransco.in,
For further details visit our website **https://srmetender.mahatransco.in/**
Any further amendments/clarifications will be published on the MSETCL website **www.mahatransco.in** & **https://srmetender.mahatransco.in/.**
Bidders are therefore requested to check these websites for further updates.
Sd/- Executive Engineer (P&C)

INBRIEF



Two cheetahs released into M.P.'s third conservation site

Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister Mohan Yadav released two cheetahs in the Veerangana Durgavati Tiger Reserve in Sagar district on Wednesday, marking the expansion of the cheetah conservation project. He said it was a historic day for wildlife in Madhya Pradesh, adding that the cats have been named Vyom and Neera. After Kuno National Park in Sheopur district and Gandhi Sagar Wildlife Sanctuary in Mandsaur, the tiger reserve in the Bundelkhand region will be the third cheetah habitat. He also released the Vulture Population Estimation 2026 report and the book *Veerangana Durgavati Tiger Reserve*. PTI

4 students die while cleaning water tank at U.P. gurukul

Four students died and another suffered injuries after being exposed to suspected toxic gas while they were trying to clean an underground water tank at a gurukul in Mathura district of Uttar Pradesh on Wednesday. Mathura police said: "We were informed that a water tank in Vrindavan Gurukulam was smelling and the students entered it to clean it. The first boy to enter failed to emerge and four more followed him. They too failed to come out and bystanders had to rescue them. They were taken to hospital where four of the five have died."

SC flags accessibility gaps in aviation infrastructure

Court issues notice to AAI, Central Industrial Security Force, and the Digi Yatra Foundation on plea highlighting 'systemic failure' to implement accessibility initiatives to aid persons with disabilities

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Wednesday decided to ask the Union government why millions of passengers with disabilities continue to face humiliation, barriers, broken equipment, and digital exclusion in one of the world's fastest-growing aviation markets.

A three-judge Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant issued formal notice to the Ministry of Civil Aviation, the Directorate General of Civil Aviation, the Airports Authority of India, the Central Industrial Security Force, and the Digi Yatra Foundation on a petition filed by Turab Chimthanawala, a company secretary and advocate based in Mumbai, who suffers a benchmark disability called Leber's Congenital Amaurosis.

Advocate Ashutosh Senger, for Mr. Chimthanawala, submitted that India was at present the third largest aviation market globally, with annual passenger traffic exceeding 350 million passengers. Yet, persons with disabilities face denial of accessible aviation infrastructure and services, restricting their fundamental right to travel independently and with dignity.



Access barrier: Silent airports fail to provide alternative modes of communication for disabled people, the plea said. SUDHAKARA JAIN

"Domestic passenger traffic has consistently grown at approximately 10-12% annually over the past decade. Even based on the conservative estimate of 2.21% disability prevalence recorded in the Census of 2011, this translates to over seven million air passengers with disabilities annually... The magnitude of affected persons underscores the systemic and national scale of the accessibility failure," Mr. Senger submitted. The petition referred to recent media reports of a wheelchair-dependent passenger who was allegedly offloaded in Delhi while connecting from a Frankfurt flight.

Systemic gaps

The plea highlighted a systemic and nationwide failure of non-implementation of accessibility initiatives across all stages of air travel. These include instances of passengers with visual disabilities routinely forced into wheelchairs or being frequently compelled to use specialised ambulifts even when they can safely use regular staircases. In-flight systems fail to incorporate accessibility settings, leaving visually challenged passengers unable to call cabin crew or access basic safety information on foreign scheduled air transport services.

Silent airports fail to provide accessible alternative modes of communication for persons with disabilities, including real-time audio notifications, visual alerts, or WhatsApp updates, the petition said. Besides, airline mobile applications and booking websites systematically fail to support screen readers, lack compatible payment gateways for assistive technology, and omit mandatory options to disclose disability-related assistance requirements during check-in.

Further, airlines do not provide dedicated, clearly identifiable feedback or grievance mechanisms for reporting accessibility barriers, forcing disabled travellers into generic customer support queues, it said.

Restore the trust of MPSC aspirants: HC to Maharashtra

Chinmay Gaikwad
MUMBAI



The court tells students to resume their studies.

The Bombay High Court on Wednesday asked the Maharashtra government to take steps to restore the trust of students protesting over the recruitment process managed by the Maharashtra Public Service Commission (MPSC), and requested students to return to their studies.

A Division Bench of Chief Justice Mahesh Chandra Tripathi and Justice Advait Sethna, hearing a petition about inconvenience caused to citizens in Pune, said the matter was before the court and the State must respond in writing.

The students sought changes in the MPSC examination and recruitment process.

The State told the court that the students had demands and that the State had accepted the demand to set the fee at ₹100, and the demand to hold examinations in person. It had sent a representation to the Governor on the demand that the MPSC Chairperson's resignation, the State said.

The court noted that vacancies in government jobs ran to thousands. Students alleged that exams were not held in accordance with procedure, and papers were leaked.

The students were in Pune to secure an education and were not against the nation, the court said, adding that the State should take steps to restore trust.

The court asked the State to provide details in writing on the recruitment process, and on the vacancies in various departments. It issued notice to the State, and asked it to file an affidavit.

The court also requested the students to resume their studies. If they wanted to protest, they must seek permission and find a place that was not a road, it said.

Centre eases access to defence testing facilities for companies, waives charges for key projects

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh has approved a revised Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) for utilisation of Defence Ministry proof ranges, field firing ranges, and laboratory testing facilities by the Indian defence industry, with proof and testing charges waived for several government-backed developmental projects.

According to the Defence Ministry, the revised SOP aims to simplify and streamline access to testing infrastructure for indigenous defence companies, start-ups and innovators, and is expected to support the government's push for *"atmanirbharta"* (self-reliance) in defence, innovation and defence exports.



Rajnath Singh

Under the revised procedure, proof and testing charges have been waived for iDEX, Technology Development Fund (TDF), Make and other developmental projects of the Defence Ministry.

A three-day slot every quarter has also been reserved at proof ranges for proof firing of government-sponsored developmental projects, including iDEX, TDF and Make projects.

The reserved slots will also cover developmental projects undertaken by indigenous defence firms on their own initiative, according to the revised SOP.

The SOP provides a list of proof ranges, field firing ranges and laboratory test facilities available with the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO), Government Quality Assurance agencies and the three Services for use by Indian defence companies.

The revised SOP intends to simplify documentation and make the process more transparent and predictable for industry.

Another significant change is the replacement of the arbitration provision in the existing SOP with a conciliation agreement clause to facilitate faster resolution of issues that may arise between the industry and the authorities while using the testing and proof facilities.

Tipra Motha chief Pradyot Debbarma quits active politics

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

Pradyot Kishore Manikya Debbarma, Tripura's royal scion and founder of TIPRA Motha Party (TMP), a partner in the Bharatiya Janata Party-led government in the State, quit active politics on Wednesday.

His announcement came a day after the TMP registered a decisive victory in the Village Committee elections of the Tripura Tribal Areas Autonomous District Council (TTAADC). TIPRA is short for Tipraha Indigenous Progressive Regional Alliance.

"Today, after much thought and considerable pain, I am making a clear and final decision. I am stepping away from active politics. I will no longer hold political office or participate in day-to-day political activity," he wrote in a letter addressed to the people of Tripura. He said the decision was not a temporary withdrawal but a deeply personal choice made after years of service and reflection.



Pradyot Debbarma

"I know what I am leaving behind. But I also know that I have reached a point where I must choose my health, my family and my own peace of mind," he wrote.

Mr. Debbarma founded the TMP in 2019, soon after resigning as the State president of the Congress.

Bankers' committees asked to report share of SC beneficiaries in jobs, loan subsidy schemes

Abhinay Lakshman
NEW DELHI

The Finance Ministry has directed State-level and Union Territory-level bankers' committees to mandatorily include data on the percentage share of Scheduled Caste beneficiaries availing flagship Central schemes.

This direction comes after the National Commission for Scheduled Castes (NCSC) flagged the fact that these bankers' committees were not reporting these data for a number of government schemes in their regular reviews, which was hindering the Commission's ability to perform its constitutional duties.

In a letter dated October 5, the Department of Financial Services (DFS) of the Union Finance Ministry wrote to all State-Level Bankers' Committees (SLBCs) and Union Territory-Level Bankers' Committees (UTLBCs), asking them to include the percentage of SC beneficiaries for all the schemes flagged by the NCSC in their periodic reviews – both scheme-wise and bank-wise. The advisory also asked the bankers' committees to ensure that this information is shared regularly with the Commission.

Review meetings

About a week ago, the NCSC had written to Sanjay Lohia, the Secretary of the DFS, highlighting that in review meetings of the bankers' committees, SLBC Conveners do not reflect the percentage of SC beneficiaries for several schemes meant to ensure financial inclusion of citizens.

The NCSC had noted that such data were missing for the Pradhan Mantri Mudra Yojana, Stand-Up India, Prime Minister's Employment Generation Programme, PM SVANidhi (Street Vendors' scheme), Credit Guarantee Fund Trust for Micro and Small Enterprises, and MSME business loans.

Sources aware of these developments told *The Hindu* that in reviewing the banks' performance, the Commission routinely checks whether the share of SC beneficiaries in these government schemes is as close as possible to the share of their communities in the population. "This has not been possible for the Commission in recent times," one government official said.

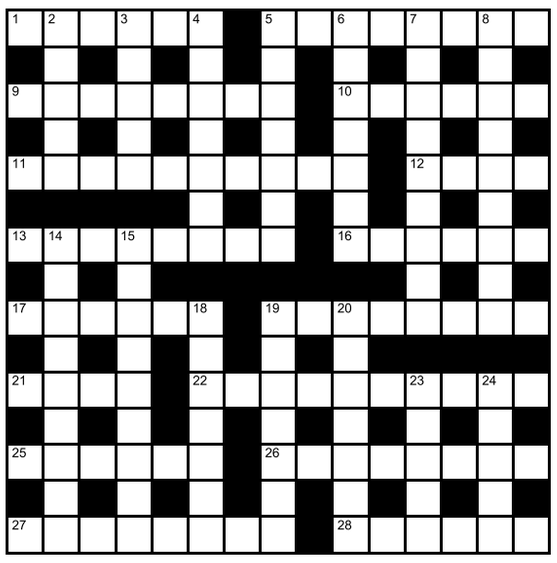
The DFS has now asked all SLBCs and UTLBCs to submit an action-taken report on the advisory issued to them by October 9.

TH CROSSWORD + 14918

(Set by Pixie Dust)

Solve this puzzle online and access more puzzles at *https://thehindu.com/crosswords*

SCAN TO PLAY



Across

1 American churchman not beginning to bother about country (6)
5 It's believed that swallow modelled (8)
9 Can these men of letters recreate real Titanic? (8)
10 South African animal delivered brand of footwear (6)
11 Toss a coin up umpteen times for a delicious beverage? (10)
12 Leonidas regularly missing targets (4)
13 Day and night, say, Santo cycling around city Male (8)
16 Bogus Dame? (4-2)
17 Prompt understanding for those in hearing (6)
19 Doctor has decks, one makes payments here (4,4)
21 Mother India from east or west (4)
22 Avoid skirt (10)
25 Husband! Kiss and cuddle, mother's away for errand basically (3,3)
26 Tiro Quoist protecting a member of a former confederacy (8)
27 Used card all over the place and struggled (8)
28 Spooner suggests: "Caress Sprite for a generous package!" (3,3)

Down

2 For starters, radish and Italian tomatoes added in a yogurt-based dish (5)
3 Some scrape elbows back-to-front and make a high-pitched sound (5)
4 A new year welcoming playful pandemonium (7)
5 Strong drinks for ghosts (7)
6 Represent each type (7)
7 Penned ode about something that is unrestricted? (4-5)
8 Old rum I'd so let loose in opening remarks (9)
14 One who never lets cancer stick near? (3-6)
15 First sign of orphan Pirrip, say, with Spark? Almost magnificent! (9)
18 In a panic mentioned tailing former boyfriend (7)
19 Moved, shed tears over Army Regulation (7)
20 Disconnect appliances which you want to babyproof yourself at last (4,3)
23 Clear the cellar (5)
24 Currency found in Malaysian AirAsia (5)

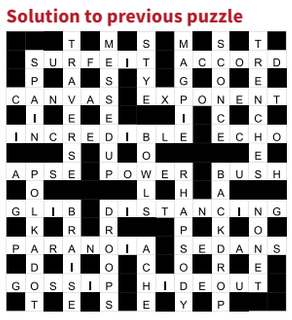
SUDOKU

4			8					9
	9				7		8	6
						5	4	
		9	4				5	8
			9	6	2			
6	4				5	2		
	7	5						
9	1		2				7	
3					9			5

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★★★★

No.SS7025 Distribution: www.knightfeatures.com

Solution to previous puzzle



Solution to yesterday's Sudoku

9	1	8	4	5	3	2	6	7
2	3	5	7	8	6	4	1	9
4	6	7	1	2	9	3	5	8
3	9	2	6	7	5	8	4	1
6	5	4	8	3	1	7	9	2
8	7	1	2	9	4	5	3	6
5	8	6	9	4	7	1	2	3
7	4	9	3	1	2	6	8	5
1	2	3	5	6	8	9	7	4

FAITH

Lord Varaha's promise

Human birth is a rare and precious blessing bestowed by God for the individual soul (atma) to realise its true nature and reach the Divine, Sri Akkarakani Srinidhi said in a discourse. Lord Vishnu took the Varaha avatar (magnificent divine boar) to rescue Mother Earth (Bhudevi) after demon Hiranyaksha submerged Her into the cosmic ocean (pralaya waters). After slaying the demon and lifting the Earth on His tusk, Lord Varaha fulfilled a higher spiritual purpose through Bhudevi's maternal compassion for suffering souls bound to the cycle of rebirth. Moved by empathy, Bhudevi asked Lord Varaha how weak, mortal humans – who inevitably face fading memory, physical pain, and fear near death – could achieve liberation (moksha).

Thereupon, Lord Varaha delivered His solemn promise, enshrined as the Varaha Charama Slokam. He assured that if a devotee turns to Him with sincere faith while he is healthy, the devotee need not worry about his final moments. Even if he lies incapacitated like a stone or a log of wood on the deathbed, Lord Varaha promised that He Himself will remember the devotee and personally lead him to His divine abode.

This sacred assurance directly bridges Lord Varaha to Andal Nachiyar, who is revered as the earthly incarnation of Bhudevi Herself. Having received Lord Varaha's promise on behalf of humanity, Bhudevi manifested as Andal in Srivilliputhur to teach humanity how to put this divine path into practice. Andal acts as the divine mother, fulfilling her cosmic intent, actively guiding fallen souls to trust Lord Varaha's eternal promise of grace and attain ultimate spiritual salvation.

As GST council meets today, tax specialists look for reforms beyond rates

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

With the Goods and Services Tax (GST) system having settled down, revenues remaining steady, and rates having been rationalised, tax experts across the board say the priority for the GST Council in its 57th meeting on October 8 should be on decisively easing the compliance burden for taxpayers.

The GST Council will meet in New Delhi on October 8 for the first time after its meeting on September 3-4, 2025, when it had introduced wide-ranging rate and slab changes. Sources in the Ministry of Finance have confirmed that the meeting will not deliberate on GST rates and will instead focus on a five-pronged effort to reform the tax system and its administration.

Tax analysts agree that this should be the priority of the Council.

Right time for reforms

The GST system turned nine years old on July 1, 2026. Through this time, the Council has met 56 times, has reformed the GST slabs, successfully implemented the 5-year compensation period to States, and the system has stabilised in terms of revenue.

"With high GST collections across the past few months, the GST Council in its next meeting scheduled on October 8, would be able to decide on several issues faced by businesses including relaxation of input tax credit restrictions, reducing complaints for service providers, providing faster refunds, etc., without being unduly worried about the impact of such measures on the GST collections," M.S. Mani, Partner at Deloitte India, said.

The Hindu had reported on October 6 that the proposals by the Centre for the GST Council's consideration would cover process reforms, structural reforms, ease of living and doing business, exports of services, and e-commerce. The final decisions will, however, be made clear only once the Council's meeting concludes.

'Priority for the GST Council meeting should be on easing compliance burden for taxpayers'

"The most important process reforms will be allowing automatic and easy refunds especially to exporters, and preventing ITC accumulation, because these are economy wide effects on working capital for firms," said Rahul Ahluwalia, Founder Director of the Foundation for Economic Development.

Prabhat Ranjan, Senior Director at Nexdigm, a business and tax consultancy, said while rate rationalisation remains important, certainty of tax treatment can be as important as the rates themselves.

"A significant hidden cost of GST arises from interpretational uncertainty – whether on classification, input tax credit, valuation, place of supply or procedural requirements," Mr. Ranjan explained. "When the same transaction can invite different positions across jurisdictions, businesses face not merely additional tax exposure but litigation costs, provisioning requirements, working-capital blockage and uncertainty in commercial decision-making."

Brijesh Agrawal, CEO of Busy Infotech, a company specialising in GST-related software services, said that the GST back-end system had become technologically sophisticated but everyday compliance remained complex for business owners. "Key priorities should centre on consolidating tax slabs to a maximum of three [currently there are 6 slabs, including Zero/Nil, 0.25% and 3%], eliminating cess and overhauling Section 17(5) to allow unconditional credit on all verifiable business-to-business expenses," Mr. Agrawal said.

At the moment, ordinary business costs are not entitled to input tax credits and so not only add to the costs of doing business, but also potentially add to the price of the final product being sold.

The Hindu has learnt that the Centre is proposing a change in this regard, to allow ordinary business costs to also be included in the ambit of input tax credits.

Another proposal that will be put up before the GST Council is to allow businesses to register in a single State and sell across the country instead of having to register their business in each of the States they want to sell in.

Nitin Vijaivergia, Partner, Price Waterhouse & Co further said that the proposed system of harmonising GST audits across multiple registrations would significantly ease the compliance burden on large taxpayers.

"A unified approach to issues that cuts across State lines would curb duplicative information requests and eliminate the risk of divergent conclusions on the same transaction," Mr. Vijaivergia said.

INBRIEF



IATA urges for alternatives to flight cuts at Mumbai airport

The International Air Transport Association (IATA), the global airline industry body, has called for a consultative approach between Adani-owned Mumbai International Airport Ltd. (MIAL) and airlines to ensure that the redevelopment of Terminal 1 does not undermine international connectivity to the Mumbai Metropolitan Region (MMR). IATA also urged stakeholders to explore alternatives to flight cuts and other capacity reductions.

Serum Institute's HPV shot gets WHO pre-qualification

Serum Institute of India's recombinant Quadrivalent Human Papillomavirus vaccine Cervavac has received World Health Organization pre-qualification. The vaccine targets HPV types 6, 11, 16, and 18. It is indicated for girls and boys aged 9- through 26. Inclusion in the WHO list of prequalified vaccines allows Cervavac to be procured by UN agencies. The vaccine was developed in collaboration with the Department of Biotechnology and Biotechnology Industry Research Assistance Council along with WHO-IARC and the Gates Foundation.

New FTAs can cushion tariff blow: RBI chief

Failure to finalise a trade deal between India and the U.S. could have 'some negative impact' on the Indian economy, says Malhotra

Lalatendu Mishra
MUMBAI

A failure to finalise a trade deal between India and the U.S. could have "some negative impact" on the Indian economy, but a string of recent trade agreements and diversification of exports could cushion the fallout from any additional U.S. tariffs, Reserve Bank of India (RBI) Governor Sanjay Malhotra said on Wednesday.



Mr. Malhotra pointed to the diversification of India's export markets as another buffer against a potential tariff shock. FILE PHOTO

"We do not know, first of all, which sectors will be impacted and to what extent these tariffs are going to be applied. So, it is premature. But it will obviously have some negative impact," Mr. Malhotra said in response to a question from *The Hindu*.

However, India's recent trade agreements, including those already operationalised and those in the pipeline, would help mitigate the impact, he said.

The governor also pointed to the diversification of India's export markets and products as another buffer against a potential tariff shock. "All these will mitigate the effect if, in case, there is an additional tariff on some of the sectors," Mr. Malhotra said. His comments come amid a prolonged deadlock in India-U.S. trade negotiations.

Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman said earlier this week that offering any further concessions to the U.S. would be difficult and that the talks had reached a "plateau", with Washington reportedly seeking additional concessions.

The negotiations have assumed greater significance following the passage by the U.S. Congress in September of the Lindsey Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act, which gives President Donald Trump powers to impose tariffs of up to 100% on countries, including India, over purchases of Russian and Iranian oil and gas.

Mr. Malhotra also said the RBI's 25-basis-point repo rate increase was unlikely to have an immediate impact on bank credit growth, as monetary policy transmission typically takes several quarters.

RBI to authorise inter-operability among NBFC-AAs

Lalatendu Mishra
MUMBAI

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) will enable interoperability among Non-Banking Finance Company account aggregators (NBFC-AAs), allowing individuals to access information on their financial assets through a single platform.

The framework will be implemented by December 31, 2026, RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra said while announcing additional measures alongside the monetary policy statement. The RBI will also facilitate Securities and Exchange Board of India - regulated depositories to include bank deposit information in consolidated account statements (CAS), Mr. Malhotra said.



Sanjay Malhotra

"Account aggregator will give you an overview of all your financial assets," he said, noting that information is currently fragmented across about 15 AAs. Interoperability would allow the information to be integrated, giving individuals a consolidated view of their financial assets.

With customer consent, the data could also be accessed by insurance brokers, asset managers and investment advisers, enabling them to offer more informed financial advice, he said.

Mr. Malhotra said CAS currently does not include bank deposits, leaving a significant gap in an individual's consolidated financial picture. It will facilitate the inclusion of deposit information from banks already onboarded, with other banks to be brought in over time. The move is expected to help in tracking dormant deposits, particularly after the death of an account holder.

Individuals spared from new FEMA reporting: RBI

Lalatendu Mishra
MUMBAI

Individuals undertaking forex transactions for personal purposes will not be covered by the Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) new FEMA reporting requirements, Governor Sanjay Malhotra clarified on Wednesday, as concerns grew among freelancers, content creators and small service exporters.

The RBI said it will soon issue a set of FAQs to clear the confusion surrounding the new trade regulations.

"Individuals are not required to report personal imports or exports, or personal earnings or spending in forex, while small exporters with bills up to ₹10 lakh can use self-declaration and an invoice," Mr. Malhotra said in response to a reporter's question.

He clarified that individuals undertaking imports or exports of a personal nature will not have to report such transactions, irrespective of the amount.

This could include payments for subscriptions to television channels, apps, journals or newspapers.

Heavy lifting on inflation will fall upon government

NEWS ANALYSIS

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

The Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) Monetary Policy Committee's (MPC) decision to raise interest rates seemed increasingly inevitable in the run-up to Monday's meeting.

Q2 inflation came in at 4.9% versus 4.7% projected by the RBI in its previous monetary policy review with the main drivers being fuel and food inflation. Looking ahead, the RBI sees inflation touching 6% in Q3 – the upper band – and 5.7% in Q4. Global oil prices are surging again on resumption of military action in Iran after a brief ceasefire. While oil marketing firms, likely at the behest of the Centre, refrained from passing on the rise to consumers, the longer this situation persists, the harder it will be to postpone price hikes.



A deficient monsoon is also boosting food prices.

Impacting prices

The higher oil prices are impacting overall prices and with higher fuel prices, the knock-on effect will only magnify. Also, El Niño and a deficient monsoon are boosting food prices. On growth, the RBI is betting the economy can handle a small rise in interest rates. It revised GDP growth forecast for FY27 to 7.1% from the 6.7% projected in the August policy. This 40bps upward revision is mainly on upward revisions to its Q2 and Q3 estimates.

The MPC's change in stance from 'neutral' to 'calibrated tightening' shows it is better to tackle inflation expectations now than inflation itself.

This makes sense. Rates cannot tackle inflation's primary causes viz. constrained food and fuel supplies. However, they can be a potent tool to control demand and second-order inflationary effects.

More expensive loans mean people and firms borrow less with less amount of money in the system. A 25bps hike is a nudge in this direction and bigger hikes become stronger pushes. A more conservative stance also signals the RBI is ready to further increase rates in the future.

The RBI also has to consider dollar outflows. Foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) sold about $24.3 billion in the Indian markets so far in 2026 against $11.8 billion in 2025. Higher rates can buy the RBI elbow room as FPIs hold off on pulling out anticipating higher rates/returns.

Most of the heavy lifting on inflation is going to fall on the government's shoulders as it seeks to protect consumers from higher oil and food prices.

'Oligarchs stimy Starlink in India'

Aroon Deep
NEW DELHI

Years into SpaceX's efforts to get permissions to operate satellite broadband service in India, the firm's founder-CEO Elon Musk accused "certain oligarchs" in India of stimying its India launch.

Mr. Musk made the accusation on X hours after one of his firm's officials said she hoped the service would go live in India by 2027.



Elon Musk

While Starlink had obtained a Global Mobile Personal Communications by Satellite (GMPCS) authorisation from the Department of Telecommunications (DoT), the government has not yet given security approvals that Starlink needs to operate.

These requirements, some of which were amended last May, require SpaceX to disable Starlink receivers purchased outside India and disable terminals sold in India abroad. This is on top of extensive surveillance norms for the telecom and broadband sector.

Also, telecom operators stoutly resisted "administrative assignment" of satellite spectrum, entailing Starlink and other operators to use airwaves for fixed fee instead of taking part in an auction. Since satellite spectrum is shared without issue in most countries, Reliance Jio has argued the 2012 2G spectrum judgment of the Supreme Court prohibits such an assignment.

UCIL bets on greenfield mines, copper residue to double uranium output

Vinaya Deshpande Pandit
JADUGUDA, JHARKHAND

The Uranium Corporation of India Ltd. (UCIL) plans to double domestic uranium output by 2036, backed by four greenfield mining and processing projects and a novel initiative to recover uranium from copper mine residue.

As part of its push towards a circular economy, UCIL is expected to begin extracting uranium from copper mine residue from 2029-30. An understanding has been reached with Hindustan Copper Ltd. (HCL) for the initiative.

UCIL CMD Kancham Anand Rao disclosed the plans while responding to a question from *The Hindu* at a media workshop here.

"This is a long process. We will take some time till we start this extraction," Mr. Rao said. "We are not going to mine from HCL plant tailings. HCL mines for copper. But they take out only 5%. 95% is reject. We will take that 95% and recover 10% of it. It will come to us for processing. So there is no mining cost involved," he said. The balance waste would be returned to HCL, making the process economically viable and aligned with circular economy principles.

Four greenfield projects

UCIL's production expansion plan comes as India seeks to increase domestic uranium availability to support its growing nuclear power programme. To boost local uranium output in the interim, UCIL is developing four greenfield projects with the most prominent at Rohil in Rajasthan with a capacity to mine/process 2,500 tonne uranium ore a day. The second project at Gogi in Karnataka is at an early stage. The other two are planned in AP and Chhattisgarh.

Mr. Rao said the entry of private players into nuclear power generation would complement UCIL.

(The writer was at Jaduguda on the invite of the PIB and the Department of Atomic Energy)

Iceland courts India for geothermal, CCUS, 'carbon-to-stone' technologies

Saptaparno Ghosh
NEW DELHI

Iceland generates 70% of electricity from hydropower, 30% via geothermal

Iceland is confident about the opportunities emerging in India's evolving geothermal energy landscape and believes regulatory challenges can be overcome, Jóhann Páll Jóhannsson, Iceland's Minister for Energy, Environment and Climate, told *The Hindu* on the sidelines of his visit to New Delhi.

"It (potential challenges originating from India's regulatory framework) is something that can be overcome", he said, adding Iceland had the legal expertise to support countries in developing regulatory frameworks for scaling up geothermal energy.

Mr. Jóhannsson also expressed confidence in India's carbon capture, utilisation and storage (CCUS), pointing to opportunities for Reykjavík to deploy "tried and tested" technology, Carbfix, which converts captured carbon dioxide into stone.

He said Iceland built huge expertise in geothermal energy and wanted to export that knowledge to nations such as India with "large, untapped potential."

Iceland generates about 70% of electricity from hydropower and 30% from geothermal sources. India, meanwhile, has an estimated geothermal potential of about 10.6 GW, according to government data. He noted New Delhi was also committed to expanding geothermal energy.

Benefit from Carbfix

Mr. Jóhannsson highlighted Iceland's Carbfix technology, which converts carbondioxide into stone via a process that permanently mineralises the captured CO_2. He said the technology could be useful for sectors such as cement and steel in India.

NASHVILLE

U.S. woman who survived botched execution is conscious, speaking



REUTERS

Christa Pike, the female inmate who survived a failed execution in a U.S. prison last week is now conscious and speaking, but her prognosis remains unclear, her lawyers said. She survived the injections, however, and was rushed to hospital, where she had been unconscious and on a ventilator in critical condition. AFP

BEIRUT

Hezbollah gets $200 mn from Iran to help displaced by this year's war



AFP

Hezbollah has received $200 million from Iran to help Lebanese displaced by this year's war with Israel, two people with direct knowledge of the transfer said. Hezbollah received the cash last month despite a tightening U.S. economic choke hold on Iran and increasing difficulties in getting funds to Tehran's ally. REUTERS

TOKYO

U.S. Army in Okinawa faces curfew and alcohol ban after murder case



AFP

U.S. forces in Okinawa were barred on Wednesday from drinking alcohol for 48 hours and faced a 30-day curfew after the murder of a woman allegedly committed by an American Marine. The case has triggered outrage in Japan, where any crimes involving U.S. forces have long inflamed criticism of the troops' presence. AFP

KATHMANDU

Nepal to amend laws to facilitate death registration of those missing



REUTERS

Nepal is preparing to amend two laws to facilitate death registration of 5,285 people who remain missing after the August 26 floods, allowing their families to access compensation and other legal benefits, officials said. The move comes two days after the search and rescue operation for victims of the floods was ended. PTI

Houthis claim new strikes on Saudi capital as fighting rages in Yemen

The group claims it attacked Riyadh's King Khalid International Airport with missiles and drones; Saudi forces say they intercepted a missile north of capital, with flights disrupted briefly; fighting in Yemen focused around Dhubab, Waziayah

Associated Press
CAIRO

Three people were killed in attacks on two airports in Saudi Arabia, the Saudi General Authority for Civil Aviation said on Wednesday.

The Saudi authorities did not blame any party for the attacks at Abha and Riyadh's King Khalid international airports, but Houthi (Ansar Allah) rebels in Yemen earlier claimed they carried out attacks against the two airports.

The attack on Abha airport killed Moroccan and Algerian residents and wounded 28 other people, while the attack on King Khalid airport killed a Sudanese national and wounded eight others, officials said.



Houthi supporters gather in solidarity as fighting escalates across several fronts, in Sanaa, Yemen on Wednesday. REUTERS

Earlier on Wednesday, Houthi rebels in Yemen claimed new attacks on airports and military facilities in neighbouring Saudi Arabia on Wednesday as the kingdom is pulled deeper into the latest front in the Iran war, which also threatens a crucial shipping alternative to the Strait of Hormuz. As the Saudi capital is targeted again, new cage-like fences have been erected this week around fuel tanks and other equipment of the Saudi state-run Aramco oil company near the Riyadh airport.

The Houthis' military spokesperson, Brigadier General Yahya Saree, said that the rebels launched ballistic missiles and drones against King Khalid International Airport in Riyadh. The spokesperson for the Saudi-led coalition fighting the Houthis, Major General Turki al-Malki, said they intercepted a ballistic missile north of Riyadh. Flights were briefly disrupted, according to Flightradar24.

Inside Yemen, fighting has centred in and around the crucial town of Dhubab, some 54 km south of the port city of Mokha that the rebels seized last month, according to both the Houthis and Yemen's internationally recognised government.

Clashes were also reported in Waziayah district in southwestern Taiz province, which links Yemen's highlands to the Red Sea and overlooks roads to the Bab el-Mandeb Strait.

Mr. Al-Malki has vowed "full operational support" to Yemeni government forces until the Houthis are "eliminated". The coalition has said 100 fighter jets were providing support.

France suspends use of stun grenades at protests

Reuters
PARIS

The French government said on Wednesday it was pausing the use of stun grenades in its policing of student protests, after a 15-year-old boy's hand was blown off during a clash with riot police, fuelling protesters' accusations of police brutality.

Protests showed no sign of easing, with more than 500 schools closed a day after demonstrations swept across the country, and unions representing high-school students, teachers and other workers planning more marches for Thursday.

The wave of protests has been going on for more than two weeks and has exposed widespread public anger six months ahead of an election to replace President Emmanuel Macron.



Police officers spray students with pepper spray as they protest against under-resourced schools, in Paris on Wednesday. AP

While most of Wednesday's blockades were peaceful, police used tear gas and pushed back protesters in a street barricaded by rubbish bins outside Sciences Po university in central Paris.

Rights groups, labour unions, students and some Opposition politicians have accused the police of using disproportionate force to quell the protests.

Education Minister Edouard Geffray told Parliament that 24 high schools had been damaged by fire or vandalism to the extent that they would remain closed for weeks, meaning some 30,000 students would receive no in-person teaching until they reopened.

Russia hits Ukraine with drones, ballistic missiles, killing 15

Reuters
KYIV

Russia pounded Ukraine with waves of missiles and drones on Wednesday, killing at least 15 people and hitting residential buildings, industrial facilities and infrastructure, Ukrainian officials said.

One Russian missile slammed into an apartment block in the northern city of Pryluky, killing at least nine people including three children, regional governor Vyacheslav Chaus said. Emergency workers used ladders to get to the upper floors of what remained of the building. Around 40 people were wounded, the governor said.

President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said six other people were killed in Kyiv, Oleksandria and Kremenchuk during the heavy overnight attack.

"This was one of the most vile strikes: 70 missiles in total, many of them ballistic," Mr. Zelenskyy said on the Telegram app.

Reopening Brexit debate a 'terrible idea': Badenoch

Sriram Lakshman
LONDON

Leader of the U.K. Conservative Party Kemi Badenoch has opposed British Prime Minister Andy Burnham's stated plan to reopen the question of Brexit (Britain's departure from the European Union), calling it a "terrible idea".

"Can you imagine having to go through that again? So much time lost arguing with ourselves, arguing with the EU, going round and round in circles... I think that is a terrible idea," Ms. Badenoch said at the conclusion of the Conservative Party's annual conference in Birmingham. Last week, the Prime Minister had said that Britian would need to consider what its ties with the EU should look like over the long term, suggesting that one option would be to return to the bloc.

Ms. Badenoch pitched the Conservatives as the main opposition to the Labour in the next elections, despite the growth in popularity of far-right parties Restore Britain and Reform UK. She said her party was ready to govern and had learned from its mistakes. The Conservatives were in power for 14 years, but their popularity had waned and they were beleaguered by internecine battles, cycling through five Prime Ministers over these years, until they lost to the Labour in 2024.



Kemi Badenoch

In her speech, Ms. Badenoch also pushed back against uniting with parties on the Right.

Referring to the defection of a number of MPs to Reform since the 2024 general election, Ms. Badenoch said, the Tories had had an "export boom" of "drama queens". Among those who had defected was former Conservative Home Secretary Suella Braverman, who is of Indian descent.

Ms. Badenoch also appealed to former Tory voters who had shifted their allegiance to Reform, saying she wanted them to "come back home".

"So, to those who say unite the right, we are not uniting with that," she said.

The Tory chief, who is of Nigerian descent, took a dig at those on the far-right who had, in recent public discourse, taken a view that Englishness was an ethnicity rather than a nationality.

"I don't want to live in a country run by people who threaten journalists, who call veterans traitors, and debate whether my mixed-race children are English," she said.

Commenting on the cost of servicing the public debt, Ms. Badenoch said the U.K. was "running out of money". She announced her party had identified savings, promised cuts to inheritance tax, reforming the welfare system, and backed a third runway for Heathrow airport.

Iran has 'lost complete control' of strait: Rubio

Agence France-Presse
ATHENS

Iran has "lost complete control" of the Strait of Hormuz, U.S. Secretary of State Marco Rubio said on Wednesday, adding that Tehran's economy was "in total and complete free fall". "The Straits of Hormuz are open. There's almost as much oil flowing out now as there was before this conflict began. So they've lost complete control of the Straits," Mr. Rubio told presspersons.

Sport

AUS U-19 IN INDIA

Baloda scalps a record-breaking 14 in India u-19's win

Sahil Mathur
AHMEDABAD

Tanmay Baloda recorded the best-ever match figures in a youth 'Test' (14 for 73) to help India under-19 register a thumping 10-wicket win over Australia under-19 at the Narendra Modi Stadium here on Wednesday.

The hosts bowled out the visitors for 151, with Baloda scalping eight for 41 in the second innings. Asked to chase a mere 11 runs, India u-19 finished the game in five deliveries.

At the start of day three, Australia u-19 was at 86 for four, 55 runs in the red.

Baloda began his morning with a wicket off the first ball. Continuing his modus operandi, he pitched the ball on stumps and trapped Zed Hollick in front while the batter was on the defensive. He cleaned up Charlie Henderson in his next over with a quicker one.



Baloda took eight wickets in the second innings. VIJAY SONEJI

Pacer Priyanshu Singh got one to cut into Jacob Pietz and uproot the off stump before pinning Thomas Vaseo.

Cattle showed immense maturity and farmed the strike with No. 10 Patrick Sullivan at the other end. Skipper Yashbardhan Chauhan kept the field open to prevent Cattle from targeting the fence, forcing the batter to take singles. Sullivan supported Cattle for a while, but Baloda eventually had the former caught at first slip.

Cattle came down the track and sent Ayaan Akram's delivery over long-off to reach his half-century. He then moved his front leg to clear the long-on boundary, taking Australia past India's mark.



Stellar performance: India's young brigade proved too hot to handle for the Aussies. VIJAY SONEJI

However, Cattle was eventually bowled while trying to take on Baloda as India u-19 went on to sweep the multi-day series 2-0.

The scores:
Australia u-19 174 & 151 in 43.5 overs (Blake Cattle 63, Tanmay Baloda 8/41) lost to India u-19 315 & 11/0 in 0.5 overs.
PoM: Baloda; **PoS:** Cattle.

Leading athletes line up for National Open championship

ATHLETICS

Uthra Ganesan
NEW DELHI

The Asian Games has just got over but Indian athletics has already moved on with the 65th National Open Championships scheduled to be held here from Thursday.

Four-day event
The four-day competition featuring 78 medal events - 41 men and 35 women - has received entries from several of those who were in action in Aichi-Nagoya although it remains to be seen how many actually turn up in the season-ending competition at the Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium after a hectic 2026.

Among the big names are M.R. Poovamma and Kiran Pahal who won India's only track & field gold in the 4x400m relay and the two pole vaulters in Japan, Baranica Elangovan and Sindhushree.

Shaili Singh also finds her name in triple jump along with Anushka Yadav in hammer throw.

Names to look out for
Among the men, meet record holder Manikanta Hoblidhar, Amiya Mallick and Lalu Prasad Bhoi will be the names to look out for in the 100m while Dharamveer Chaudhary and Jay Kumar part of the Indian bronze-winning 4x400m relay squad, have confirmed entries.

Interestingly Abhishek Pal, who was dropped from the Indian squad for Asiad after being served notice for doping, figures among the entries in both 5,000m and 10,000m.

Aadarsh Ram and silver medallist Sarvesh Kushare also find their names in the high jump, as does David Solomon in long jump.

Nirbhay Chaudhary, who recently set a new national record in hammer throw, is also entered.

Decathlete Thowfeeq N, who withdrew after Day One, is present.

However, most of the big names are expected to give the event a miss and focus on rest and recovery ahead of the next season.

The final list of participants who actually turn up will only be known on the morning of the competition.

CAPTAINS SIZZLE

Shreyas soars to seventh in T20Is, Gill remains No. 1 ODI batter



SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

India T20I captain Shreyas Iyer on Wednesday climbed to a career-best seventh spot in the latest ICC rankings for the shortest format, while ODI skipper Shubman Gill retained the top position in the 50-over batting list. Ishan Kishan and Abhishek Sharma continue to occupy the top two spots in T20Is.

NEW WORKFLOW

Laxman will attend selection committee meetings, says Saikia



FILE PHOTO: EMMANUAL YOGINI

Centre of Excellence head V.V.S. Laxman will attend all senior selection panel meetings going forward to ensure there is "no miscommunication" between the committee and the CoE, BCCI secretary Devaijit Saikia said. Laxman attended the T20I and India-A team selection meeting in Guwahati on Tuesday.

NOTHING BUT RESPECT

I owe Messi a debt of eternal gratitude, says coach Scaloni



FILE PHOTO

I have never seen such a set of skills in any other player. I owe him a debt of eternal gratitude for everything he gave us. I told him in front of everybody, with the little energy that I still had: never in my life did I imagine I would coach the best footballer in history — Lionel Scaloni on Lionel Messi.

COVETED HONOUR

Bhagat and Bhavina to be India's flag-bearers at Asian Para Games



FILE PHOTOS: BISWARANJAN ROUT & R. RAVINDRAN

Paralympic champions Pramod Bhagat and Bhavina Patel will lead the Indian contingent as flag-bearers at the Opening Ceremony of the Asian Para Games, scheduled from October 18 to 24 in Nagoya. Para badminton star Bhagat has won six Asian Para Games medals since 2014 while the TT player has two Asian Para Games medals.

I am not pushed enough: Vithya

The 28-year-old says she doesn't get the fanfare surrounding her show in the latest Asian Games where she bagged three medals for India

ATHLETICS

K. Keerthivasan
CHENNAI

Vithya Ramraj still cannot understand the hype surrounding her.

The 28-year-old, who emerged as one of India's standout performers at the Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games, returned with three medals and a National record in the 400m hurdles, breaking P.T. Usha's 42-year-old mark.

"In the last Asian Games (2023) in Hangzhou, I won three medals. I don't know why I became popular this time," she told select media at a function organised by jewellery brand Tanishq on Wednesday.

She might sound modest, but her performance speaks for itself.



Colourful haul: Vithya won one each of gold, silver and bronze at Aichi-Nagoya. R.V. MOORTHY

Brilliant anchor leg

She played the anchor role brilliantly to help India win the gold medal in the women's 4x400m relay, ran a brilliant race to break Usha's long-standing record in the 400m hurdles (bronze) and did well to guide India to a silver in the 4x400m mixed relay.

Though Vithya is happy to have won bronze in the 400m hurdles at the Games while breaking the National record (54.75s), the athlete and her personal coach, Nehpal Singh, felt she should focus on running sub-54 next.

"My coach is not happy with my timing in the 400m hurdles at the Games in Japan. "In India, I am not pushed enough... hence, I am not able to go sub-54. I will work harder and try to achieve the timing my coach has demanded of me," said Vithya.

When asked about the facilities at the cruise ship where the team stayed in Japan, Vithya replied: "I've lived in a room with 20 members. We lived like that for six years. There were no reservations during travel for competitions. My coach (Nehpal) said, 'Don't care about anything. Just go and run the race.'"

In all probability, Vithya will make her debut at the World athletics championships next year in Beijing. "I want Vithya to make it to the final. That's the target," said Nehpal.

According to Vithya, the key to her success at the Asian Games was the good sleep she had in Spala (Poland), where she trained prior to the Games.

"I slept for 10 hours in those three months. That was what brought my performance," she said.

She will be keen to maintain the sleep cycle to achieve higher dreams.





Argentina's gem: Messi leaves the international arena as one of the greatest to have graced the beautiful game. GETTY IMAGES & AP

The world stands still as Messi signs off on a perfect note

FOOTBALL

Agence France-Presse
BUENOS AIRES

Lionel Messi brought the curtain down on his 21-year international career on Tuesday, bidding farewell to adoring Argentina fans in an emotional final appearance for the 2022 World Cup winner.

In a perfectly scripted finale, the 39-year-old, widely regarded as the greatest football player in history, signed off with his 126th international goal in front of 85,000 supporters as Argentina cruised to a 3-0 victory over Benin. Messi, playing in his record-extending 208th international match, also provided the assist for the opening goal scored by veteran Nicolas Otamendi. Nico Paz scored the other goal.

But the match was a footnote to the occasion itself, which saw Messi savouring the adulation of the Monumental Stadium crowd one last time for an event billed as 'The Last Tango'.

"It was a huge source of pride for me to defend this jersey for more than 20 years," Messi told fans in a post-match address.

"Not coming anymore is going to be deeply painful. I swear I'd like to play for the rest of my life, because playing for the Argentina national team is the most beautiful thing that can happen to you."

Messi, though, said he had no regrets about his decision to retire, citing Argentina's gruelling World Cup campaign, which took place as his late father was seriously ill, as a factor.

"Even though I want to be here all my life, I feel that this is the moment. The last World Cup was too much, everything I had to live through," said Messi.

Beforehand, Messi wiped away tears as the bus carrying him and his Argentina teammates made its way through crowds of wellwishers en route the stadium.

Messi took the field alongside his three children and received affectionate waves from his wife, Antonela Roccuzzo, and his mother, Celia Cuccittini, who were watching from a VIP box.

Shortly before kick off, a giant Argentina jersey bearing the word *"Gracias"* (Thank You) above the football superstar's No. 10 was laid out on the pitch as the crowd roared its approval. Messi crowned the occasion with a goal from the penalty spot in the 71st minute.

Dhir's impact with the ball was decisive

WI IN INDIA

S. Dipak Ragav
LUCKNOW

Three weeks ago, Naman Dhir was with the Punjab team preparing for the Ranji Trophy campaign when he learned he had been selected for the India ODI squad. After playing all three matches in the 50-over format, Dhir was added to the T20 squad in the eleventh hour, making it a dream fortnight.

On Tuesday, the all-rounder made his first real mark in international cricket, albeit in a facet of his game few have seen.

"It was a great feeling when I got the call. I was in the Ranji Trophy camp at the PCA. Right away I called my father; he was emotional; I also got a little emotional," said Dhir.

"Obviously, every kid has a dream to play for the country, so if you represent the country, it's a big deal. I am from a small town and no one had played for the country from there. So it's a big deal for me and in our area."

Match-ups and analytics have meant captains are reluctant to trust finger spinners, especially off-spinners, in T20s. Operating as the fifth bowling option, Dhir's figures of three for 31 on his T20 debut played a key role in India's eight-wicket win over West Indies here.

The most impressive aspect of his bowling was how he responded to being attacked, showing real smarts and temperament. Every time he was hit, the 26-year-old adjusted, whether by bowling it wide outside off-stump, slowing it up, or altering his length to induce false shots.

Remarkably, all his wicket-taking deliveries came just after he was hit for a six.

"I saw Axar (Patel) bhai in the PowerPlay, where he was bowling a little slow. It was turning. I thought if I slow it down, with the wicket gripping, I can get them out. So I just stuck to my basic plan and got good results," he added.

While he has made his name through his batting in the IPL for Mumbai Indians, Dhir revealed that he has always worked on his bowling.

"I've been bowling for a long time. It's not like I've just started. In IPL, yes, there's an Impact Player rule, so you see me bowling less. But it's not like I haven't bowled; I've bowled a lot and got wickets."

"I hope I'll keep doing well in the future," said Dhir.



Good tidings: Dhir brought cheer to his skipper and India with three strikes on his T20I debut. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP



Targeting glory: The archers strike a pose with the APL mascot. ARCHERY PREMIER LEAGUE

APL second season gets underway today

Anirudh Velamuri
HYDERABAD

When the dust settled at the 2026 Asian Games, one sport stood taller than the rest. Archery hit the bullseye, hauling in nine medals (five gold, two silver and two bronze).

Two quotas for the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics were also secured, courtesy Chikitha Taniparthi and Sahil Jadhav in the mixed team compound and Kumkum Mohod in the women's individual recurve.

The country's finest archers have assembled again, this time in Hyderabad to team up with international rivals and compete against their compatriots in the second season of the Archery Premier League (APL) from Thursday.

Chikitha, whose twin gold caught the nation's attention in Aichi-Nagoya, credited APL for helping refine her game.

"During the first season, I learnt a lot about managing pressure under the faster shot clock as well as techniques from my teammates while watching them train," she said.

Interest in the league has only grown since the inaugural edition in New Delhi, according to APL director Anil Kamineni. He revealed plans to add more teams in the future and announced that the APL caravan will pitch tent in a new city every year.

Smriti Mandhana, India's new captain, has earned her job

P.K. Ajith Kumar

The queen of batting is all set for a new reign.

Smriti Mandhana, the most prolific batter in women's cricket, has taken over the captaincy of the Indian team from Harmanpreet Kaur. She wasn't just the obvious choice; she was the only choice.

She commands respect from her teammates. And she is the most experienced player in the team after Harmanpreet.

The 30-year-old is not new to the leadership role, either. She has stepped in when Harmanpreet wasn't available on a few occasions. She has also led Royal Challengers Bengaluru to two WPL titles.

The first of those titles, in 2024, brought an end to the agonisingly long wait for a trophy for the Bengaluru-based franchise, whose men's team used to falter after promising much, season after season.

Smriti has an opportunity to end a title drought for the Women in Blue, too.



Immediate task: Smriti will have to strengthen the team in the shortest format. GETTY IMAGES

The 30-year-old, who is the most experienced player in the side after Harmanpreet, has led RCB to two WPL titles

They have never won the T20 World Cup. They didn't even make it to the knockout stage in the last editions.

Strengthening the Indian team for the shortest format should be her priority. India is excellent in ODIs; the World Cup victory last year underlined that fact.

The Indians are pretty good in the longest format, too, though women get to play Test matches only once in a blue moon. They were ruthless against England in the historic Test at Lord's recently. But, there is work to be done in their T20 side.

They have struggled against stronger teams like Australia and South Africa. They need to address the issue of batting firepower in the middle-order, instead of leaving everything to Richa Ghosh. They have to find, and develop, some quality all-rounders. Smriti, and the team management, will have to address those issues well in time for the next T20 World Cup in 2028.

Added pressure

Along with privilege, captaincy also brings in added pressure. Given her gift, ambition and fearlessness, it is unlikely to affect Smriti's batting. Who knows, it may help, even.

History will be kinder to you: Gambhir to Agarkar

Amol Karhadkar
MUMBAI

A day after the BCCI invited applications for his successor, Ajit Agarkar was publicly thanked for his three-year stint as chairman of the men's selection committee, with head coach Gautam Gambhir acknowledging the former India pacer's contribution to a period of considerable success.

"Dear Ajit b*hai*, an absolute honour to work with you," Gambhir tweeted on Tuesday. "Those three ICC trophies are testimony of your conviction: Team first and team ahead, always. I must say, history will be kinder to you. Thank you for everything."

The BCCI followed it up in the evening with a tribute to Agarkar, highlighting the trophies won during his tenure, including three ICC titles and two Asia Cup triumphs, as well as back-to-back Asian Games gold medals and India's run to the 2023 ODI World Cup final.

"Thank you, Ajit Agarkar, for your commitment, conviction and contribution as chairman of the men's selection committee," the board said.

Agarkar took over as chairman in July 2023 and was handed a renewed contract before his tenure expired on October 4.

His tenure encompassed some significant selection calls, as India transitioned across formats while collecting major silverware.

INBRIEF



Spain fights back to beat Croatia and remain perfect

Spain fought back against Croatia to win 2-1 thanks to Mikel Merino's, *in pic*, brace in Split on Tuesday and remain perfect in Nations League Group A3 while Harry Kane continued his hot form as England beat the Czech Republic 3-0 to stay second.

The results: League A: Group 1: England 3 (Coufal 27-og, Kane 40, 57) bt Czech Republic 0; Croatia 1 (Perisic 17) lost to Spain 2 (Merino 61, 89).
League B: Group 1: Switzerland 3 (Rieder 43, Manzambi 73, Ndoye 81) bt North Macedonia 0.



Clinical India U17 men blank Myanmar 4-0 in friendly

The India U17 men's team ended its friendly tour of Myanmar with a comprehensive 4-0 victory over the hosts in the second match at Thanlyin on Wednesday. The first match had ended in a 1-1 draw three days ago.

The result: Myanmar 0 lost to India 4 (Dallalmoun Gangte 40, Kyi Thar 53-og, Kamgouhao Doungel 60, Hrishikesh Charan Manavathi 72).

Krishna-Pruthvi duo stuns the fifth seeds Ting-Yu

Krishna Prasad Garaga and Pruthvi Krishnamurthy Roy upset fifth seeds He Ji Ting and Ren Xiang Yu at the Arctic Open Super 500 badminton doubles in Vantaa, Finland.

The results (first round): Men: Anders Antonsen bt H.S. Prannoy 21-10, 21-9; Magnus Johannesen bt Tharun Mannepalli 21-16, 21-14; Weng Hong Yang bt Rounak Chauhan 22-20, 20-22, 21-17.
Doubles: Krishna Prasad Garaga & Pruthvi Krishnamurthy Roy bt He Ji Ting & Ren Xiang Yu 10-21, 21-18, 22-20.
Women: Tanvi Sharma bt Chiu Pin Chian 21-15, 21-17; Ratchanok Intanon bt Isharani Baruah 21-10, 21-15-21.

Vidya, Shivam carry India's hopes in C'wealth cue sports

The second edition of the Commonwealth Cue Sports Championships, featuring 144 players from across 42 nations, began here on Wednesday. The championship sees 72 men and 72 women compete across English billiards, snooker, 10-ball pool, heyball and blackball. Defending Commonwealth women's heyball champion Vidya Pillai, men's heyball silver medallist Shivam Arora and women's 10-ball pool silver medallist Chitra Magimairaj are headlining the Indian challenge.

'Players have to be alert for full match'

The India head coach Jamil underlines the importance of preparation; Forlan glad Uruguay recovered well after a positive start by the host

FOOTBALL

Amitabha Das Sharma
KOLKATA

The India men's football team ended its three-match FIFA international friendly window on a disappointing note, suffering a 1-6 defeat against Uruguay at the Salt Lake Stadium on Tuesday. However, head coach Khalid Jamil's post-match assessment focussed less on the heavy defeat and more on the lack of concentration that contributed to India's defensive lapses.

Jamil repeatedly highlighted the need for the players to remain focused throughout the match as India played its matches against Panama, Brazil and Uruguay. Much like what it did against Panama and Brazil, India showed encouraging signs against Uruguay, attempting to press high and attack despite facing a team considerably higher in the FIFA rankings. But Jamil felt those positive spells meant little when defensive mistakes were punished.



On target: Thapa's strike helped India fight back after Uruguay took the lead before the visiting team raised its level. K.R. DEEPAK

"The key thing is that one mistake in a good game can be punished," Jamil said, stressing the need for his players to remain sharp and alert throughout the match.

India was competitive during the opening half-hour but struggled to maintain that level thereafter.

"We were okay in the first 30 minutes. After that, maybe it was fitness, maybe concentration, the lack of which contributed to the loss. That is why we have to be more alert because we conceded more goals around the 60th and 70th minutes," Jamil analysed.

Jamil also underlined the importance of preparation and collective responsibility. "Your preparation has to be good, and your concentration has to remain strong both before and during the game. There can be no distractions. At this level, even if you play a good game, one mistake can be punished," he said.

The three friendlies have offered India both encouragement and a warning. India showed it can compete against stronger opponents in patches, but must turn those spells into sustained performances. With the New Zealand test due next in November, Jamil will look to build a more disciplined, resilient and switched-on side capable of competing for the full 90 minutes.

Uruguay coach Diego Forlan said his side recovered well after India made a positive start. "Our transition and our passing was a little bit slow at the start, so India could profit from that. Then, we tried to fix it, and as the game progressed, we controlled the pressing really well," said the former star forward now working as the team's interim coach about his side's performance.

India faces strong Russian challenge

Sports Bureau
KOLKATA

India's women's national football team returns to international action on Thursday when it takes on the 27th-ranked Russia at the Kishore Bharati Stadium here on Thursday.

The fixture marks India's first international appearance in Kolkata and gives head coach Crispin Chettri an opportunity to test a young squad against a stronger opposition.

India women are ranked 69th in the world and play their first match after winning their sixth SAFF Women's Championship title in June. The two sides will play two friendlies with the second match coming at the same venue on October 11.

Chettri's squad has an average age of 23, with several players promoted from the U-20 setup. Goalkeeper Nandini, winger Sibani Devi Nongmeikapam and forward Renu are among those looking to establish themselves at senior level.

The matches are an important step towards building a team for the Asian Cup. For India, the challenge will be to compete well, learn from the experience.



Coach Crispin Chettri leads a training session. AIFF

Preparations have been affected by club commitments, particularly East Bengal's AFC Women's Champions League and Indian Women's League campaigns.

Chettri sees the absences as an opportunity for emerging players to prove themselves. "There is nothing to lose for us, but to show character and give our best for the country," he said.

Russia has won both previous meetings, including an 8-0 victory in 2021 and a 2-0 win earlier this year. However, Russia coach Yuri Krasnozhan insisted that past results are irrelevant.

"The previous game is history, it's just statistics. Every new game is a new challenge," he said. Both matches will be streamed live on the Indian Football YouTube channel.

Pranav upsets fourth seed Udit



Fighting effort: Pranav Karthik hit back strongly after losing the first set and moved into the next round. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

TENNIS

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

Pranav Karthik pulled off a major upset, rallying from a set down to knock out fourth seed Udit Kamboj 1-6, 7-6(3), 6-3 in the second round of the 31st Fenesta Open National tennis.

Meanwhile, men's top seed Manish Sureshkumar routed Lakshit Sood 6-0, 6-1 to enter the last eight.

Important results
(round-of-16): Men's singles: Manish Sureshkumar bt Lakshit Sood 6-0, 6-1; Pranav Karthik bt Udit Kamboj 1-6, 7-6(3), 6-2; Maan Kesharwani bt Rohith Gobinath 6-1, 6-2; Rohan Mehra bt Ajay Malik 7-6(3), 6-3; Suraj Prabodh bt Debasis Sahoo 6-4, 6-4; Parth Aggarwal bt Deep Munim 7-5, 6-2.

Women's singles: Vaidehee Chaudhari bt Aahan Aahan 6-4, 6-1; Shruti Ahlawat bt Parthsarthi Mundhe 6-1, 6-3; Akanksha Nitture bt Yubrani Banerjee 6-1, 4-6, 6-1; Sonal Patil bt Akansha Ghosh 6-3, 6-7(4), 6-4; Aditi Rawat bt A. Sonkusare 6-3, 3-6, 6-2; Laxmi Siri Dandu bt Bela S. Tamhankar 6-0 (retd.); Sohini Mohanty bt A. Jadhav 6-3, 6-2; Soha Sadiq bt Saily Thakkar 6-1, 6-0.

Boys u-18 singles: Veer Jiten Madam bt Praneel Sharma 7-6(4), 6-4; Om Ramesh Patel bt Sharan Somasi 6-3, 6-1; Aditya Mor bt Lakshya Chukka 6-2, 7-5; Yashwin Dahiya bt Parjanya Adury 6-4, 6-2; Ribhav Saroha bt N. Kirbakaran 6-0, 6-3; Raghav Sarode bt Srivaant Mummadi 6-3, 6-3; N. Badrinarayanan bt Aarav Bharat 6-4, 6-0; Srikar Doni bt Govardan Suresh 6-1, 6-3.

Girls u-18 singles: S. Bhuvaneswaran bt Aahida Singh 3-6, 7-6(5), 3-0 (retd.); Parthsarthi Mundhe bt Manvi Gupta 6-0, 6-0; Shreeniti Chowdhury bt Aaradhya Meena 6-3, 0-6, 6-4.

'I used the scrambled seam a lot and tried to hit the deck'

AUSTRALIA-A IN INDIA

Anish Pathiyil
PUDUCHERRY

India has been blessed with vast cricketing riches. But an eyebrow is always raised when it comes to one particular player profile – the pace-bowling all-rounder. Hardik Pandya is undoubtedly the *numero uno*, but recurring injuries have kept him out of the national side for a while. Nitish Kumar is the next in line, but injuries haven't been kind to him either.

This has opened the door for young Suryansh Shedge from Mumbai to spend time around the first-team setup. The selectors have earmarked him as a future option, and his latest effort with the ball for India-A against Australia-A proves why. On a surface that offered little extra bounce for the pacers, the 23-year-old registered his career-best List-A figures of four for 35 in the first one-dayer in Puducherry.

"After my first over, I realised that the ball is coming on nicely at full length. So I used the scrambled seam a lot and tried to hit the deck, which gave me a lot of positives," the all-rounder said. Shedge has always been a hard-lengths bowler. He says it comes naturally due to his action. "If I can master that length, it will always give me an upper hand against batters," he says.



Shedge has put Hardik's advice to good use. @CAP

A brief injury-induced layover at the BCCI Centre of Excellence ahead of the series allowed him the chance to pick Hardik's brains. "Master your stock ball. That will be your USP. When someone is attacking, you can always fall back on that," was the senior all-rounder's advice to his junior partner, who could be the solution to India's team balance problems in the future.

Bopanna, Hijikata set for TPL

Press Trust of India
MUMBAI

Former world No. 1 Rohan Bopanna and 2023 Australian Open men's doubles winner Rinky Hijikata will be the marquee names of their respective teams in the Tennis Premier League (TPL) ahead of the player auction on October 12 in Mumbai.

Bopanna will represent the Gurgaon Grand Slammers in the eighth season of TPL to be held from December 8 to 13 in Hyderabad.

Argentina's world No. 60 Roman Burruchaga, representing the Kolkata Thunder Blades, will be the highest-ranked singles player in the league.

Frenchman Terence Atmane, nicknamed 'The Magician', will headline the Mumbai Royals. The Lucknow Blazers will be represented by Czechia's Dalibor Svrcina.

Attacking approach helped, says Kalkal

WRESTLING

Y.B. Sarangi
KOLKATA

Wrestler Sujeet Kalkal thanks foreign coach Shako Bentinidis for encouraging him to adopt an attacking approach and employing the *dhobi pachhad* (arm throw) technique, which made key contributions in his Asian Games gold medal win on debut.

Kalkal, who carried forward iconic wrestlers Yogeshwar Dutt and Bajrang Punia's legacy to win the freestyle 65kg title, acknowledged Bentinidis' role.

"Since my attack is good, Shako asked me to attack from the first bout," said Kalkal, who was named India's male athlete of the Games, during an interaction facilitated by the Sports Authority of India (SAI) on Wednesday.

"I competed in Russia where I won, but Shako was not happy. He said, 'You don't attack much.' I worked on that. In the Asian Games, I attacked in every bout and scored as well."

Kalkal also added *dhobi pachhad* to his attacking repertoire. "For (mastering) one technique, you need to practise it a lot so that you can show it in a competition. I thank Shako because he taught me this. I was interested, but couldn't do it. He corrected me and made me practise it."

Living in the present, Kalkal, who has claimed four international gold medals this year, wants to shine at this month's World championships in Astana.

"This competition is tougher than the Olympics (because of the quality and volume of athletes)," said Kalkal.

TNCA LEAGUE



Dhaivik (MRC-B, 7/55); Churchil (TFUCC, 6/51); Vigneshwaran (Companions, 5/25); Sachin (Magnet, 5/33); Ram Thilak (Grove, 5/34); Sasikiran (Lusuraj, 5/43); Mathivanan (Unicorn, 5/62).

MRC-B's Dhaivik scalps seven

CHENNAI: Dhaivik's seven for 55 helped MRC-B thrash Twentieth Century by 98 runs in a TNCA league fifth division B-zone match held recently.

The scores: V-A: Globe 205/9 in 50 overs (S. Shai Ram 38, S. Daniel 49 n.o., P. Mathivanan 5/62) bt Unicorn 177 in 45.3 overs (K. Farhaan 51, P. Mathivanan 33, S. Naveen Kumar 3/43).

GTUC 166 in 49.5 overs (F. Haashid Farhaan 42 n.o., N. Ponnivalavan 4/44, M. Dinesh Kumar 4/57) lost to Triplicane Comsopolitan 169/8 in 41.2 overs (G. Rajesh Kanna 43 n.o., M. Saran 4/49).

Triplicane RC 220/7 in 50 overs (P. Gugan 58, B.G. Ramkaanth 72, S. Balasubramanian 35 n.o., M. Churchil 6/51) lost to TFUCC 221/3 in 40.3 overs (J. Tamiselvan 48, S. Ilamugil 55, Aaship Ahamed 51 n.o.).

Grove 197 in 48.4 overs (Barath 90, Deepak Shanmuganathan 30, B. Vishal 3/31) bt Bharathi SC 168 in 49.3 overs (S. Kumaresan 66 n.o., S. Sachin 37, Raul Roshan 3/40, R. Ram Thilak 5/34).

Netaji 204/9 in 50 overs (C. Andrew Wesely 36, M. Sri Varshath 57 n.o., M. Chandru 34, S. Sachin 5/33, Thummalurai Sai Mayank Prasad 3/40) bt Magnet 145 in 40.5 overs (Thummalurai Sai Mayank Prasad 33, M. Chandru 4/51, V. Bharanidharan 3/30).

Gandhi Nagar Starlets 170 in 42.3 overs (B. Arun Kumar 44, S. Manikandan 38) bt Gopalapuram 93 in 44.4 overs (K. Namasivayam 3/26).

V-B: MRC-B 267/7 in 50 overs (S. Raja Ravi Varma 85, Dhaivik 34, R. Prabhu Dhev 58, Sabarigiri 3/73) bt Twentieth Century 169 in 32.4 overs (S. Kevin Charles Vaz 48, K. Jagadeesh 3/28, Dhaivik 7/55).

Vepery 256/9 in 50 overs (M. Prabhu 48, D. Shiva Shankaran 49, K. Ajith Kumar 3/68, P. Mahesh Krishna 3/69) bt Free Lancers 220 in 42.5 overs (P. Mahesh Krishna 78 n.o., Ramakrishnan 39, P. Sakthi 3/55).

Companions 204 in 38.5 overs (K. Lakshmanan 78, K. Raja 39, K. Pradeepak Kumar 4/31, A. Ashwin Kumar 3/60) bt Grand Prix 137 in 34.3 overs (S. Padmanaban 57, S. Vigneshwaran 5/25).

TANGEDCO 283/8 in 50 overs (S. Dinesh 70, A. Muthukumaran 37, K. Chithirakannan 36, T. Tamizharasan 65 n.o., P. Kishore Kumar 3/59) bt Indian Oil 282/9 in 50 overs (A.S. Santhosh 66, C. Vijaya Balaji 59, P. Rakesh Kumar 61, N. Shyam Prasad 4/87).

YMCC 143 in 46.1 overs (N.C. Venkatesh 53, R. Magesh 3/42) bt Chennai P&T Audit 103 in 31.2 overs (N. Rajesh 4/43, S. Selvakumar 4/22).

Lusuraj 212/8 in 50 overs (M. Suresh Kannan 43, A. Edwin Arasan 53 n.o., M. Mohamad Mavasim 3/43) bt CCL 146 in 37.3 overs (K. Thiruneelakanta Pillai 44, D. Hariharasuthan 52, J. Ebinezar Paul 3/26, V. Sasikaran 5/43).

ENGAGEMENTS

Cricket: TNCA round-robin u-14 tournament, City-I vs. Districts-IV (PBEL City); City-II vs. Districts-III (Wahe Guru-B); Districts-I vs. City-IV (Wahe Guru-A); Districts-II vs. City-III (Jones Krish), day one, 9.30 a.m.

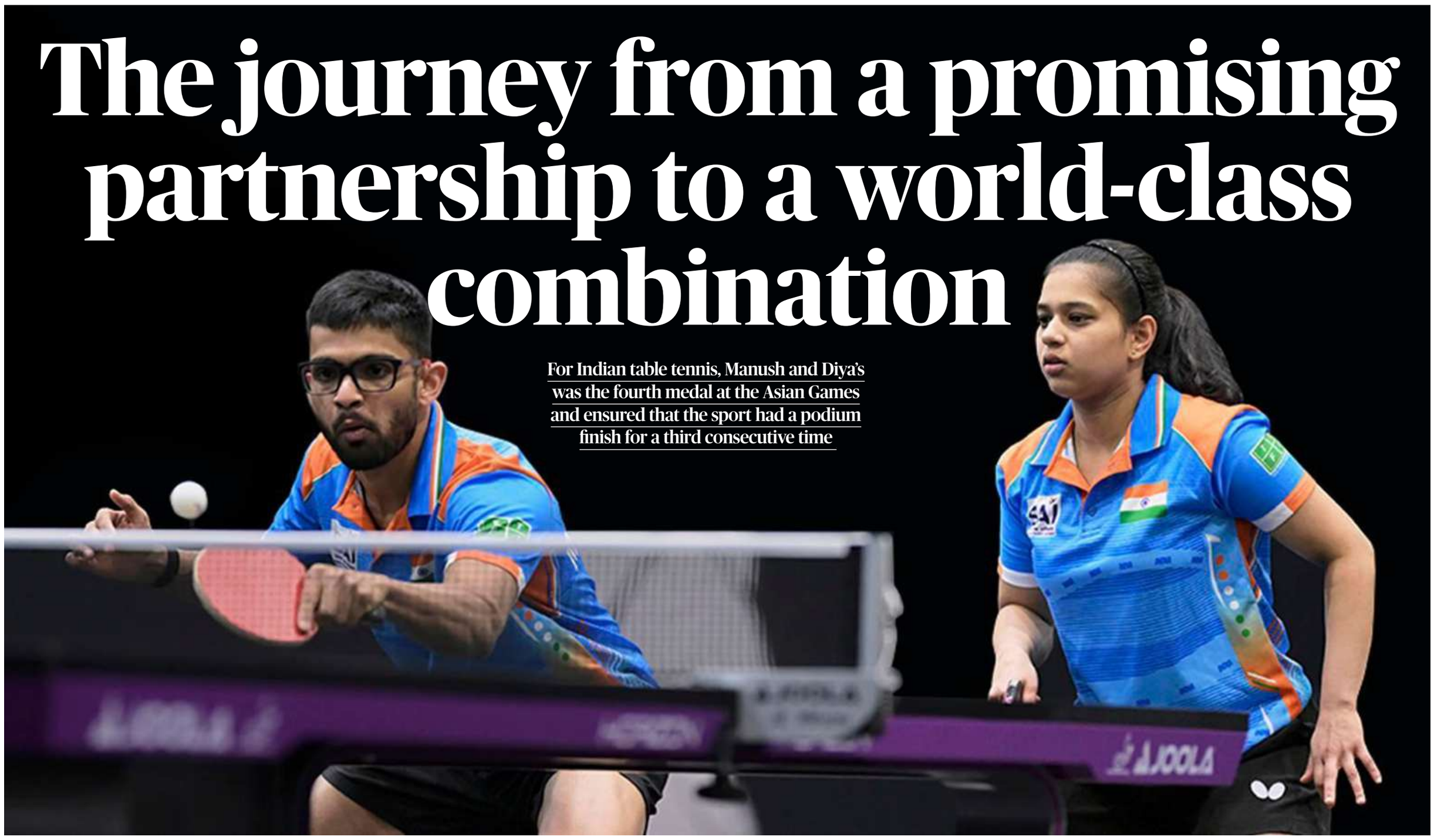
Committee formed to ensure HIL's continuation

Uthra Ganesan
NEW DELHI

The Sports Ministry has constituted a seven-member committee to work out the modalities of the governance structure and way forward to ensure the continuation of the Hockey India League.

Headed by former Odisha sports secretary and currently joint secretary (Khelo India) R. Vineel Krishna as the government's representative, the committee includes Hockey India president Dilip Tirkey, secretary general Bholanath Singh and treasurer Sekar J. Manoharan among others. The three representatives named from among the HIL franchises are JSW Sports CEO Divyanshu Singh, SG Pipers' CEO Mahesh Bhupathi and Hyderabad Toofans' owner Alok Sanghi.

The journey from a promising partnership to a world-class combination



For Indian table tennis, Manush and Diya's was the fourth medal at the Asian Games and ensured that the sport had a podium finish for a third consecutive time

Amol Karhadkar

For four days in early September, Manush Shah travelled to Mumbai, the hometown of his mixed doubles partner Diya Chitale for a relatively simple job. Train.

There were no selection meetings to worry about, no administrative developments to follow, no uncertainty over who would be around the Indian table tennis team. In Mumbai, the pair could concentrate on the one thing that had brought them together in the first place – making their partnership work.

Those four days would prove valuable when they eventually arrived in Aichi-Nagoya.

The sixth-seeded Indian pair went on to win a bronze medal at the Asian Games, beating Hong Kong's third-seeded Wong Chun Ting and Doo Hoi Kem in the quarterfinals before losing to eventual silver medallists Wong Chuqin and Sun Yingsha of China in the semifinals.

Significant achievement

For Indian table tennis, the medal was significant. It was the fourth at the Asian Games and ensured that the sport had a podium finish at a third successive edition of the continental extravaganza.

For Manush and Diya, though, the bronze represented something more personal. It was the reward for a partnership that had steadily climbed the international ladder and, in the process, had learnt to complement two very different games.

It was also an affirmation that, amid a turbulent build-up, they had managed to keep the noise away from the table.

When Diya spoke about going into her second Asian Games, she did not need to be reminded of the difference between a regular international tournament and a multi-sport event. Her first Asian Games, in Hangzhou three years ago, had given her that perspective.

"Going into my second Asian Games, I think the first one gave me a lot of experience and exposure," Diya told *The Hindu* before leaving for Japan. "Representing the country at a multi-sport event is a very different feeling. It was a great experience in 2023, and I wanted to carry that experience forward." But there was a difference this time. The expectations were higher. Diya and Manush were no longer simply an emerging combination hoping to make an impression. They had become one of India's principal medal contenders, their progress reflected by a place among the world's top-eight pairs at the 2025 WTT Finals, the season-ending event reserved for the leading performers of the year.

"We have been doing really well in doubles," Diya had said ahead of the Games. "Me and Manush have been doing really, really well for the last two or three years. When we started, our graph has gone up a lot."

That graph eventually took them to an Asian Games podium. The bronze did not arrive out of nowhere. Over the preceding seasons, the pair had learnt the demands of international mixed doubles, where the rhythm and speed of a rally can differ considerably from men's doubles.

Breaking it down

Manush described the distinction in simple terms. "In men's doubles, you expect power from the opponents. The ball really travels and you expect good quality, so you don't have to manage the front-and-back movement as much," he said.

"In mixed doubles, it is the opposite. The front-and-back movement becomes really important because the woman on the opposing pair may not be as powerful. They try to play quickly, so the ball can be a little slower and you have to make faster adjustments with your footwork." That difference requires more than just technical ability. It requires trust. "In mixed doubles, Diya is the one with the control and I try to finish the point," Manush said. "If this works out, then we are already one step ahead of the opponent. That is what the goal is all about in doubles." The quarterfinal against Hong Kong was evidence of that equation working when it mattered.

India's table tennis contingent had not arrived at Aichi-Nagoya without precedent. In 2018, the men's team won a historic bronze and Sharath Kamal and Manika Batra added another bronze in mixed doubles. In Hangzhou, Ayhika Mukherjee and Sutirtha Mukherjee produced a surprise run to the women's doubles bronze.

Manush and Diya's medal therefore extended the sequence of Indian table tennis appearing on the Asian Games podium. Yet it carried a different weight.

Unlike the Hangzhou women's doubles bronze, which came as a surprise, this was a medal India had begun to expect from the pair. Their qualification for the WTT Finals in 2025 had placed them among the world's leading combinations, while their performances over the preceding couple of seasons had made them a credible medal proposition.

"Since two or three years, we have been doing really well," Diya had said. "We understand each other's game better now. We know each other's strengths and weaknesses."

That understanding had been tested against the world's best. "We have played a lot of top pairs over the years," she said. "We have beaten a top Japanese pair and qualified for the WTT Finals, where the top eight pairs in the world play. All these experiences put together have helped us reach where we are today."

The Asian Games simply provided the biggest stage yet on which that accumulated experience had to translate into a result. And it did. The achievement becomes more significant when the build-up to the Asian Games is considered. Indian table tennis spent much of the preceding months dealing with issues away from the playing arena.

The selection controversy surrounding Manika Batra had cast a shadow over the process after she was left out of the Asian Games squad for failing to meet the prescribed selection criteria. The episode led to questions about the transparency of the selection system and public exchanges between the paddler and the federation.

Then, in August, the Sports Ministry suspended the recognition of the Table Tennis Federation of India as the National Sports Federation for table tennis, citing a series of administrative and governance issues. The turmoil had consequences beyond the boardroom.

Massimo Costantini's tenure as India's foreign expert had expired on May 15, and the uncertainty surrounding the federation meant his continuation with the national set-up was delayed. The Italian eventually joined the Indian contingent in Japan only a week before the Asian Games. Against that backdrop, Manush and Diya had little choice but to concentrate on what they could control.

Rising expectations

There was no luxury of an extended camp dedicated exclusively to the mixed doubles combination. The international calendar rarely allows it. But the partnership had already developed enough understanding to make those sessions count. Diya was aware before the Games that expectations would follow them. The pair's rise had ensured that. "Pressure is always going to be there," she had said. "There will always be some expectations and some pressure. But what is important is that we gave our best and are happy with the way it progressed." That attitude became particularly relevant in the quarterfinal. A defeat would have meant another near-miss for Indian table tennis. A victory would guarantee at least a bronze. Manush and Diya delivered. The win over Wong and Doo, seeded third, confirmed the medal and effectively transformed their status from contenders to medallists. The bronze was secure.

While Manush has come a long way since starting to train under Shailesh Gosain's watchful eyes in Vadodara, Diya has been coached by Sachin Shetty ever since she took up the sport more than a decade and a half ago. Since their junior days, Olympic Gold Quest has been supporting the duo's journey towards excellence in the international circuit. Government support has also reduced some of the financial pressure on athletes and their families.

"With so many government schemes, the Government helps a lot with the TOPS scheme," Diya said. "Of course, that also relieves the financial pressure on the parents." That support becomes especially relevant when an athlete is required to travel extensively, train continuously and compete against the world's best. By the time Diya and Manush stepped onto the Asian Games arena, they were carrying the work of that entire ecosystem with them. More than just a bronze. The significance of the medal extends beyond the result of one quarterfinal and one semifinal.

Bigger message

It means India has now won table tennis medals at three consecutive Asian Games. It means the country has a established mixed doubles combination capable of competing with the best in Asia. And it confirms that Manush and Diya's journey from promising partnership to world-class combination has been real.

Their qualification for the 2025 WTT Finals had already indicated where they belonged.

The Asian Games provided a different kind of test – one where the draw, the occasion and the weight of expectations all mattered.

They responded by beating the third seeds and securing India's only table tennis medal at the Games. The loss to the Chinese pair in the semifinal did not diminish what had been achieved. If anything, it reinforced the progression.

Three years earlier, Diya had entered her first Asian Games looking for experience and exposure while Manush had endured the disappointment of being one point away from a medal in men's doubles. This time they went for a medal. "We went into the Asian Games aiming for a medal," Diya said.

"And we are thrilled that we have achieved the objective and have brought that medal home".





THE GIST

For Manush and Diya, though, the bronze represented something more personal. It was the reward for a partnership that had steadily climbed the international ladder and, in the process, had learnt to complement two very different games

When the two stepped onto the Asian Games arena, they were carrying the work of an ecosystem with them. The significance of the medal extended beyond the result of one quarterfinal and one semifinal

Three years earlier, Diya had entered her first Asian Games looking for experience and exposure while Manush had endured the disappointment of being one point away from a medal in men's doubles. This time they went for a medal, and got it

India's cement footprint stands in its way to net-zero emissions

Producing cement is highly carbon-intensive and releases greenhouse gases as part of limestone calcination processes; extracting limestone also destroys forests and fertile topsoil; cement is so entrenched in modern construction that the sector remains exceptionally hard to abate

Monika Mondal
BERLIN



Green construction: Traditional ordinary Portland cement consists of over 95% clinker mixed with gypsum. GOWTHAM AGM/UNSPLASH

By 2047, India plans to become an economically developed country. By 2070, it aims at becoming a net-zero emissions economy. Achieving both of these targets requires the Indian government to deal with one of the most important sources of emissions: construction.

This sector consumes steel and cement, among other materials, and its footprint contributes 35% to 40% of all greenhouse gas emissions around the world.

Most of these emissions are because of the energy that the steel and cement sectors need to reach extremely high temperatures required for industrial processes. But even between the two, the cement sector also emits carbon when calcinating limestone — a chemical reaction that makes cement one of the few hard-to-abate sectors, and which contributes 7 to 11% of emissions, almost double that of the aviation sector.

Need for cement

Construction activities have been part of human civilisation for many centuries Cement became the standard binding agent only in the 19th century, with the development of Portland cement in Britain in the 1820s, when builders were trying to meet the demands of rapid industrialisation. Before that, people used mineral-based binders, the material that holds bricks, sand, and stone together.

"Traditionally, India and many other parts of the world used a much wider range of binders and construction systems than Portland cement," Nandini Haldar, assistant professor at the School of Architecture and Planning, Vishwakarma University, Pune, said. "These included lime-based mortars, lime-surkhi mortars, mud/clay mortars, gypsum-based materials, and, in some contexts, naturally pozzolanic materials."

(A pozzolanic material reacts with calcium hydroxide in water to form cementitious compounds, thus strengthening concrete without itself being cement.)

Researchers have suggested that meeting India's infrastructure and housing demands may not be realistic without cement. However, that does not mean there are no alternatives. The Taj Mahal, which was completed in the mid-17th century, is testimony to the efficacy of lime mortar. Many Roman buildings until the 4th century AD that used lime-based binders with volcanic pozzolanic materials also still stand.

"The issue is less about the technologies having disappeared and more about the construction industry having developed an enormous ecosystem around cement," Ms.. Haldar noted.

"One of the challenges is that cement has become deeply embedded in the construction industry through standardisation, commercial availability, established supply chains, building practices and extensive marketing. Traditional materials often lack the same level of commercial infrastructure and standardised supply."

Science of cement

"Not just cement production ... [The] wider life cycle of cement and concrete has an environmental impact. From extraction and processing of raw materials, subsequent manufacturing, and transportation to construction sites," Dr. Haldar added.

Limestone — the raw material for cement — is formed when calcium-rich marine life, such as oysters and corals, is fossilised and compressed over millions of years.

Accessing it requires miners to first clear forests and all layers of fertile soil in specific areas to expose the sedimentary rock layer. Depending on the geography, limestone can be found 30 to 60 meters under the topsoil in Karnataka, Chhattisgarh, and Andhra Pradesh and at more shallow depths in Rajasthan.

Once that limestone is brought to a factory, it is mixed with clay and heated to around 1,450 degree Celsius. This heating process alone accounts for 35% to 40% of emissions from cement-making; the rest comes from the chemical breakdown of limestone.

When limestone is heated in the calcination process, it releases carbon dioxide as a by-product along with small stone-like balls called clinkers. These clinkers, responsible for 53% to 65% of emissions, are made of calcium silicates, calcium aluminates, and calcium aluminoferrites. They are crushed into powder and mixed in several ratios with gypsum and fly ash and sold as the various cement types available on the market.

India's cement industry currently emits 0.62 tonnes (or 620 kg) of carbon dioxide per tonne of cement. In a decarbonisation roadmap prepared with the Global Cement and Concrete Association, experts from The Energy and Resources Institute, New Delhi, said India should aim to reduce the emission rate to 0.56 tonnes of carbon dioxide tonne of cement made by 2030 and to 0.51 tonnes of carbon dioxide by 2047.

The same report also estimated cement production in India is expected to rise from 334 million tonnes in 2019- 20 to 1,546 million tonnes in 2070.

But "carbon dioxide is not the only environmental concern associated with industrial activity," Ms. Haldar said. "Cement manufacturing can also be associated with air pollutants such as nitrogen oxides, sulphur dioxide and particulate matter. These should be distinguished from greenhouse gases, which are assessed using their global warming potential."

There are also many "hidden" sources of carbon. Some examples are the carbon cost of cutting down hills to secure the limestone, emissions due to long distance transport, and the long-term effects of the loss of vegetation and the corresponding loss of carbon sequestration. And these effects are not typically considered in discussions around the cement industry.

"The dialogue on the effects before and after the cement production units are under-emphasised in current climate debates" in India, Kaveri Ashok, a researcher at the Center for Study of Science, Technology and Policy, Bengaluru, said.

Existing and proposed solutions

Since the dawn of the First Industrial Revolution, engineers and manufacturers have used coal, petroleum coke or natural gas to heat kilns. Today, with the focus on renewable sources of energy, electrification and the use of solid municipal waste to produce refuse-derived fuel (RDF) — to replace coal as a heat source for kilns — are at the forefront, according to a decarbonisation roadmap that NITI Aayog, the Indian government's topmost think-tank.

RDF is processed waste, typically shredded and sorted, with combustible materials concentrated into a fuel suitable for industrial boilers and cement kilns.

Before Portland cement, India and many other parts of the world used a wider range of construction binders like lime, lime-surkhi, mud/clay, gypsum, and natural pozzolanic binders

The idea is especially attractive because it also creates an incentive to improve waste management.

The NITI Aayog roadmap recommends that India "increase the use of RDF from municipal solid waste to achieve a 20% thermal substitution rate by 2030", resulting in "a cumulative emission reduction of approximately 80 million tonnes of carbon-dioxide-equivalent". But this requires India to do a better job of segregating waste at the source.

Another option focuses on reducing the amount of clinker: by mixing it with waste or by-products like slag from heavy industries like power plants and steelmaking. The less clinker cement contains, the greener it is. According to the International Energy Agency, replacing one tonne of clinker can avoid 0.83 tonnes of carbon dioxide emissions.

This said, cement cannot be fully decarbonised, so attaining net-zero emissions makes carbon capture inevitable.

The substitution also presents another limit: "While there are options where substitution goes as high as 50-70%, [in practice] the average substitution cannot be more than 40%," Ms. Ashok added, or a building's integrity could suffer. This is why cement "is called hard-to-abate".

Traditional ordinary Portland cement (OPC) consists of over 95% clinker mixed with gypsum. Portland pozzolana cement has 65-80% of clinker with fly ash and gypsum. Portland slag cement consists of 35-64% of clinker, with the rest a mixture of gypsum and granulated slag from a blast furnace. But per Ms. Ashok, real-estate developers and builders generally prefer OPC. One reason is that while all three types have a similar setting time of around 30 minutes, OPC gains strength in one week while the other two could take twice as long.

"To push the demand for green cement in the initial few years, maybe the government can do more public procurement of green cement," she suggested.

Since green cement replaces clinker with waste from other industries, it is less expensive. As per NITI Aayog, clinker-to-cement ratio — around 67.5% — in India is already lower than the global average of 77% and can be further reduced.

Some researchers are also working on complementary solutions like using traditional materials to make binders and to design buildings better. Then there is also the challenge of changing people's perceptions about the alternatives.

"Cement is easy to use, relatively fast-setting, versatile and widely understood by the construction industry. It can be used in a very wide range of structural and architectural applications, and the existing construction ecosystem is built around it," Ms. Haldar said. "These factors make cement very difficult to replace at scale, even when we recognise its environmental impact."

Looking beyond cement

In her research, Arpita Mathur, assistant professor at the National Institute of Construction Management and Research, Pune, has been studying indigenous construction practices. She said that depending on the requirements, there are several examples of alternatives to conventional cement-based construction around India, each of which evolved in response to the local geography and weather. For example, in Southern India, compressed earth blocks and rammed earth have been used with soil and sand and relatively small amounts of cement or lime.

Ms. Mathur has also identified binding agents such as cactus juice — a thick water-repellant fluid derived from cactus plants and mixed with lime and mud — and marble powder, a by-product of the marble industry.

Traditional Kath Kuni construction in Himachal Pradesh uses dry masonry and alternating layers of wooden beams without cement, with the structure using a raised stone plinth for better strength. In parts of Northern and Northeastern India, houses are raised above the ground using lightweight wood and bamboo to better survive flooding and earthquakes.

But these options are also not silver bullets. Ms. Haldar said a material or construction method that works well in one region or for one type of building may not be appropriate elsewhere. Traditional practices may also have to be modified to meet contemporary requirements.

"Cement and concrete are extremely difficult to eliminate from contemporary construction. I cannot realistically tell a client constructing a ten-storey building to simply replace reinforced-concrete construction with soil," Ms. Haldar said. "The more realistic approach is to reduce dependence where appropriate and design the building and surrounding urban environment to minimise heat gain and heat storage."

There are contemporary practitioners using lime, earth, mud, lime-surkhi, and other traditional or natural systems, she added. "The issue is less about the technologies having disappeared and more about the construction industry having developed an enormous ecosystem around cement."

(Monika Mondal is a freelance science and environment journalist. a.monikamondal@gmail.com)



A view of the cement factoy at village Mohanpura Jodhpura village in Rajasthan. S .M. Tayyab Hussain



The study generated more than 38,000 GPS locations, providing high-resolution data on seasonal elephant movements across multi-use landscapes. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

GPS study aims to reduce human-animal conflicts in Assam

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

GPS study of elephant movements aims at reducing conffilicts in Assam. A five-year satellite tracking study has provided new insights into how wild elephants navigate Assam's forests, tea plantations, agricultural areas, and riverine habitats, yielding "crucial" data for the authorities to strengthen habitat protection and mitigate conflicts with humans.

Wildlife officials and conservation ecologists tracked four female-led herds and a solitary male elephant in three high-conflict districts of Udalguri, Sonitpur and Biswanath – all on the northern bank of the Brahmaputra River – between April 2021 and June 2026 for the "breakthrough" study.

The findings of the study, conducted by the Assam Forest Department and World Wide Fund for Nature-India (WWF-India), were published in a report titled *Tracking the Giants: Movement* and *Habitat-Use Patterns of GPS-Collared Elephants in Assam*.

"The study will help guide conservation planning, strengthen wildlife-friendly infrastructure and support safer coexistence between people and wildlife across Assam," Assam's Forest Minister, Jayanta Mallabaruah, said after releasing the report on the occasion of the 72nd Wildlife Week on Teusday (October 6). The Minister told the 126-member Assam Assembly in July that human-elephant conflicts claimed 1,147 human lives and 246 elephants in the State since 2016. The study generated more than 38,000 GPS (Global Positioning System) locations, providing high-resolution data on seasonal elephant movements across multi-use landscapes.

According to the 2025 Synchronised All India Elephant Census, Assam remains the stronghold for Asian elephants in the northeastern region with an estimated population of 4,149 individuals.

"This report fills a major knowledge gap in terms of elephant presence and movement in the State. The findings of this study provide important baseline information on elephant-ranging patterns, particularly where they overlap with human land use," Vinay Gupta, Assam's Principal Chief Conservator of Forests-Wildlife and Chief Wildlife Warden, said.

Conservation strategies

Aritra Kshettry, who heads WWF-India's Elephant Conservation Programme, said the GPS telemetry survey helped identify core natural and secondary habitats used by the collared elephants and revealed a strong seasonal pattern in their movements. "This information will guide effective management of human-elephant conflict, which requires a clearer understanding of where elephants move, how they use different habitats and land-use types, and how these patterns change across seasons," he said.

Sonai-Rupai Wildlife Sanctuary, Behali Wildlife Sanctuary and Bornadi Wildlife Sanctuary emerged as important habitats extensively used by the collared elephants, a WWF-India statement said. At the same time, tea plantations served as significant movement pathways and secondary habitats, often bringing elephants close to people, it stated.

"Protected areas and reserve forests remained important elephant habitats for much of the year, with home ranges of female-led herds expanding during the paddy cropping season, a period also associated with high levels of human-elephant conflict," the statement read.

For feedback and suggestions
for 'Science', please write to **science@thehindu.co.in** with the subject 'Daily page'

Text&Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Number of markets to which Spotify has expanded audiobooks

180 Streaming giant Spotify announced on Wednesday it is expanding access to its audiobook service to more than 180 markets, up from 22 currently, as the format continues to gain popularity. According to the latest data from the Swedish company, the monthly audiobook listeners on the platform has risen some 40% year-on-year. AFP

Russian individuals, entities targeted by EU over Ukraine war

1,600 EU countries on Wednesday agreed a major new raft of sanctions on Russia targeting nearly 1,600 individuals and entities over Ukraine war, diplomats said. Officials said those being blacklisted are mainly linked to the Russian military and arms industry and that EU Foreign Ministers will adopt the measures at a meeting on Monday. AFP

People displaced due to fighting in Yemen in recent weeks

2 In lakhs. More than 2,00,000 people have been displaced from their homes since fighting in Yemen began in recent weeks, according to data released by United Nations' International Organization for Migration (IOM). IOM described the crisis sparked by renewed fighting between the Iran-backed Houthi group and Saudi-backed government forces in Yemen as alarming. REUTERS

Unaccompanied child migrants who travelled alone to Europe

20,800 Most migrant children who reached Europe last year were travelling alone, the UN said, warning about the abuse and violence they face en route. More than 20,000 of the 31,100 children arrived without a parent or guardian, the UN children, migration and refugee agencies said in a joint study. PTI

Rain deficit recorded in Meghalaya due to El Niño

60 in per cent. Meghalaya has recorded a 60% rain deficit due to the impact of the El Niño weather phenomenon, with Chief Minister Conrad K. Sangma saying his government has initiated mitigation measures by formulating a water policy and satellite mapping around 17,000 springs. PTI

COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

Follow us facebook.com/thehindu X.com/the_hindu instagram.com/the_hindu

India's trade caught in the middle

India's trade surplus with the U.S. is critical as it offsets a structural trade deficit with China, but a heavy U.S. tariff and the potential impact of AI on exports could put this surplus at risk and intensify pressure on the rupee; India should treat the tariff threat as a wake-up call to diversify its export markets and products

ECONOMIC NOTES

Rohit Azad
Indranil Chowdhury

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman said on Monday that India-U.S. trade talks have reached a "plateau" and further concessions from either side might be difficult. To begin with, those celebrating India extracting a great trade deal from the U.S. miss the point. While a deal with some relaxations may be better than no deal, we have to compare the situation against the status quo, i.e., what it was before the Trump tariff was imposed. This piece attempts to discuss the importance of the trade surplus that India runs with the U.S. in this context.

What makes the situation difficult is that India runs a trade deficit with China (red bars in Chart 1) but a surplus with the U.S. (blue bars in Chart 1). And it is not just that. India buys goods from China that are not easily substitutable, at least not in the short run; i.e., it is a structural deficit that is not easy to reverse. On the other hand, the heavy tariff on Indian goods that Donald Trump has threatened to impose, and the development of artificial intelligence (AI), could reverse its surplus with the U.S. Combine these two factors, and India faces a serious problem on the trade front.

India is caught between the devil and the deep blue sea.

Forex market and the rupee's value

Like many other markets, the price of a currency is determined by its demand and supply. In India's case, let us consider the value of the Indian rupee (INR). As a proxy for a global currency, we take the U.S. dollar. How many rupees a dollar can buy is India's exchange rate vis-à-vis the U.S. dollar. A rise in the number of rupees a dollar can buy means a rise in the value (price) of the dollar and a fall in the value of the rupee.

India's demand for dollars consists of its imports and capital outflows (outward Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) + Foreign Portfolio Investment (FPI)). A rise in the price of the U.S. dollar (a depreciation of the INR) means imports become more expensive for Indians because they have to shell out more INR to buy the same goods they were buying earlier. So, it is often assumed that demand for dollars falls with a rise in the price of the dollar. The supply of dollars to India comes from exporters, capital inflows (inward FDI + FPI), transfers, Net Factor Income from Abroad (NFIA), and external borrowing and deposits. In contrast to imports, exports are assumed to vary positively with the price of the dollar. If a dollar can buy more rupees, then the cost of employing a computer coder sitting in India becomes cheaper for an American firm. Once you bring the demand and supply together (in Diagram 1 (a)), the equilibrium value of the rupee is determined.

A caveat is in order. This is a simplified representation of reality. Firstly, India's exchange rate is not fully market-determined. The central bank manages the value of the rupee by intervening in the market to keep the exchange rate within a range of its preference (between the levels in Diagram 1). India has what is called a managed float system. How does the central bank intervene? If the demand for dollars outpaces its supply by so much that the rupee threatens to depreciate below the level preferable to the central bank, it releases forex to the markets (thereby inflating the supply of forex available) and keeps the rupee within the range. It adds to its reserves if the opposite happens, i.e., the rupee appreciates outside that range.

Secondly, the demand and the supply curves are not as neat as they are presented here. For example, beyond a certain range of depreciation of the rupee, capital outflows (for fear of loss in its dollar value) may far outpace the fall in imports, making the demand curve vary positively with the exchange rate, i.e., a C-shaped demand curve. But we leave those complications aside for this piece.

Trump tariff and the Iran crisis

Diagram 1 (b) is a schematic representation of the state that India is/likely to be in. Faced with a rising dollar price of crude imports, the demand curve for India would go up significantly. This threatens a depreciation of the rupee (which is what has worried India so much). Since this threatens to push the exchange rate beyond its range, the central bank would have to run down its reserves to manage the rupee's value, as it has done in the last two years.

If the U.S. continues to arm-twist India, it makes better economic sense for us to gradually diversify away from U.S. economy; what will be lost in the U.S. market could, at least potentially, be compensated within Global South

The role of a Trump tariff (added to the potential loss of exports that AI may bring in) needs to be seen in this context. Such a tariff, if implemented, will push the supply curve of dollars (due to a fall in exports to the U.S.) to the left and add to India's current woes on the external front. The extent of depreciation resulting from this is far beyond what India is facing currently. And to prevent the currency from depreciating beyond the upper bound may require a significant loss of reserves, an intervention which may set off a vicious cycle of capital outflow and depreciation.

Chart 2 plots these demand and supply values for the last nine quarters to show that the demand for dollars has outpaced the supply for four out of the last nine quarters. And there has been a sharp rise in demand in the aftermath of the closure of the Strait of Hormuz.

Criticality of the U.S. markets

Let us look at the trade surplus that India has with the U.S., which is the bone of contention for President Trump. If we divide the trade surplus into goods and services, we get a disaggregated picture of the current account surplus that India runs with the U.S. (see Chart 3). India's surplus in goods (Chart 3(a)) is much higher than it runs in services (Chart 3(b)) vis-a-vis the U.S.

The aim of Trump tariff is to reverse this goods balance in favour of the U.S. to the extent possible. If the U.S. continues to arm-twist India, it makes better economic sense for us to gradually diversify away from the U.S. economy. What will be lost in the U.S. market could, at least potentially, be compensated within the Global South provided the right trade and industrial policy architecture is in place.

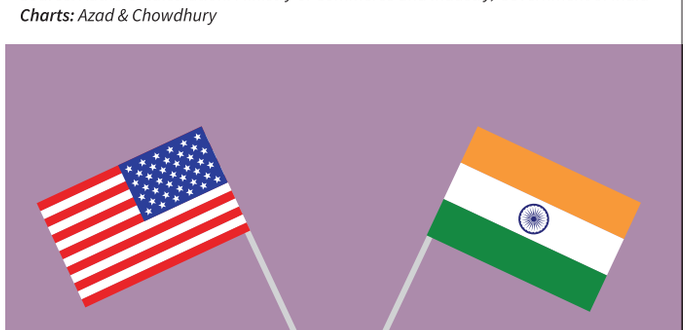
India should, accordingly, treat the Trump tariff as a wake-up call and use this opportunity to focus on export growth by diversifying the exportable product mix and regional development.

(The authors are a part of the DevMac (Development Macroeconomics) network, which seeks pluralism in Economics)

Trade-off on the cards

India's trade surplus with the U.S. faces uncertainty amid tariff persistent deficit with China

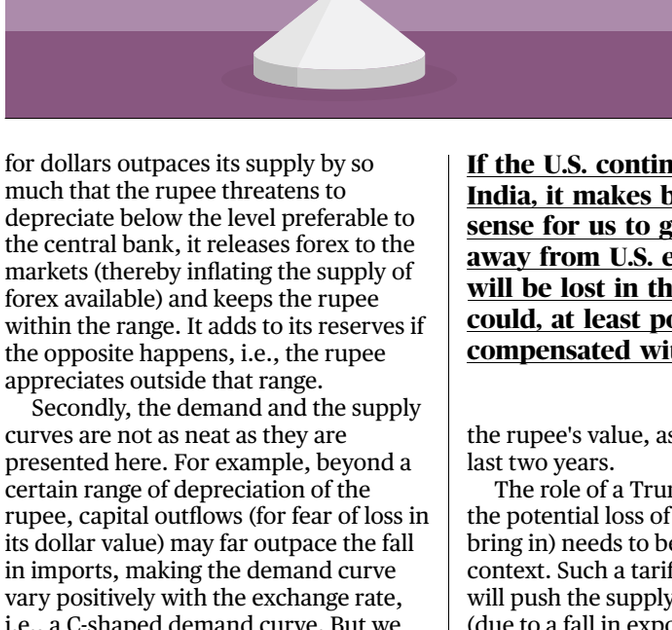
Diagram 1: India's forex market: A schematic representation



a) Demand for and supply of forex

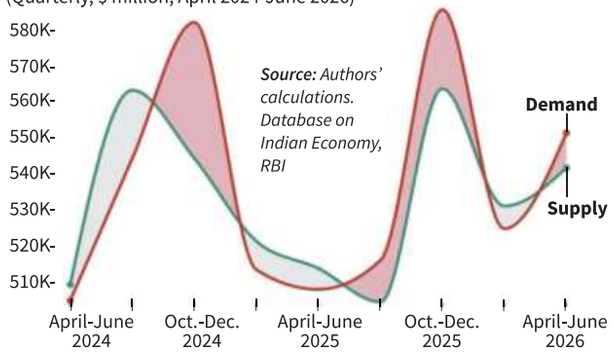
b) Trump tariff and the Strait of Hormuz

Chart 1: Net exports with the U.S. and China
(Annual, FY2013-14 to FY2025-26, in $ million)



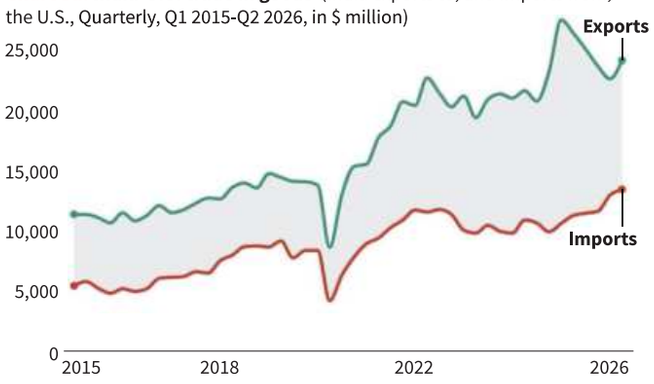
Source: Authors' calculation. Ministry of Commerce and Industry, Government of India
Charts: Azad & Chowdhury

Chart 2: Autonomous demand vs. supply of foreign exchange
(Quarterly, $ million, April 2024-June 2026)



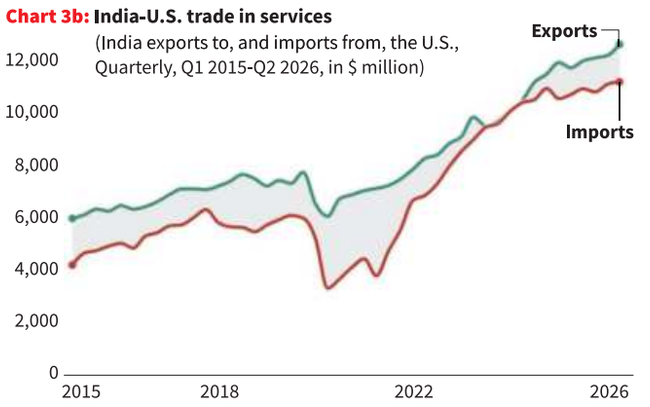
Supply of forex = Credit side of Current + Capital + Financial Account, excluding the Reserve Assets sub-item (RBI's own reserve transactions are the residual being financed, and not a private-market source of supply). Demand = the matching Debit side, same exclusion

Chart 3a: India-U.S. trade in goods (India exports to, and imports from, the U.S., Quarterly, Q1 2015-Q2 2026, in $ million)



Source: U.S. Census Bureau, FT-900 releases, Exhibit 19a / 20a, various years

Chart 3b: India-U.S. trade in services
(India exports to, and imports from, the U.S., Quarterly, Q1 2015-Q2 2026, in $ million)



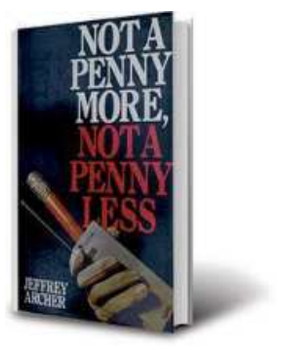
Source: U.S. Census Bureau, FT-900 releases, Exhibit 19b / 20b, various years

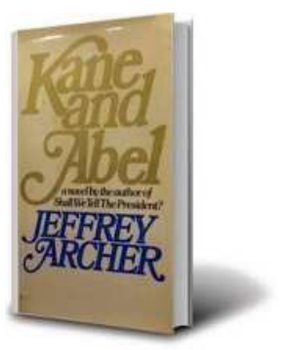
THE GIST

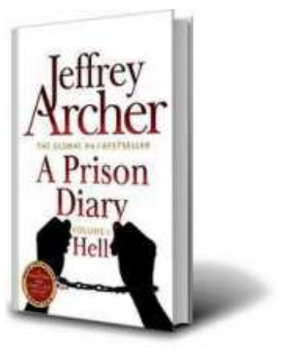
- India's trade deficit with China is structural, while rising crude import costs are putting pressure on the rupee and foreign exchange reserves
- A U.S. tariff could further widen the external imbalance by reducing export earnings and triggering capital outflows and currency depreciation
- India needs to strengthen export growth through a wider product mix and regional diversification, rather than relying heavily on the U.S. market

BIBLIOGRAPHY









Jeffrey Archer. REUTERS

Jeffrey Archer and the art of turning trouble into stories

His novels were dismissed by critics but devoured by readers; from political success and literary fame to scandal, imprisonment, and renewed success, Archer repeatedly turned both triumph and disgrace into material for his books

Uma Mahadevan-Dasgupta

My father, who died at the age of 90 last month, enjoyed reading the British author and former politician Jeffrey Archer's novels. Ever since he bought the first one, *Not a Penny More, Not a Penny Less* (1976) at an airport bookstore in the late 1970s, he became a fan. In the later years of his life, when he found it difficult to focus on serious texts, I often saw my father rereading Archer's novels — though he did not care for the prison memoirs.

His own life

Archer's books, however flat and formulaic the prose, are compulsively readable. Beginning with the opening lines of his first novel: "Making a million legally has always been difficult. Making a million illegally has always been a little easier. Keeping a million when you have made it is perhaps the most difficult of all." Four men — an Oxford academic, a doctor, an art dealer, and a peer — have been swindled out of their life's savings by the shady multi-millionaire Harvey Metcalfe. The four strangers come together to plan a heist and get their money back, to the last penny, in an entertaining *Ocean's Eleven* kind of caper novel.

According to Archer, who died aged 86 this week, the novel was based on his own experience and his urgent need for income. He had been one of the youngest Members of Parliament of his time, elected in 1969 as a Conservative MP, but a failed investment and near-bankruptcy in 1974 compelled him to stand down from his parliamentary seat and sell the family house.

The novel reportedly sold only 3,000 copies initially, but went on to become a bestseller. Meanwhile, his wife Mary's academic job at Cambridge kept the family afloat while Archer began his writing career.

Scale of ambition

While critics dismiss Archer's fiction for the potboiler style, contrivance, and melodrama, readers across the world keep buying his books, especially in airports and railway bookstalls, and even pirated copies at traffic signals. It is not only the plot or the fast pace that grabs their attention, but also the sheer scale of ambition. *Kane and Abel* (1979), Archer's bestselling novel, which has reportedly sold 50 million copies across the world, is a saga of capitalism and enterprise. The two main characters are born in very different circumstances and have very different lives, but along with a common birthday, they share a limitless ambition. Both are given tumultuous childhoods spanning continents: a forest birth, a war, Siberia, a death on the *Titanic*. The banker William Kane is a member of the Boston elite; the businessman Abel Rosnovski is a Polish immigrant in America. Through the Great Depression, the Second World War, and beyond, the two men's lives are connected in ways they do not fully realise until it is too late. Of course, being an Archer novel, the most enduring connection is made when their children meet. This golden goose of a story continues over three generations and two more novels.

If Archer's middlebrow fiction keeps returning to themes of meteoric rise, ruin, and recovery, it is perhaps because his life did the same, except with far more self-promotion and hubris. He was born in London in 1940 and grew up in Weston-super-Mare, a childhood hometown that would later return in his career as his title and entry into the House of Lords.

Archer's first novel was born out of his troubles, and so were his prison diaries, years later. Between these books came years in public life, a hunger for visibility, a tendency to self-promotion, and an inveterate snobbishness: a Conservative Party deputy chairmanship, a peerage, and a London mayoral candidacy that ended in 1999. A key point in the midst of this trajectory was a 1987 libel case against the tabloid newspaper *Daily Star* for its allegation that he had slept with a prostitute, Monica Coghlan. Although Archer won £500,000 in damages, his testimony was later shown to be false, leading to his conviction in 2001 for perjury and perverting the course of justice.

Writing in jail

"As we draw up to the entrance gate, I see a sign declaring BELMARSH PRISON. Some wag has put a line through the B and replaced it with an H. Not the most propitious of welcomes."

A Prison Diary is a three-volume account of Archer's life in multiple prisons: Belmarsh, Wayland, North Sea Camp, and Lincoln.

In the first volume, written after three weeks in jail, Archer doesn't reflect on the reasons why he has been sentenced to serve time in the high-security prison. Egregiously, and self-servingly, he prefaces the narrative with William Henley's poem *Invictus* — the poem that Nelson Mandela famously drew sustenance from during his 27 years of imprisonment. Elsewhere, Archer alludes to Oscar Wilde. Nevertheless, *A Prison Diary* is no *De Profundis*, and Archer is no victim other than of his own vanities. With a stubborn refusal to reflect on his own acts or hubris, he comments disdainfully about other prisoners and the reasons for their incarceration. About the first volume (2002), *Kirkus Reviews* noted: "Archer is a known recidivist. He will write again." Prescient words, for Archer would write two more volumes of his prison diary.

Making a million is hard, and keeping it harder. It involves ambition and occasionally its uglier synonym, greed. Archer made his millions, lost them, rebuilt his life, and, in the end, refused to reflect on his doings. Instead, he packaged and sold the prison years as well, fully monetising his disgrace.

(Uma Mahadevan Dasgupta is in the IAS)

THE DAILY QUIZ

Please send in your answers to dailyquiz@thehindu.co.in

On this day in 1967, Che Guevara was captured in a Bolivian ravine: a quiz on asthmatic medical student who became the most recognisable face of 20th-century revolution

Prathmesh Kher

QUESTION 1
Ernesto Guevara was born on 14 June 1928 in which Argentine city on the Paraná river?

QUESTION 2
Where does the nickname "Che" come from?

QUESTION 3
As a hard-tackling schoolboy rugby player, he was nicknamed "Fúser." What was it short for?

QUESTION 4
What was the nickname of the 1939 Norton 500 motorcycle on which he and Alberto Granado made their 1952 journey across South America?

QUESTION 5
In 1954, in which country did he watch a CIA-backed coup topple President Jacobo Árbenz, an experience that hardened his views of the U.S.?

QUESTION 6
In 2007, it emerged that Mario Terán, the soldier who shot Che, had received what from Cuban doctors?



Visual Question:
Identify the photographer who captured this famous image of Che Guevara at the memorial service for the victims of the La Coubre explosion. MUSEO DE COMANDANCIA DEL CHE, HAVANA

Questions and Answers to the previous day's daily quiz: 1. The 85 medals tally is India's second-highest ever haul at an Asian Games, following the record 107 at Hangzhou 2022. With which country did India tie for the gold medals with 21? **Ans: Uzbekistan, but claimed fourth place outright due to a superior silver medal count**
2. Who was the only Indian to win all three types of medals, and in which events? **Ans: Vithya Ramraj, who brought home gold in the women's 4x400m relay, silver in the mixed 4x400m relay, and bronze in the 400m hurdles**
3. At 15 years, 6 months, and 6 days old, who became India's youngest-ever gold medal winner? **Ans: Vaibhav Sooryavanshi (cricket)**
4. Which sport gave India the maximum gold medals with five? **Ans: Archery**
5. Apart from Neeru Dhanda in shooting, who also returned with two gold medals to his/her name? **Ans: Kumkum Mohod (archery)**
6. Pincky Balhara and Suchika Tariyal won bronze medals in which contact sports? **Ans: Kurash and MMA**
Visual: Identify her. She became the first Indian woman to win individual gold in which sport? **Ans: Pranavi Urs in golf**
Early Birds: Piyali Tuli | Tito Shiladitya | Pulkit Sathe | Sitaram Saharay | Sadhan Panda



FROM THE ARCHIVES

Know your English

S. Upendran

What is the meaning of "kicking it back"? (L. Balagopal, Hyderabad)
When you "kick back", "kick it back", or "kick it", what you are doing is relaxing. If you are sitting at home with your friends doing absolutely nothing, you can say that you are "just kicking it". This expression is considered to be slang and therefore used only in informal contexts. Here are a few examples.

After the exam, my friends and I kicked it at home last night.

Some people complain that most government employees go to the office, just kick it back until they have to go home.

This expression has more or less the same meaning as "chill out".

I have told Vyomakesh to chill out after the exams.

What is the positive reply to, "Won't you eat"? (V. Krishnan, Palghat)
If you want to eat, then you would have to say, "Yes, I will". If you want to sound very polite, you could say, "Yes, I will. Thank you." If the person is well known to you, then you could simply say, "Of course", "Sure", "Why not?", "Love to", etc.

What is the meaning of "hydrophobia"? (M. Amarnath, Kodaikanal)
"Hydro" means water; so it stands to reason that "hydrophobia" is fear of water. If a person is hydrophobic, does he/she ever take a bath? Worth looking into, don't you think? Someone should write a dissertation on this. Maybe we should all become hydrophobic during the summer. One way of saving water!

What is the meaning of the idiom "to fish in troubled waters"? (Nividha, Visakhapatnam)
When you fish in troubled waters, what you are doing is involving yourself in a dangerous situation in the hope of gaining some personal advantage. In other words, you hope to capitalise on someone else's misfortune. Something that our political parties and politicians are famous for. When a country fishes in troubled waters, what it is attempting to do is to gain advantage from the political problems that the other country is having.

Here are a few examples.

Bela is fishing in troubled waters by buying shares of that software company. I understand that the company is in financial difficulties.

Many American arms companies have been fishing in troubled waters for several decades now by selling armaments to states that are potential sponsors of terrorism.

The Prime Minister denied that his Government was fishing in troubled waters.

Fishermen believe that it is easy to catch fish when the water is "troubled" or rough. Some believe that the fish come to the surface at this time and therefore it is easier to catch them. Others argue that fish don't "bite" any better in bad weather than in good weather. They feel that the bad weather drives away most fishermen and, as a result, the few that remain catch more fish.

Published in The Hindu on March 12, 2002

Word of the day

Germane:
relating to something in an important or appropriate way

Synonyms: relevant, applicable, pertinent, to the point

Usage: *She asked a germane question about the proposal.*

Pronunciation: newsth.live/germane

International Phonetic Alphabet: /dʒɜːmeɪn/

For feedback and suggestions for Text & Context, please write to **letters@thehindu.co.in** with the subject 'Text & Context'